



LABOR AND EMPLOYMENT PLAN 2023-2028



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Message from the Secretary



Bienvenido E. Laguesma

Secretary

Department of Labor and Employment

The Department of Labor and Employment is pleased to share with the public the Philippine Labor and Employment Plan (PLEP) 2023-2028. The Plan is built on three priority pillars and outcomes - maximizing productive, remunerative, freely chosen, and sustainable work and employment opportunities; enhancing labor market governance in a way that balances respect for fundamental principles and rights at work, international labor standards and human rights with private sector-led growth; and strengthening policies, institutions and programs toward equitable and inclusive social protection.

The PLEP is intended to serve as the labor and employment component of the 2023-2028 Philippine Development Plan, which sets out the broad strokes toward attaining the primary goals of President Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr.'s socio-economic agenda of creating decent jobs, increasing productivity and incomes, reducing poverty and inequality, and ensuring a just, humane and secure future for all. The PLEP is also aligned with global social development goals (SDGs) as set out in the United Nations Agenda 2030, particularly SDG 8 which aims for decent work and inclusive growth for all. Envisioned as a living document, the PLEP is well-positioned to be integrated as a foundational plan for the on-going development of the National Employment Master Plan under the Trabaho Para Sa Bayan Act.

While the process of formulating the PLEP was initiated by DOLE, it would not have been completed without the active engagement, participation and inputs of the tripartite partners consisting of concerned government agencies, trade unions and other workers' organizations, and employers' and business organizations at the national, regional and local levels. Also involved in the formulation were representatives from the academe, local government units, and civil society organizations particularly those representing the informal sector and vulnerable communities and groups of workers. The PLEP also benefitted from the contributions of experts and development cooperation arrangements, especially from the International Labor Organization. DOLE is indeed grateful to have worked with all these stakeholders, and looks forward to continuing collaboration with them in the implementation of the PLEP.

PLEP 2023-2028 builds upon the strengths of previous labor and employment plans. Incorporating positive lessons learned from these plans as well as concerns arising from the accelerated transformations in the world of work, it now includes a strategic roadmap and a results matrix, identifying the commitments and responsibilities of concerned agencies and partners and the timelines for achieving results. It is also now enhanced with an in-

dustry- and sector-specific dimension, bearing in mind the opportunities and challenges in adapting labor market governance to new and emerging forms of work and employment arrangements; the need to ensure workforce readiness to cope with the advances in technology in the form of new work processes, robotization, automation, digitalization and artificial intelligence; the challenge of climate change and just transition, with an emphasis on the creation of green and sustainable jobs; and constantly shifting geopolitical alignments that affect access to trade with possible positive and negative effects on product and labor markets. In addition to the industry- and sector-specific dimension, the PLEP is now also enhanced with a localized, geographical dimension. During the consultative process leading to its formulation, key employment generators in specific growth areas were identified, leading to specific plans on how these may be supported. This combination of industry- and sector-specific and area-specific dimensions will help allow for more strategic, targeted, focused, efficient and effective program interventions in implementing the PLEP.

The letter of the PLEP, as spelled out in its roadmap and results-matrix, will of course be always animated by its spirit. And this spirit is found in the commitment of all the stakeholders who contributed to its formulation to work together in the attainment of the priority pillars and outcomes that they have agreed upon, contribute their share in achieving these outcomes, jointly monitor progress and periodically revisit the plan to make necessary adjustments, and continue understanding their differences and interests in order to expand the space for collaboration and joint action. It is this spirit that will ensure that PLEP will make a significant contribution to the common goal of decent work, inclusive growth and a just and progressive new Philippines.

With this publication, the DOLE hopes to give stakeholders and the public a deeper appreciation of the PLEP, and to invite everyone to do their share in contributing to the realization of the outcomes that it embodies.

Message of Support



Khalid Hassan

Director, ILO Country Office for the Philippines

The International Labour Organization (ILO) congratulates the government, workers, employers and tripartite plus partners on the completion of the Philippine Labor and Employment Plan (PLEP) 2023-28. This comprehensive document, which also serves as the ILO's Decent Work Country Programme (DWCP) for the Philippines, demonstrates our collective commitment to fostering a more inclusive, equitable, and dynamic labour market in the country.

The PLEP is also a significant step towards further aligning the Philippines with international labour standards and best practices. The ILO is therefore proud to have provided technical support and participated in the PLEP development process.

We recognize the importance of the plan's emphasis on social protection and decent work. By ensuring that all workers have access to social security, equal access to remunerative work opportunities, effective support for micro-, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs), and safe working conditions, the PLEP directly contributes to the overall well-being of the Filipino workforce.

Furthermore, the plan's focus on digital transformation and innovation is crucial in preparing the workforce for the future of work. By investing in digital skills training and promoting the adoption of new technologies, the plan ensures that workers are equipped to thrive in an increasingly digital economy.

The ILO also highlights the importance of inclusive growth, which is a cornerstone of this plan. By prioritizing marginalized groups, including women, youth, and persons with disabilities (PWDs), the plan promotes equal opportunities and reduces disparities in the labour market. This inclusive approach not only enhances social cohesion but also drives sustainable economic development.

I strongly commend the collaborative efforts of the government, the employers' and workers' organizations, and civil society groups in crafting this forward-thinking strategy. Together, we can build a resilient and prosperous future for all Filipino workers, ensuring that no one is left behind in the pursuit of inclusive sustainable development and social justice.

Message of Support



Atty. Sonny G. Matula

President

Federation of Free Workers (FFW) &
NTIPC Member Representing The Labor Sector

Minamahal na mga kasama,

Ang Federation of Free Workers (FFW), bilang bahagi ng National Tripartite Industrial Peace Council- Labor Sector, ay buong pusong sumusuporta sa Philippine Labor and Employment Plan (PLEP) 2023-2028. Kinikilala ng FFW ang LEP bilang isang mahalagang hakbang upang makamit ang inklusibong pag-unlad at disenteng trabaho para sa bawat manggagawang Pilipino.

Bilang patuloy naming panata, nananatiling pangunahing layunin ng FFW na palakasin ang pakikilahok ng mga manggagawa sa proseso ng just transition tungo sa isang makatarungan at mas likas-kayang kaunlaran, na mahalagang bahaging planong ito. Kaya't mahalagang mapal-akas ang karapatang mag-union upang magkaroon ng makabuluhang partisipasyon ang manggagawa sa pagpapayaman ng planong ito. Itinuturing din namin ang LEP bilang isang buhay na dokumento na nangangailangan ng patuloy na pag-a-update at pagsusuri upang mas matugunan ang pangangailangan ng kasalukuyan at ng hinaharap.

Sa paggunita ng aming misyon, mananatili ang FFW na kaisa ng pamahalaan at mga social partner sa pagtutulungan para sa maayos at epektibong pagpapatupad, pag-monitor at pagtata-sa ng LEP 2023-2028.

Maraming salamat sa pagkakataong mag-ambag sa planong ito. Sama-sama nating isulong ang tagumpay ng PLEP para sa kapakanan ng manggagawang Pilipino.

Message of Support



Annie Enriquez Geron, RGC, PhD

President

Public Services Labor Independent Confederation

The Public Services Labor Independent Confederation (PSLINK), an umbrella organization representing over 114,000 government employees across national agencies, local government units, state and local universities and colleges, government-owned and controlled corporations, barangay health workers, and retired government employees, proudly extends its unequivocal support for the Philippine Labor and Employment Plan (PLEP) 2023-2028.

This plan is a testament to the power of collaboration among government, labor, and employers in creating a more inclusive, equitable, and sustainable labor environment. We commend the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE) for its steadfast commitment to an inclusive process that ensures the voices of all labor sector stakeholders are heard and valued.

PSLINK upholds the principles of Strong, Accountable, Comprehensive, Responsive, Effective, and Democratic (SACRED) public services as the cornerstone of good governance and equitable development. The PLEP 2023-2028 aligns with our mission to promote public service that truly serves the people, safeguards workers' rights, and upholds the dignity of labor.

This plan provides a clear roadmap for ensuring no worker is left behind and for creating opportunities for decent work and sustainable growth. As advocates for the rights and welfare of government employees, PSLINK commits to actively supporting its implementation. We stand ready to work hand in hand with our social partners to uphold industrial peace, promote decent work, and drive forward sustainable development, all while ensuring SACRED public services remain central to our shared vision.

Through solidarity, we can build a resilient, empowered, and inclusive workforce that will pave the way for a brighter future for all Filipino workers.

Message of Support



Temistocles S. Dejon Jr

National President
All Workers Alliance Trade Unions (AWATU)

The All Workers Alliance Trade Unions (AWATU) fully supports the Philippine Labor and employment Plan spearheaded by the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE). This comprehensive initiative is a significant step towards advancing workers' rights, promoting decent work and ensuring sustainable employment opportunities for all Filipinos.

As a unified voice of the labor sector we stand ready to collaborate with DOLE and all stakeholders in achieving the plan's goals. Together

let us work towards a future where every worker is empowered, protected, and valued.

Mabuhay ang manggagawang Pilipino! Mabuhay ang DOLE!



Mary Joy D. Viñas

Labor Sector Representative
Public Services Labor Independent Confederation (PSLINK)

On behalf of the Public Services Labor Independent Confederation (PSLINK), we extend our heartfelt gratitude to the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE) for its continued dedication to the welfare of Filipino workers. The finalization of the Philippine Labor and Employment Plan (PLEP) 2023-2028 marks a significant milestone in our collective journey towards inclusive growth and sustainable development.

We recognize that the successful implementation of this plan hinges on the strength of collaboration between the government and social partners. By working together, we can create an environment where every Filipino worker has access to decent work, fair wages, and opportunities for growth.

This plan not only aims to address the immediate needs of our workforce but also envisions a future where no worker is left behind. The PSLINK stands united in supporting these initiatives, as we believe that a strong partnership is key to achieving a prosperous and equitable society for all.

We are committed to continuing our efforts in ensuring that the plan's goals are met and that Filipino workers remain at the heart of development, enjoying dignity, security, and empowerment in their workplaces.

Message of Support



Sergio Ortiz-Luis, Jr.

President

Employers Confederation of the Philippines &

NTIPC Member Representing The Employer Sector

On behalf of the employer sector, the Employers Confederation of the Philippines (ECOP) extends its heartfelt appreciation to the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE) for its tireless and visionary efforts in crafting the Philippine Labor and Employment Plan (PLEP) 2023-2028. This forward-looking plan is a testament to our shared commitment to fostering an inclusive, sustainable, and future-ready labor market that champions decent work, equitable opportunities, and social justice for all Filipinos.

The development of the PLEP 2023-2028 underscores the importance of social dialogue and collaboration among the government, employers, workers' organizations, and other stakeholders. More importantly, the PLEP is not the sole responsibility of DOLE, but a shared endeavor of all social partners who are committed to creating meaningful and transformative changes in the Philippine labor market. It is through this spirit of tripartism and collective action that we can address the complex challenges of our times and lay the groundwork that is not only resilient but also empowering and inclusive.

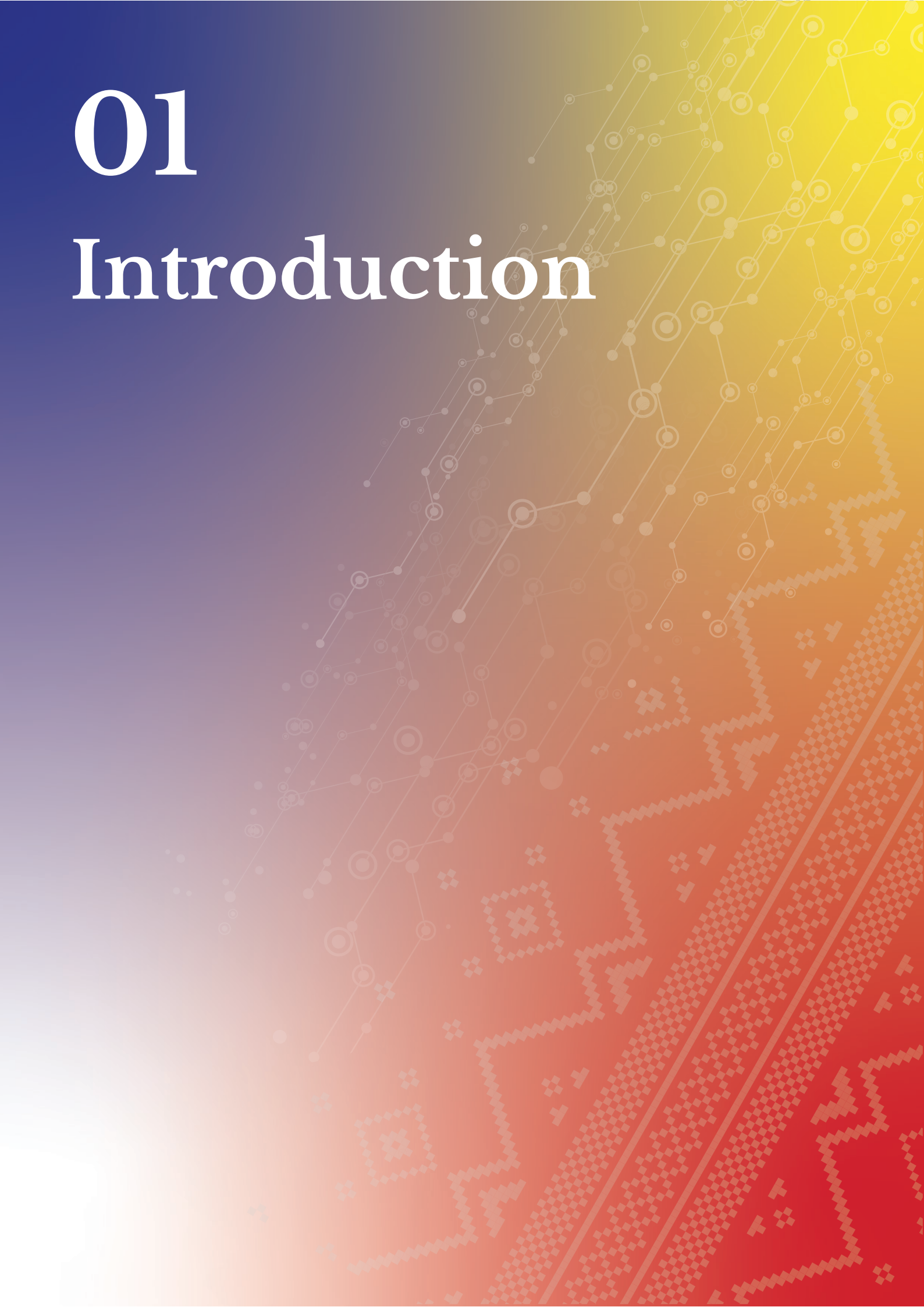
This plan offers a comprehensive and actionable roadmap to align labor and employment policies with the principles of sustainable development. By doing so, it ensures that economic growth is both inclusive and equitable, leaving no Filipino worker behind. It also prioritizes the creation of decent and dignified work opportunities, recognizing that the prosperity of businesses and the well-being of workers are inseparable pillars of national progress.

As we see the completion of this pivotal framework, the employer sector reaffirms its unwavering support and commitment to the plan's objectives. We are determined to work hand in hand with DOLE and all social partners to implement the strategies outlined in the PLEP 2023-2028, ensuring that its vision is translated into tangible benefits for the Filipino workforce and the business community alike.

Together, let us strive to create a resilient, competitive, and compassionate labor landscape—one that not only adapts to global trends and challenges but also upholds the dignity and aspirations of every worker. By aligning our efforts, we can unlock the full potential of the Philippine workforce, enable enterprises to thrive, and secure a brighter future for generations to come.

01

Introduction

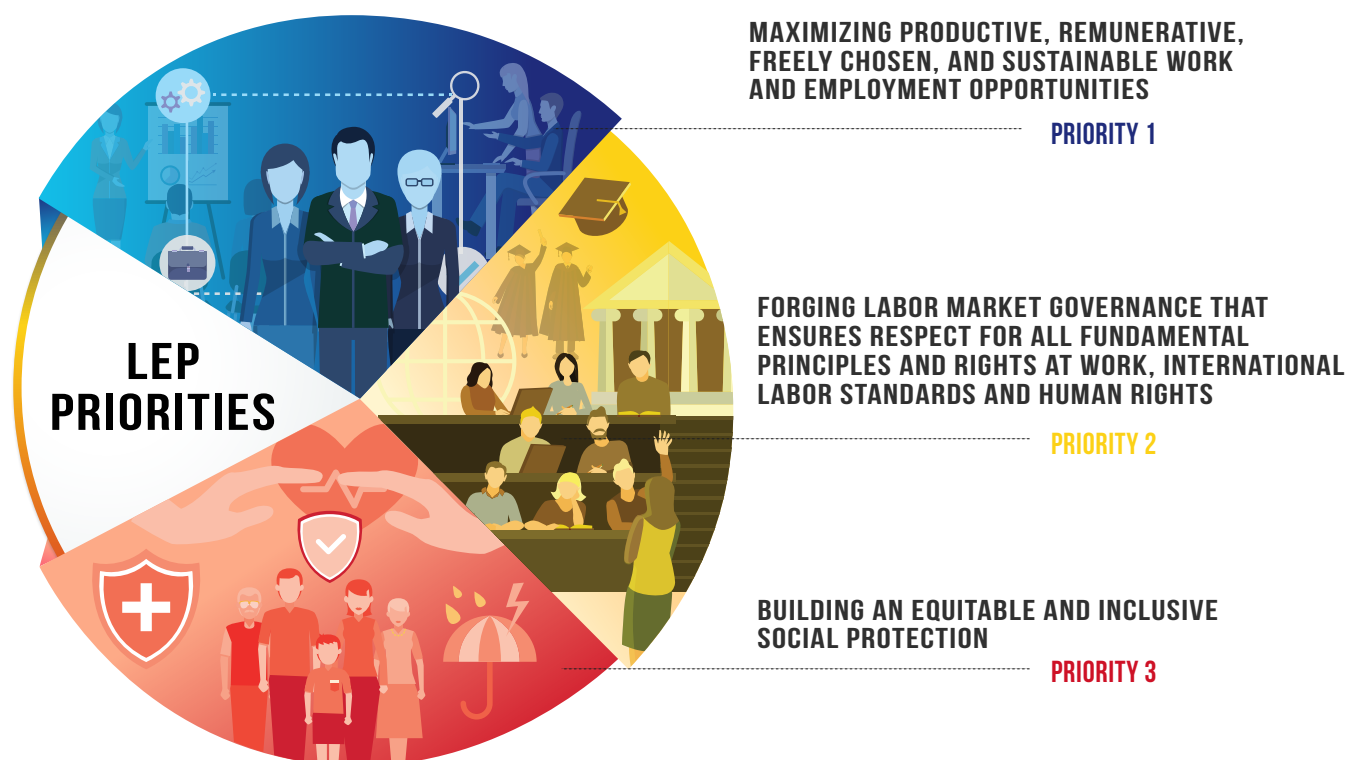


Introduction

The Philippine Labor and Employment Plan 2023-2028 (PLEP) is a multipartite blueprint that supports and facilitates the creation of decent, productive, remunerative and sustainable work and employment opportunities for every Filipino worker. The PLEP embodies the employment goals articulated in the President's 8-Point Socioeconomic Agenda, particularly the generation of more jobs that are green and of high quality. It also complements the Philippine Development Plan 2023-2028 (PDP) which aims "to reinvigorate job creation and accelerate poverty reduction" and "achieve economic and social transformation for a prosperous, inclusive, and resilient society."¹ The PLEP also supports the Trabaho Para sa Bayan Act² which recognizes the important role decent jobs and sustainable enterprises play in reducing poverty, and the need to improve the employability, competitiveness, and productivity of Filipino workers.

Decent, productive, remunerative, and sustainable work will empower Filipino workers and their families to realize their full potentials and enable them to lead resilient (*matatag*), comfortable (*maginghawa*), and secure (*panatag*) lives.

The PLEP updates and expands the existing Decent Work Country Program (DWCP) 2020-24³ and will also serve as the country's DWCP for the duration of the PDP. It is organized along three key priorities, as follows:



¹ Philippine Development Plan 2023-2028, Chapter 1, pp. 14 and 17.

² Republic Act No. 11962 was enacted on 27 September 2023

³ The last PLEP was for the period 2011-2016 with the theme, "Inclusive Growth Through Decent and Productive Work." No PLEP was published after 2016. What was published, instead, was the DWCP 2020-24, jointly endorsed by the DOLE and the ILO and their social partners. The DWCP is envisioned to serve as the integrated strategic roadmap for national stakeholders and international partners in supporting the labor and employment goals and priorities of AmBisyon Natin 2040.

1.1. The President's Socioeconomic Agenda and Philippine Development Plan 2023-2028

The development vision of President Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr.'s administration was first set out in an eight-point socioeconomic agenda and subsequently through the PDP. Both documents place high priority on policies, programs and projects that generate sustainable investment, create work opportunities, and increase productivity and incomes. This is sought to be achieved through a combination of strategies focused on protecting the purchasing power of families; reducing vulnerability, including effective social protection, and mitigating the scarring effects from the COVID-19 pandemic, among other priorities. It is expected that from 2023 to 2028, the socio-economic agenda and the PDP will guide spending priorities in the General Appropriations Act (GAA).

As the strategic articulation of the President's socio-economic agenda, the PDP embodies the development objectives that the administration vows to pursue at the national and sub-national level to create high-quality jobs in all sectors of the economy, and reduce the incidence of poverty among all demographic groups by 2028. It emphasizes the importance of investing in physical, human, social overhead, and technological capital to ensure sustained, stable, and inclusive economic growth.⁴

The PDP aims to transform the production sectors to provide high-quality, high skill, and stable employment opportunities for the Filipino workforce.⁵ An essential reinforcing strategy for this transformation is the development of the capabilities of individuals and families to enable them to take advantage of growth opportunities, and to pursue their aspirations in livable communities where social protection is accessible and available, lifelong learning is a way of life, and conditions for increased income-earning ability of the people exist.

The PLEP and its priorities are aligned with these national development objectives. Its programs, activities, and legislative agenda are organized to bring about an effective, efficient and forward-looking labor market governance capable of producing and sustaining desired labor market outcomes. The labor market serves as a venue for a

variety of exchanges between workers, employers, entrepreneurs and other market players who demand and supply or produce goods and services. To ensure and maximize the mutual benefits from these exchanges, the enabling conditions for a vibrant labor market must be present. This means that the economy must be able to create work opportunities at an optimum pace, that such opportunities are open and accessible to all those who wish to be part of the exchange, that the rights of the players are defined and respected to ensure predictability and stability in their relations, and that adequate provisions exist to respond to contingent events.

The PLEP's desired outcomes and strategies under Priority 1 are aligned with the PDP's strategy to increase the income-earning ability of Filipino workers by enhancing their employability and creating more and better-quality jobs, expanding their access to employment opportunities, and ensuring shared labor market governance⁶ among the tripartite partners and other stakeholders in policy formulation and program development and implementation.

On the other hand, the need to ensure a labor market governance that promotes respect for all fundamental principles and rights at work under Priority 2 resonates with the "whole-of-society" approach that the PDP advocates and its objective to foster an enabling environment encompassing institutions which promotes a prosperous, inclusive and resilient society.

⁴ Social overhead capital here refers to public institutions normally viewed as prerequisites to development, including well-designed public institutions and working arrangements to ensure smooth implementation of government programs and projects, along with a legal and judicial system committed to the rule of law, contractual enforcement, as well as timely and fair adjudication of contractual disputes.

⁵ This transformation includes revitalizing industry, modernizing the agriculture sector, and reinvigorating the services sector (PDP Strategy Framework, p. 17).

⁶ According to ILO, labor market governance refers to a totality of policies, norms, laws, regulations, institutions, machinery and processes that influence the demand and supply of labor in an economy. Elements include the international labor standards system, labor law and policy reforms, effective social dialogue mechanism and tripartism, good industrial relations, labor administration and inspection system, and capacity-building of workers' and employers' organizations. (See <https://www.ilo.org/manila/areasofwork/labour-market-governance-and-working-conditions/lang-en/index.-htm#:~:text=Labour%20market%20governance%20refers%20C>)

The creation and sustenance of decent and productive work is best achieved in an environment where respect for all fundamental principles and rights at work, international labor standards and human rights, is assured and promoted.

Finally, Priority 3 pursues the desired outcomes and strategies of the PDP to strengthen social protection through the establishment of a universal, modern, integrated and inclusive social protection system in the country.

1.2. Formulation of the PLEP

The PLEP was formulated in a participatory and inclusive manner, with the involvement of high level representatives from the tripartite partners--workers and employers--and multipartite stakeholders representing the informal sector/economy, indigenous peoples (IPs), persons with disabilities (PWDs), key government agencies, and development partners from both the local and international community.

The DOLE organized a series of area-based consultations in Luzon, Visayas, and Mindanao in March 2023. These consultations sought to gather sectoral inputs to the PLEP along its three priority areas namely, employment, labor market governance, and social protection.

Each consultation consisted of four major activities, as follows: 1) assessment of the country's socio-economic situation and identification of the challenges confronting the world of work and the achievement of the desired outcomes in the three priority areas; 2) presentation and discussion of sectoral comments and recommendations; 3) joint formulation of outcomes and strategies, including targets; and 4) identification of a proposed PLEP legislative agenda.

A national High-Level Consultation was conducted on May 4 for the presentation of consultation outputs. Thereafter, on May 19, the National Tripartite Industrial Peace Council (NTIPC)⁷ convened to discuss the draft Plan, eventually passing a resolution approving the PLEP in a subsequent special meeting. On June 26, the Plan was endorsed to the Director-General of the International Labour Organization (ILO) during his official visit in Manila on the occasion of the 75th anniversary of the Philippines' membership in the ILO. The PLEP was presented during the National Tripartite Conferences convened in July and November 2023, marking the culmination of a series of area-based and high-level multi-stakeholder consultations and engagements.

⁷ The NTIPC is chaired by the Secretary of Labor and Employment, with 20 representatives each from the labor and employers' sectors. Its functions include the following: 1) advise the Secretary of Labor and Employment in the formulation or implementation of policies and legislations affecting labor and employment; 2) formulate, for submission to the President or to Congress, tripartite views, recommendations and proposals on labor, economic and social concerns, including the presentation of tripartite positions on relevant bills pending in Congress, and 3) participate in national, regional or industry-specific tripartite conferences which the President or the Secretary of Labor and Employment may call from time to time.

1.3. Overview of the PLEP

Within the overarching PDP framework of economic and social transformation, consistent with the country's decent work agenda, and supportive of the Trabaho Para sa Bayan Act, the PLEP will pursue a development path that is anchored on the creation of decent, remunerative, productive and sustainable work and employment opportunities for all Filipinos willing to work. This will be achieved through the implementation of three mutually-reinforcing priorities that will support the national goal of developing and protecting the capabilities of individuals and families through the promotion of human and social development, reducing vulnerabilities and protecting purchasing power, and increasing income-earning ability of Filipino workers.

Productive, remunerative, freely chosen, and sustainable work and employment opportunities will be maximized. For decent and sustainable work to be realized, it is important to increase the employability of workers through human capital development anchored on lifelong learning and globally-competitive and inclusive basic and higher education and technical and vocational education and training (TVET). Micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs), which comprise 99.6 percent of total enterprises in the country,⁸ will be supported to enable them to create decent work opportunities and expand productive employment in the formal sector. The enabling environment will be enhanced to facilitate the development and creation of more sustainable and resilient enterprises in the entire value/supply chain, particularly for MSMEs.

This priority also focuses on cross-cutting concerns of gender mainstreaming, environmental sustainability, equality and elimination of all forms of discrimination, and just transition towards a green, sustainable economy and toward socio-political stability in areas affected by conflicts. The goal is for groups in vulnerable and marginalized situations such as women, indigenous peoples (IPs), people with disabilities (PWDs) and youth, acquire appropriate competencies and have access to and engage in remunerative and productive work.

A labor market governance that ensures respect for all fundamental principles and rights at work, international labor standards and human rights will be forged. Decent work is only possible if the fundamental principles and rights at work are promoted and protected. For this to happen, there is a need to improve the capacity of labor administration authorities to implement and enforce labor standards and social and welfare legislations, including occupational safety and health standards, and to eliminate all forms of unacceptable work. This necessitates strengthening of the capacity of government and social partners in ensuring compliance with labor standards and effective participation in social dialogue and tripartite processes at the enterprise, industry, subnational and national levels. The goal is to put in place strengthened, modernized and balanced policy, legal and institutional frameworks on labor protection for all including migrant workers, workers in the informal economy and in non-standard or atypical employment arrangements.

An equitable and inclusive social protection will be established. The PDP envisions a universal, modern and integrated social protection system to which everyone can access in times of need. The PLEP shares this outcome and intends to realize it by ensuring a more inclusive implementation of social protection policies, programs and mechanisms, and strengthening the policy, legal and institutional framework for social protection for all. Toward this end, it supports the PDP outcome to establish a standard menu of rationalized programs for the social protection floor guarantees by, among other action points, reviewing existing social protection programs covering emergency cash assistance, livelihood, and social insurance.⁹ An effective and efficient implementation and coordination mechanism among social protection agencies will ensure adequate universal coverage, maximize impact for beneficiaries, and enhance the viability and sustainability of social protection floors.

⁸ Philippine Statistics Authority, 2022 List of Establishments (LE).

⁹ PDP 2023-2028, Subchapter 3.2 - Strengthen Social Protection, p. 88.

Social partnership as the implementation framework. The PLEP embodies the decent work aspirations of the tripartite partners and other constituents aligned with national and international development goals.

As a product of social dialogue and consensus, its implementation will be guided by the principles of mutual accountability, tripartite ownership, and inclusiveness.

1.4. Target Outcomes and Headline Indicators

As a companion sectoral plan to the PDP, the PLEP focuses on helping improve the productive and transformative capacity of the economy with specific and targeted development interventions on people who supply work, and on ensuring that their relations with those who demand work are balanced and fair. As such, over the next five years, the labor and employment agenda will support the achievement of PDP's goals to create more and better-quality jobs, increase productivity and incomes, develop and sustain globally-competitive workforce, provide a universal and integrated social protection system, and ensure shared labor market governance.

Create more and high quality jobs. The PLEP supports the PDP's goal to create more and better-quality jobs, measured in terms of low unemployment and increased share of wage and salary workers to total employment in the private sector. By 2028, unemployment rate is within 4 to 5 percent, and the percentage of wage and salary workers in private establishments to total employed is within 53 to 55 percent.

Increase employability of workers, including youth. Decent work is achieved when workers are able to earn income that allows them to meet basic needs and unforeseen emergencies. Thus, it is necessary to increase their employability by equipping them with relevant skills and competencies. The proportion of employed college graduates in elementary occupations will be decreased from 2.7 percent in 2020 to 1.5-1.73 percent starting 2024 until 2028. Also, the percentage of youth not in employment, education, or training (NEET) will be reduced from 12.6 to 11.3-13.3 in 2028.

Expand access to employment opportunities.

The labor force participation rate of women will be increased from 51.7 percent to 52-54 percent in 2028. Likewise, the placement rate of public employment service offices (PESOs) will be increased from 91 percent to 91.5 percent in 2028. Further, the percentage of educated unemployed to total unemployed will be reduced from 38 to 30-35 in 2028.

Ensure shared labor market governance. The percentage of total number of establishments provided with technical assistance that installed or enhanced productivity performance-based incentive schemes will be increased from 12 in 2021 to 15-17 in 2028. Similarly, the percentage of trained micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) that implemented productivity improvement programs will be increased from 69 in 2022 to 70-75 in 2028.

Reduce vulnerabilities by strengthening social protection. Social protection will be strengthened to reduce vulnerabilities and protect purchasing power. Toward this end, concerted efforts will be undertaken so that all Filipino families are covered with social insurance starting 2024. On the other hand, the percentage of senior citizens who receive pension will be increased from 60.27 in 2021 to 66.53 in 2028. Likewise, the total expenditures on social protection programs as percentage of gross domestic product will be increased from 2.7 percent in 2021 to 5.25 percent in 2028.

Table 1.4.1 presents the PLEP headline targets and outcome indicators for the period 2024-2028. Other indicators are included in the Results Matrix of the plan.

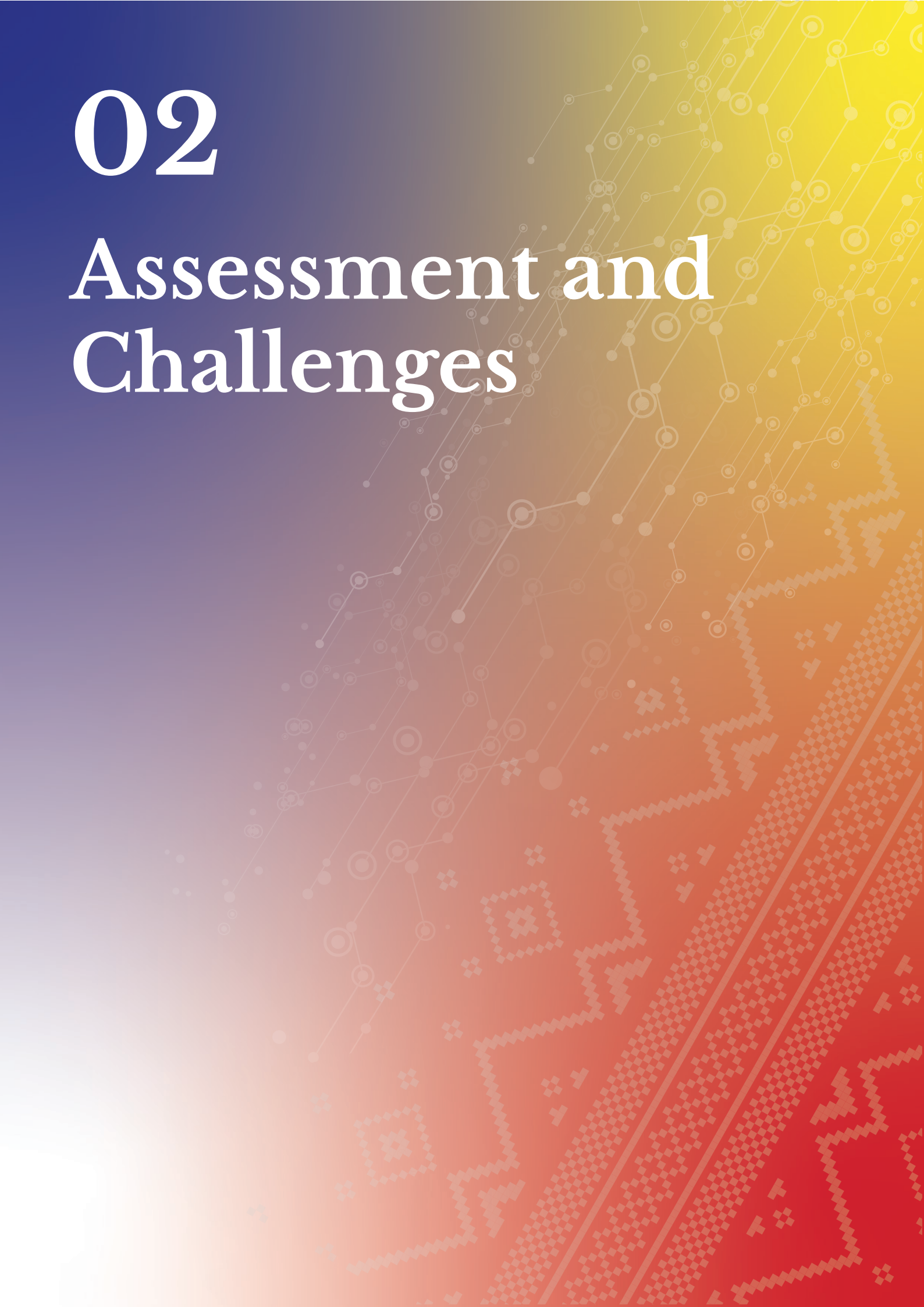
Table 1.4.1
Outcome Indicators

- a. Baseline figure is computed using the identified post-secondary graduates from the LFS.
b. Number of training regulations and competency standards with green competencies, including newly developed and reviewed.
c. Includes those with college education (undergraduates and graduates).
* Average spending of Middle-Income countries on SP excluding health (Source: ILO, World Social Protection Report 2020-22)

	BASELINE (YEAR)	ANNUAL PLAN TARGETS					MEANS OF VERIFICATION	RESPONSIBLE AGENCY
		2024	2025	2026	2027	2028		
More and High Quality Jobs Created								
Unemployed rate decreased (%)	5.4 (2022)	4.4-4.7	4.8-5.1	4.0-5.0	4.0-5.0	4.0-5.0	Labor Force Survey [LFS], PSA	Social Development Committee (SDC)
Percentage of wage and salary workers in private establishments to total employed increased (%)		50.9-51.5	51.4-52.4	51.9-53.3	52.5-54.1	53.0-55.0	LFS, PSA	SDC
Employability Increased								
Proportion of employed college graduates in elementary occupations (%) decreased	2.7 (2020)	1.50-1.73	1.50-1.73	1.50-1.73	1.50-1.73	1.50-1.73	LFS	SDC
Percentage of youth not in employment, education, or training (%) decreased	12.6 [Ave. Jan, Apr, Jul, Oct. 2022]	12.5-14.5	12.2-14.2	11.9-13.9	11.6-13.6	11.3-13.3	LFS	SDC
TESDA certification rate in priority sectors (%)increased	92 (2021)	92.5	93	93.5	94	94.5	TESDA data	TESDA
Employment rate of TVET graduates (%) increased	93.4 (average for Jan, Apr, Jul, Oct. 2022)	94-96	95-96	95-96	95-96	95-96	LFS	SDC
Number of training regulations, curricula, and courses with green core competencies increased	81 (2021)	98	108	119	131	144	TESDA data	TESDA
Access to Employment Opportunities Expanded								
Female labor force participation rate (%) increased	51.7 (average for Jan, Apr, Jul, Oct. 2022)	51.5-53.5	52.0-54.0	52.0-54.0	52.0-54.0	52.0-54.0	LFS	SDC
Placement rate (%) of public employment service offices increased	91 (Sep. 2022)	91	91.2	91.3	91.4	91.5	DOLE data	DOLE
Percentage of educated unemployed to total unemployed (%) reduced	38.0 (average for Jan, Apr, Jul, Oct. 2022)	35-37	35-37	30-35	30-35	30-35	LFS	SDC
Shared Labor Market Governance Achieved								
Percentage of total number of establishments (%) provided with technical assistance that installed or enhanced productivity performance-based incentive schemes	12 (2021)	10-12	12-15	12-17	15-17	15-17	DOLE data	DOLE
Percentage of trained micro, small, and medium enterprises (%) that implemented productivity improvement program	69 (2022)	69-70	70-75	70-75	70-75	70-75	DOLE data	DOLE
Vulnerabilities Reduced and Purchasing Power Protected through Strengthened Social Protection								
Percentage of families covered with social insurance (%)	83.8 (2020)	100	100	100	100	100	Annual Poverty Indicators Survey	SSS, GSIS, PhilHealth, Philippine Crop Insurance Corporation
Percentage of senior citizens who receive pension (%)	60.27 (2021)	63.74	64.20	65.41	65.84	66.53	SSS, GSIS, DSWD, PNP Pensioner Online Accounting System admin data, PSA population projection	SSS, GSIS, DSWD, National Commission of Senior Citizens, PNP, AFP
Percentage of documented Overseas Filipinos to total Overseas Filipinos (%)	88.9 (2021)			Increasing			DFA report	DFA, DMW, OWWA, Commission on Overseas Filipinos
Percentage of economically active population contributing to SSS (%)	37 (2021)	40-41	40-41	41-42	41-42	42-43	SSS admin data	SSS
Total expenditures on social protection programs as percentage of gross domestic product (%)	2.7 (2021)	3.55	3.98	4.49	4.83	5.25	DBM data	NEDA SDC

1.5. Contents of the PLEP

The PLEP is organized as follows: Chapter 1 introduces the plan and the development context that guided its formulation and will inform its implementation, monitoring and evaluation. Chapter 2 presents an assessment of labor market performance in the pre- and post-pandemic period 2001-2023, including labor market outcomes, and the challenges faced by the labor market and actions to prioritize moving forward. Chapter 3 discusses the three strategic priorities and the targets, outputs and outcomes of each strategy. Chapter 4 covers the proposed legislative agenda. Finally, Chapter 5 presents the management structure of the plan, and the action points to be taken to monitor and evaluate its implementation, and to communicate its progress and achievements. For this purpose, a Results Matrix (RM) was developed containing indicators and targets, as well as the names of agencies and stakeholders responsible for the Plan's implementation, monitoring, achievement and evaluation of results.



02

Assessment and Challenges

Assessment and Challenges

This chapter discusses the labor market performance in the pre- and post-pandemic period and the labor market outcomes of government programs and interventions in the areas of employment, human resource and skills development, labor standards, labor migration and overseas employment, and social protection. It also presents the challenges in creating decent work and inclusive employment opportunities and enhancing labor market governance to ensure respect for the fundamental principles and rights at work, and bring about an equitable and inclusive social protection for all.

Sub-chapter 2.1. Maximizing productive, remunerative, freely chosen, and sustainable work and employment opportunities

Sustaining the creation of decent work, productive and remunerative employment opportunities requires addressing constraints on the supply and demand side of the labor market. It means creating the conditions necessary to increase labor force participation, enhance employability, raise labor productivity, and equalize opportunity and access to education and skills development programs of groups at particular risk of vulnerability or marginalization. It also entails giving particular attention to interventions that will enhance the

policy environment and capacity of institutions to promote the development and creation of sustainable and resilient enterprises in the entire value/supply chain, particularly MSMEs and cooperatives. It also means adopting and sustaining programs and interventions that promote decent work, green jobs, environmental sustainability and gender equality in employment policy, development plans and strategies, skills and enterprise development, peacebuilding, disaster and emergency response, and poverty reduction efforts.¹⁰

Assessment and Challenges

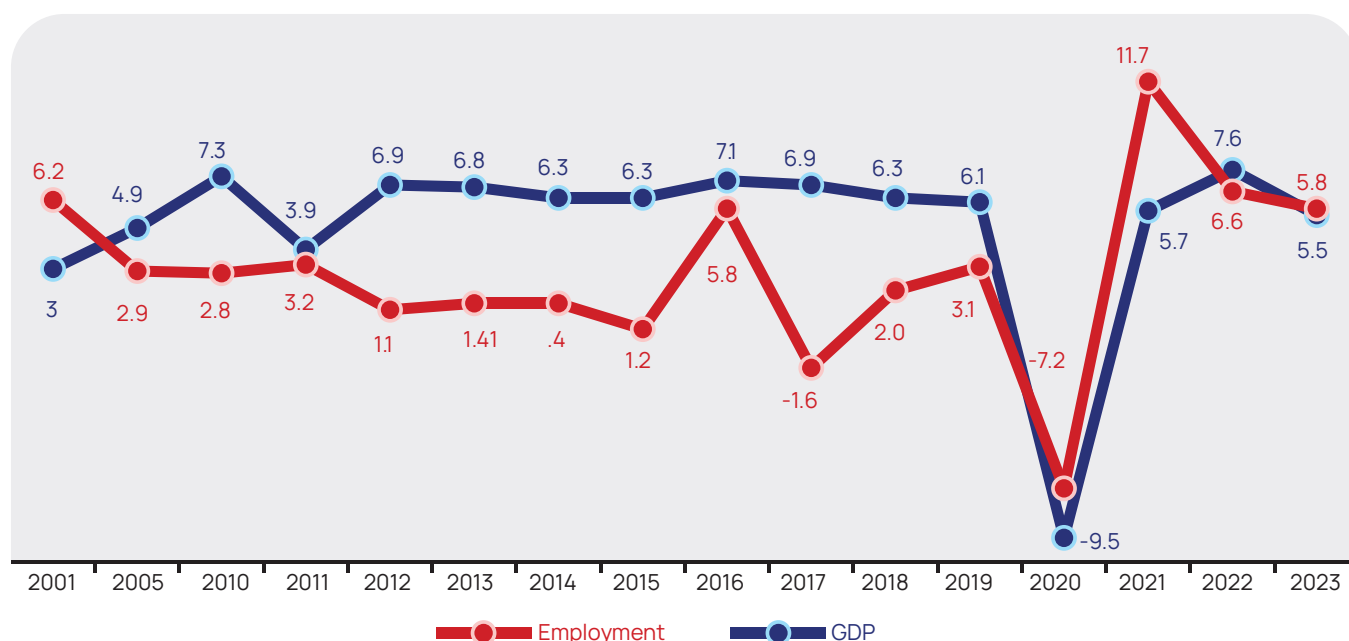
GDP and employment growth. Before the onset of the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020, the country achieved sustained economic growth from 2010 to 2019 but without corresponding growth in employment. Overall employment levels in some of the LFS rounds actually decreased, particularly in 2017, despite a 6.9 percent economic growth for the same year. The pandemic triggered an unprecedented economic and labor market crisis in the Philippines. Output contracted and employment levels dropped sharply, bottoming out in 2020. The economy started to recover starting in 2021 and continued in 2022 when employment surpassed the pre-pandemic levels (Figure 2.1.1).

Aggregate and sectoral labor market performance. The aggregate labor market performance since 2005 shows that the Philippines had a strong labor market as reflected in key employment indicators. However, the COVID-19 pandemic brought the country into a recession, causing record-high unemployment, with wide-ranging negative impacts on productivity, poverty, and structural transformation. Groups in vulnerable situations like women, children, youth, persons with disabilities, workers in the informal economy, and migrant workers were hit the hardest.

¹⁰ Decent Work Country Programme Philippines 2020-24, pp. 22-23.

Figure 2.1.1
GDP and Employment Growth (%), Philippines: 2001, 2005, 2010-2023

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, National Accounts and Labor Force Surveys



But with the calibrated opening of the economy and gradual improvement in health situation beginning in 2021, key labor market indicators started to show modest recovery. In 2022, employment rate was registered at 94.6 percent, which represented a 5 percentage point rebound from 89.6 percent in 2020. The underemployment situation also improved, down by 2.2 percent from 16.4 percent in 2020 to 14.2 percent in 2022. Employment growth continued in 2023 at 95.2 percent, while underemployment declined by 1.3 percent to 12.9 percent in the same year (Figure 2.1.2).

Sectoral employment. In terms of employment by sector for the period 2001-2024, the employment share of agriculture declined. For instance, the share of agricultural employment dropped by 14.3 percent from 37.2 percent in 2001 to 22.9 percent in 2019, the smallest share recorded during the past 19 years (Figure 2.1.3). However, data also showed both increases and decreases in the number of employed persons in the sector during the same period. For instance, increases were recorded for the period 2001-2009 and year 2011. However, from 2012 to 2019, data showed consistent decreases in the number of employed persons in the sector.

The pandemic caused employment in the sector to rise again. In 2019, close to 9.7 million were

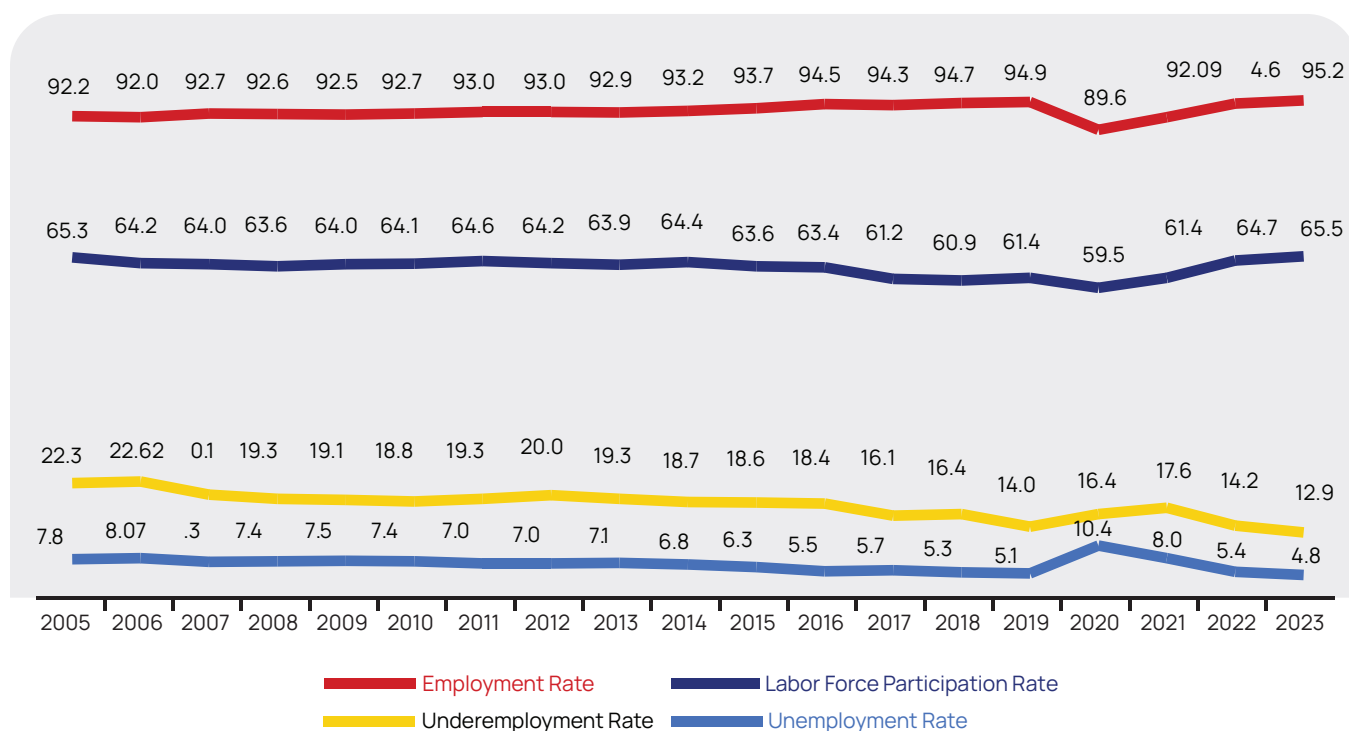
employed in the sector, the lowest ever recorded since 2001. This number slightly increased in 2020, and continued to rise until 2023 when 11.19 million were employed in the sector, almost the same level recorded in 2002 (Figure 2.1.4). This represents a 24.8 percent share of the sector in total employment in 2020, which remained above the 2019 level in 2021 (24.2%), 2022 (23.1%), and 2023 (23.2%) (Figure 2.1.3).

Meanwhile, industry, which has manufacturing as its biggest sub-sector, registered slight increase in its share of total employment for the same period. From a 16.2 percent share in 2001, its share increased by almost 3 percentage points to 19.1 percent in 2019. In absolute terms, this means that 3.4 million workers were added in the industry during the past 19 years. However, COVID-19 slashed around more than 900 thousand jobs in the sector, that is, from 8.11 million in 2019 to 7.2 million in 2020.

Employment recovery started to manifest in 2021, as the number of employed persons increased by 886 thousand to almost 8.1 million. In 2022, an additional 436 thousand workers were added in the sector as employed persons rose to more than 8.5 million.

Figure 2.1.2
Key Employment Indicators (%), Philippines: 2005-2023

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, Labor Force Surveys 2005-2023



Industry registered 8.43 million employed persons in 2023, accounting for 17.5 percent share of total employment. The increases in the number of employed persons indicate recovery of industrial jobs lost during the pandemic (Figures 2.1.3 and 2.1.4).

On the other hand, services, which has wholesale and retail trade as its largest sub-sector, remained the biggest sectoral employer with 59.3 percent share in 2023. This represented a 12.7 percentage points increase from the 2001 level. The pandemic stopped the steady and consistent increase in the share of industry to total employment during the past 19 years, as its share shrank by 1.1 percentage points from 58 percent in 2019 to 56.9 in 2020 (Figure 2.1.3). This is translated to a 2.2 million decrease in the number of employed persons during the same period. However, employment recovery in the sector started strong in 2021 with 2.82 million additional workers. In 2023, the share of services in total employment was registered at 59.3 percent, which corresponds to a 28.56 million employed persons, the highest since 2001 (Figures 2.1.3 and 2.1.4).

Sectoral underemployment. But while services continued to account for biggest employment, it also accounted for the largest share of underemployment since 2015 (41.8%). Underemployment in the sector reached an all-time high of 49.6 percent in 2023, compared to just 34.7 percent in 2002, the lowest ever recorded during the past 22 years. In absolute number, this means almost 2.95 million workers in the sector were underemployed in 2023, compared to only 1.77 million in 2002.

Meanwhile, underemployment in industry declined by 0.8 percent from 19 percent in 2022 to 18.2 percent in 2023. In contrast, underemployment in agriculture rose by 0.5 percent from 31.7 percent in 2022 to 32.2 percent in 2023 (Figure 2.1.5). This means that in 2023, more than 1 million and 1.9 million workers in industry and agriculture, respectively, like their counterparts in the services sector, sought additional jobs and worked longer hours to augment their incomes.

Figure 2.1.6 presents the actual numbers of underemployed persons by sector for the period 2001-March 2024.

Figure 2.1.3
Employed Persons by Sector (%), Philippines: 2001-March 2024

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, LFS 2001-2023

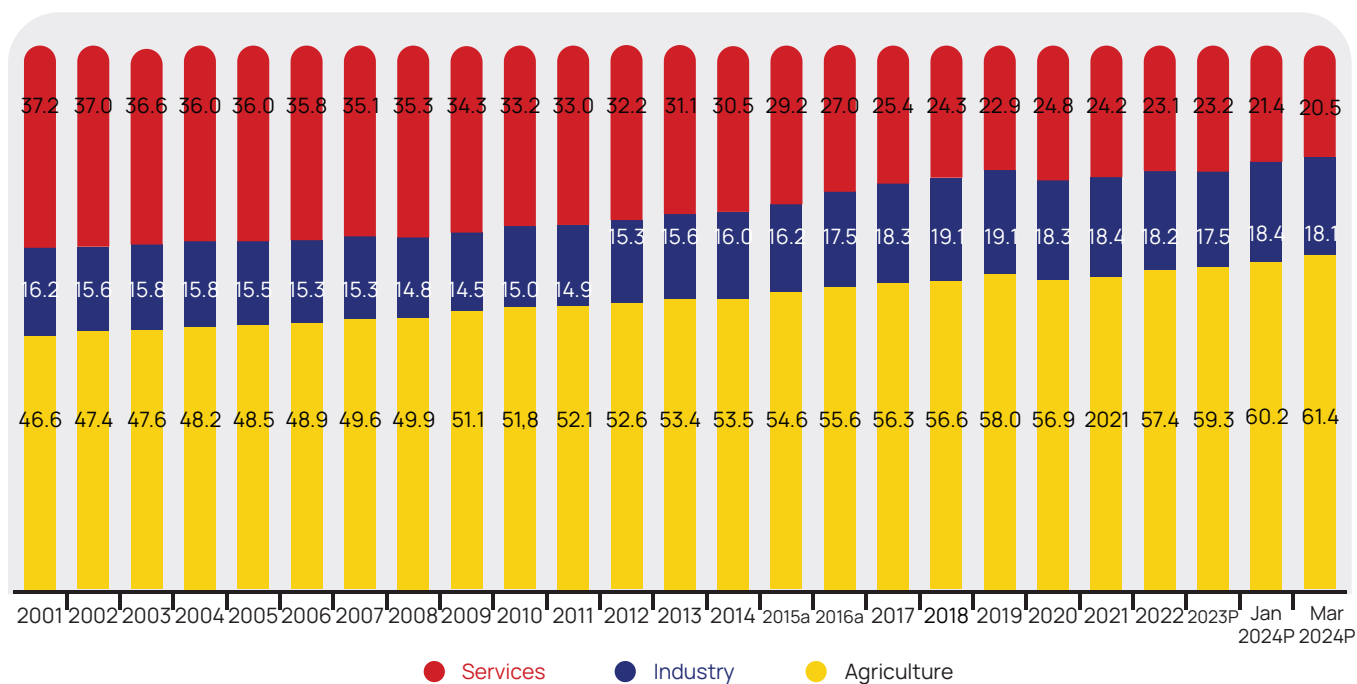


Figure 2.1.4
Employed Persons by Sector (in '000), Philippines: 2001-March 2024

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, LFS 2001-2023

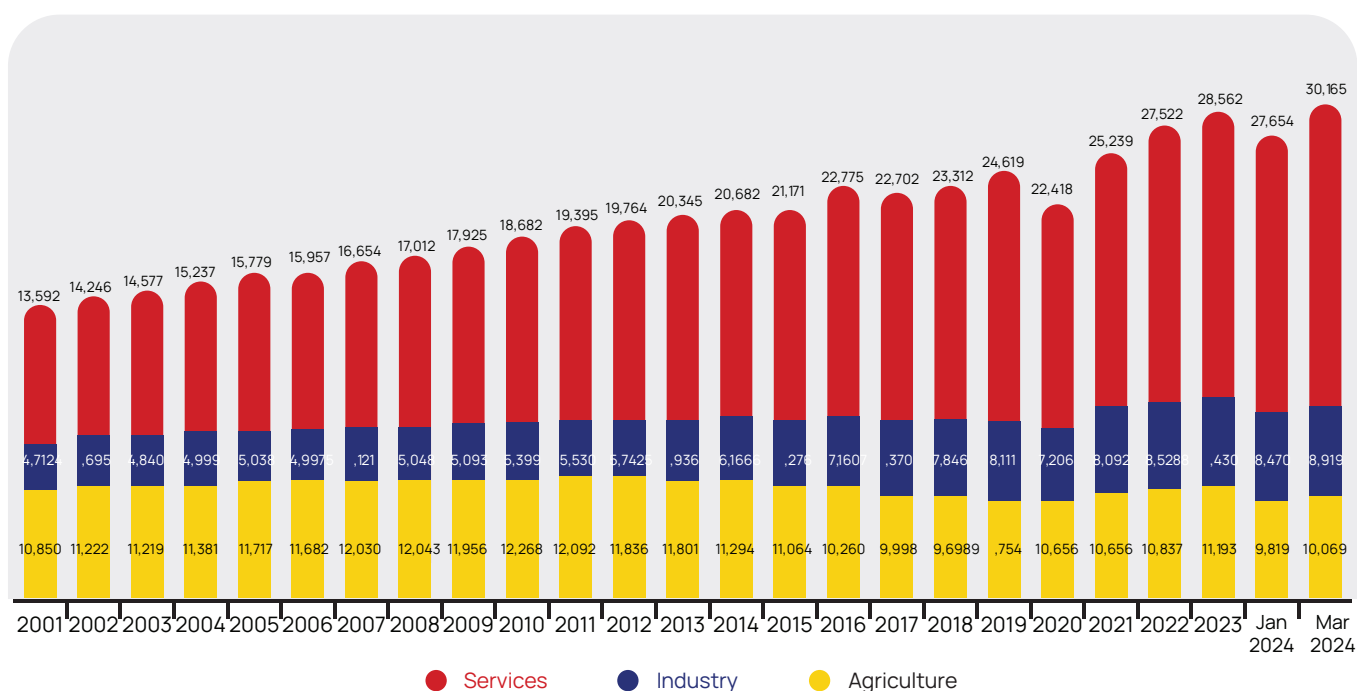
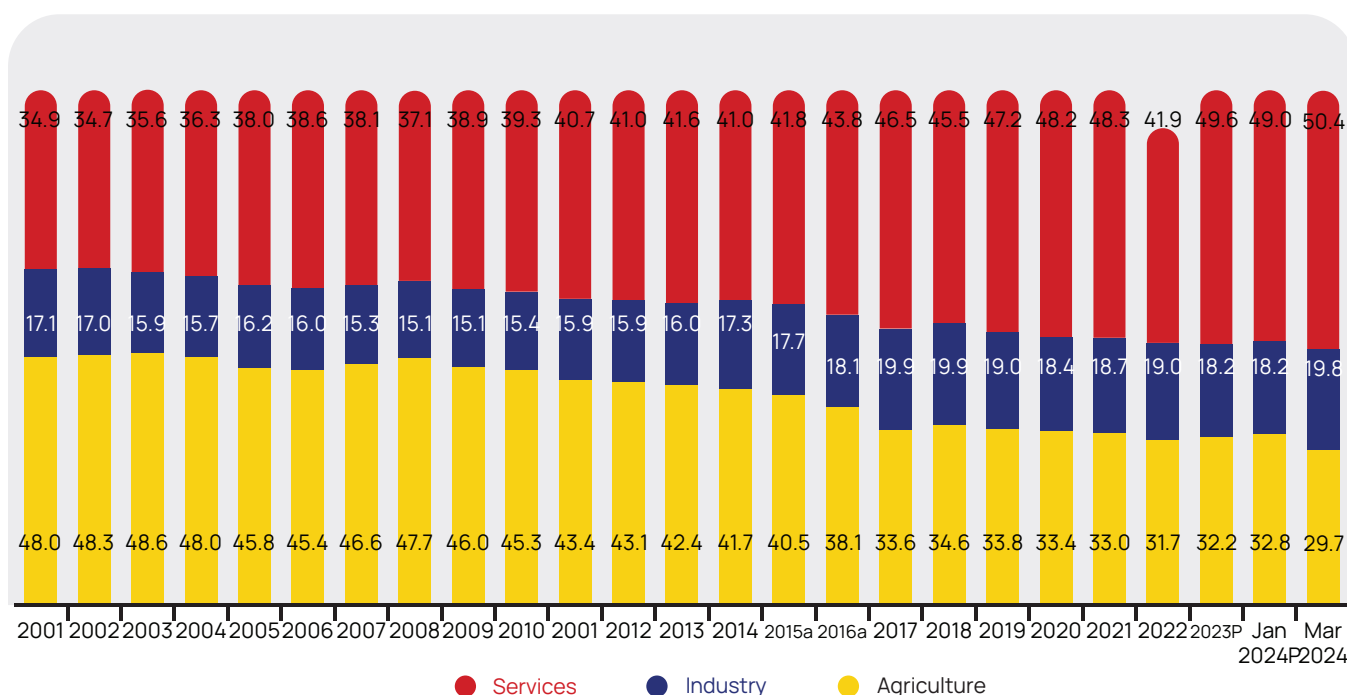


Figure 2.1.5
Underemployed Persons by Sector (%), Philippines: 2001-March 2024

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, LFS 2001-March 2024P



Employment by class of worker. In terms of employment by class of worker, data show that the share of vulnerable employment in total employment has generally declined—although in a fluctuating pattern—during the past 23 years. In 2001, for instance, the share of unpaid family workers to total employment was recorded at 13 percent. In 2019, a year before the pandemic, its share went down by more than 56 percentage points to just 5.7 percent. This is equivalent to a 1.41 million decrease in the number of unpaid family workers (Figures 2.1.7 and 2.1.8).

However, the pandemic reversed this positive trend, as the share of unpaid family workers in total employment started to rise starting in 2020 at 6.3 percent and in 2021 at 7.3 percent. In 2023, its share was registered at 8 percent, the same level recorded in 2016. In actual numbers, there were around 3.85 million unpaid family workers in 2023, which was higher by 190 thousand compared to the 3.65 million recorded in 2022 (Figures 2.1.7 and 2.1.8).

In comparison, wage and salary workers accounted for 49.5 percent of total employment in 2001. This share increased by 15 percentage points in 2019 when salaried workers comprised 64.6 percent of

total employment. However, the massive job losses in 2020 were most pronounced among wage and salary workers, as its share to total employment declined by 1.7 percent to 62.9 percent, equivalent to a 2.36 million job losses.

Employment in the sector showed sign of gradual recovery starting in 2021 with 62.2 percent share. In 2023, wage and salary workers surpassed the 30 million mark for the first time, which corresponds to a 62.5 percent share in total employment. Correspondingly, there was a reduction in the share of self-employed workers in total employment over the same period, that is, from 27.7 percent in 2022 to 27.2 percent in 2023 (Figures 2.1.7 and 2.1.8). However, both unpaid family workers and self-employed workers registered increases in actual numbers for the three-year period 2021-2023 compared to pre-pandemic levels (Figure 2.1.8).

Wage and salary workers and job quality. A succession of Labor Force Surveys conducted over the years show that private establishments, with 78.9 percent share in 2019, have consistently accounted for the biggest share in employment among wage and salary workers during the past 15 years. Government-owned and controlled corporations also accounted for a sizable share at

Figure 2.1.6
Underemployed Persons by Sector (in '000), Philippines: 2001-March 2024

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, LFS 2001-March 2024

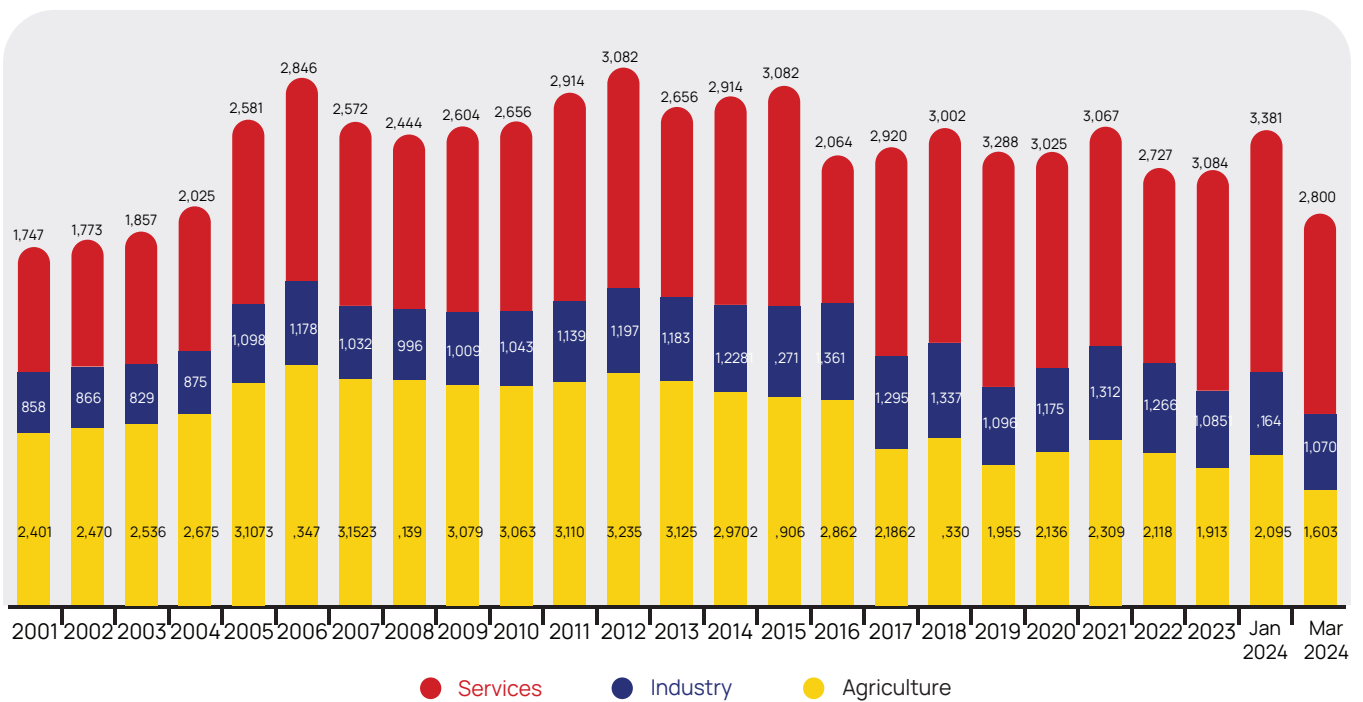


Figure 2.1.7
Employment by Class of Worker (%), Philippines: 2001-March 2024

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, LFS 2001-March 2024

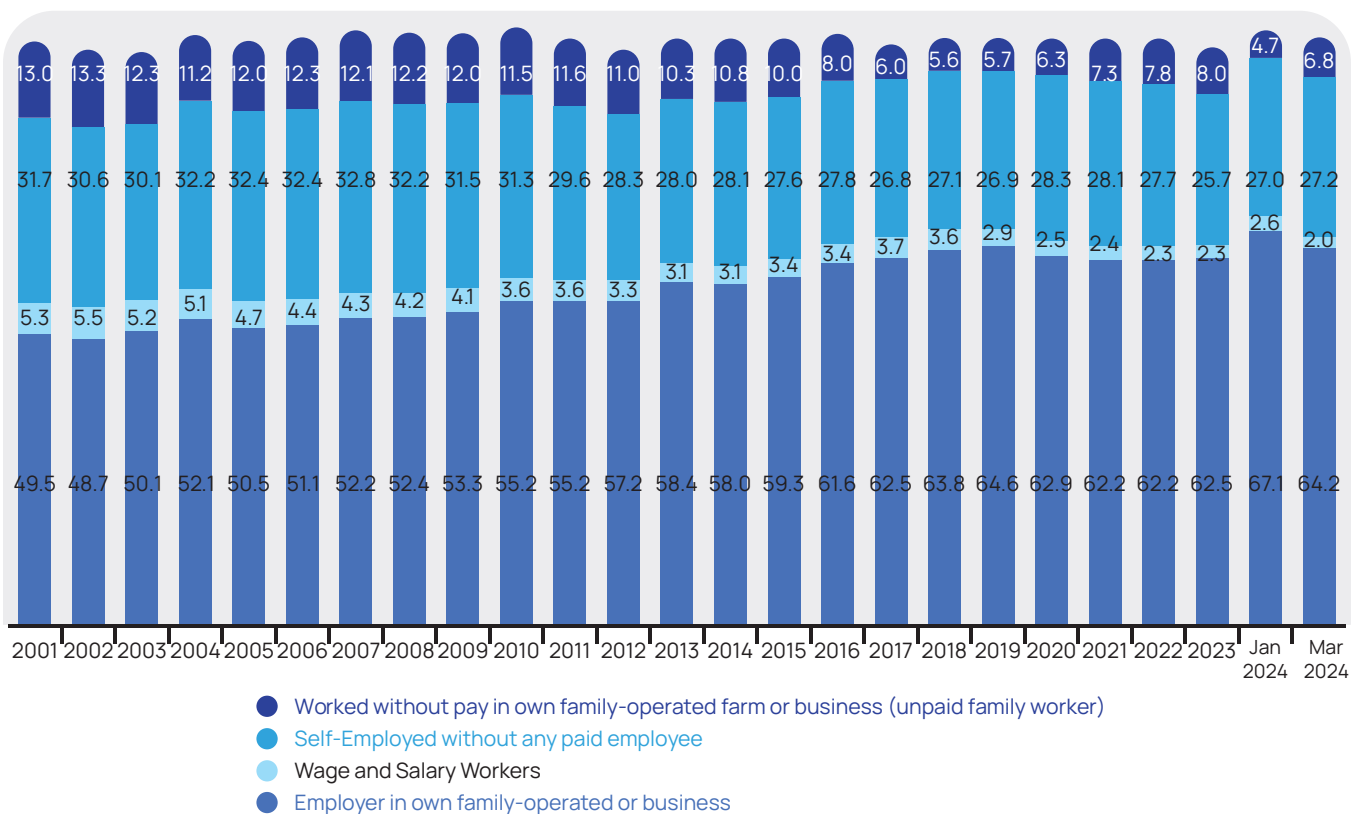
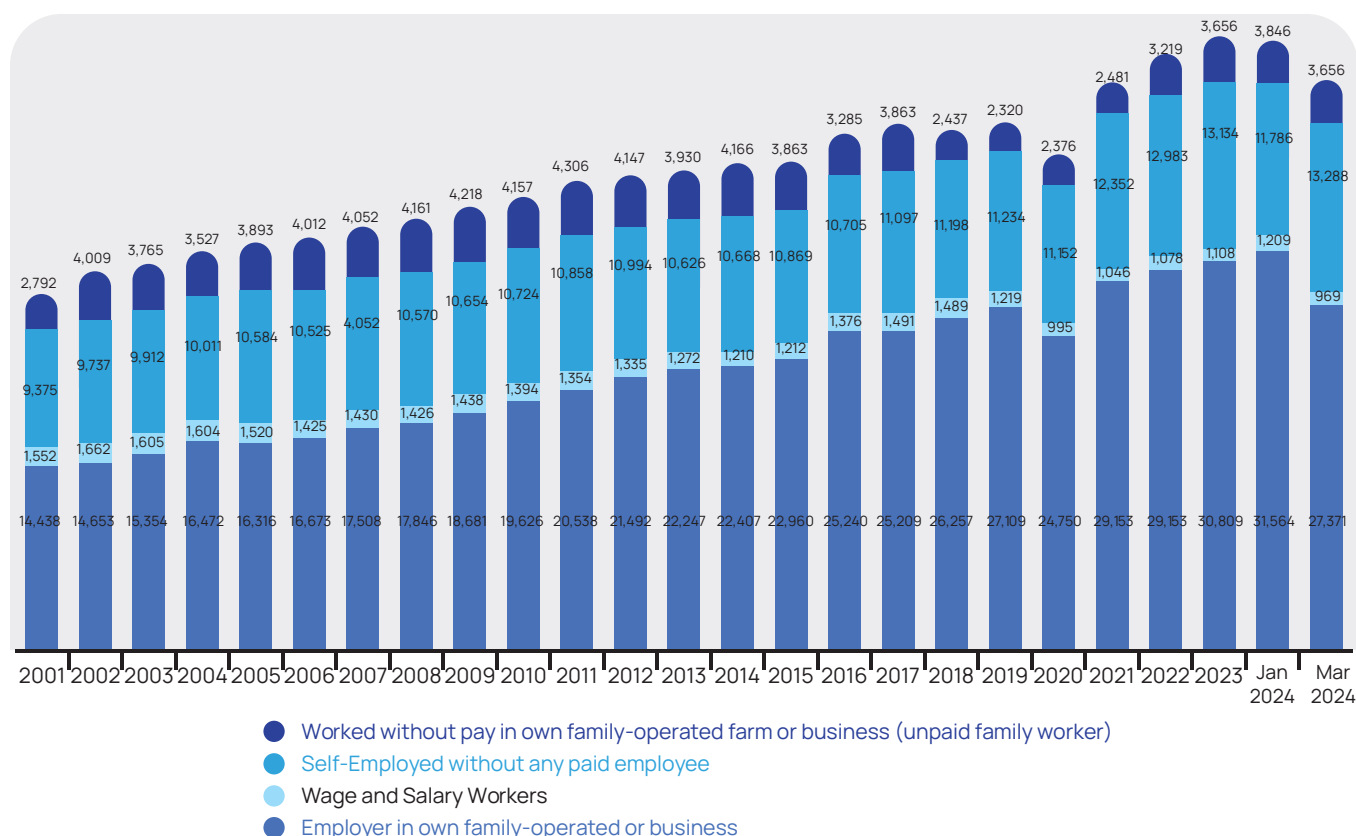


Figure 2.1.8
Employment by Class of Worker (in '000), Philippines: 2001-March 2024

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, LFS 2001-March 2024



14 percent, with private households accounting for 6.7 percent share for the same year (Figure 2.1.9).

The share of wage and salary employment to total employment in the past decade prior to the pandemic had been increasing, indicating rising quality of employment in the economy. The pandemic stopped this positive trend due to business closures, resulting in massive termination of employment. With further economic recovery and growth projections, it is expected that employment opportunities in this sector will again expand.

Employment in the public sector. Based on the Civil Service Commission's Inventory of Government Human Resource, the number of government employees appears to have grown faster in the past seven years. This expansion is attributed to the hiring of population-based personnel such as teachers and police officers; additional hiring by local government units due to more devolved functions and responsibilities; and the phenomenal rise in the number of job orders (JOs) and contract-of-service (COS) personnel in

government (Table 2.1.10). The proliferation of JOs and COS in the public sector is a conundrum among policymakers. The non-regular nature of their employment excludes them from social security coverage and entitlement to mandatory benefits enjoyed by permanent government workers. To the extent that JOs and COS do not meet the basic civil service qualification standards, unabated use of such arrangements can undermine the system of meritocracy in the civil service.

Further, based on the 2023 DBM Staffing Summary, the total number of permanent positions in government for Fiscal Year 2023 is 1,943,316, of which 1,772,512 (91.2%) positions are filled and 170,804 (8.8%) are unfilled. This means that roughly 1 out of 10 authorized positions is unfilled.¹¹

¹¹ Department of Budget and Management, Staffing Summary of the National Government - FYs 2021, 2022, and 2023. <https://dbm.gov.ph/wp-content/uploads/Staffing/STAFFING2023/Table-I-Staffing-Summary.pdf>.

Figure 2.1.9
Employment by Subclasses of Wage and Salary Workers (%), Philippines: 2005-March 2024

Source: PSA, Labor Force Survey

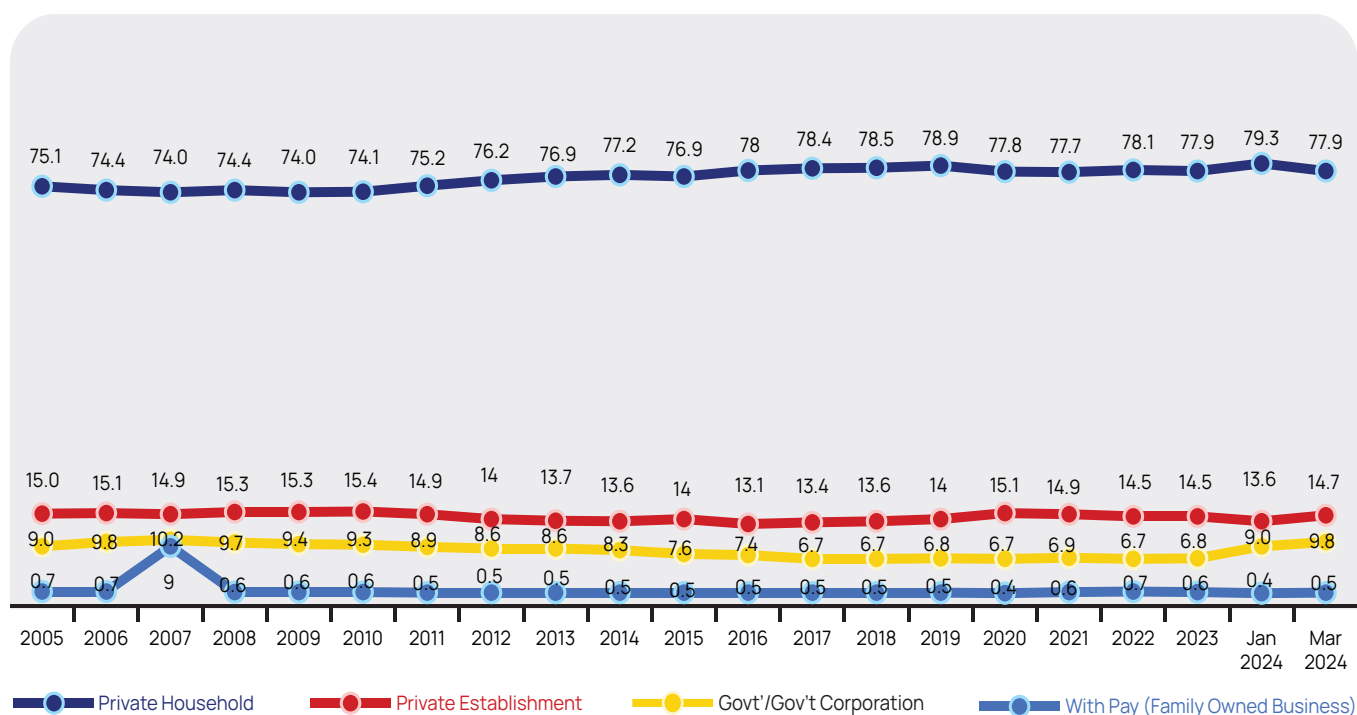
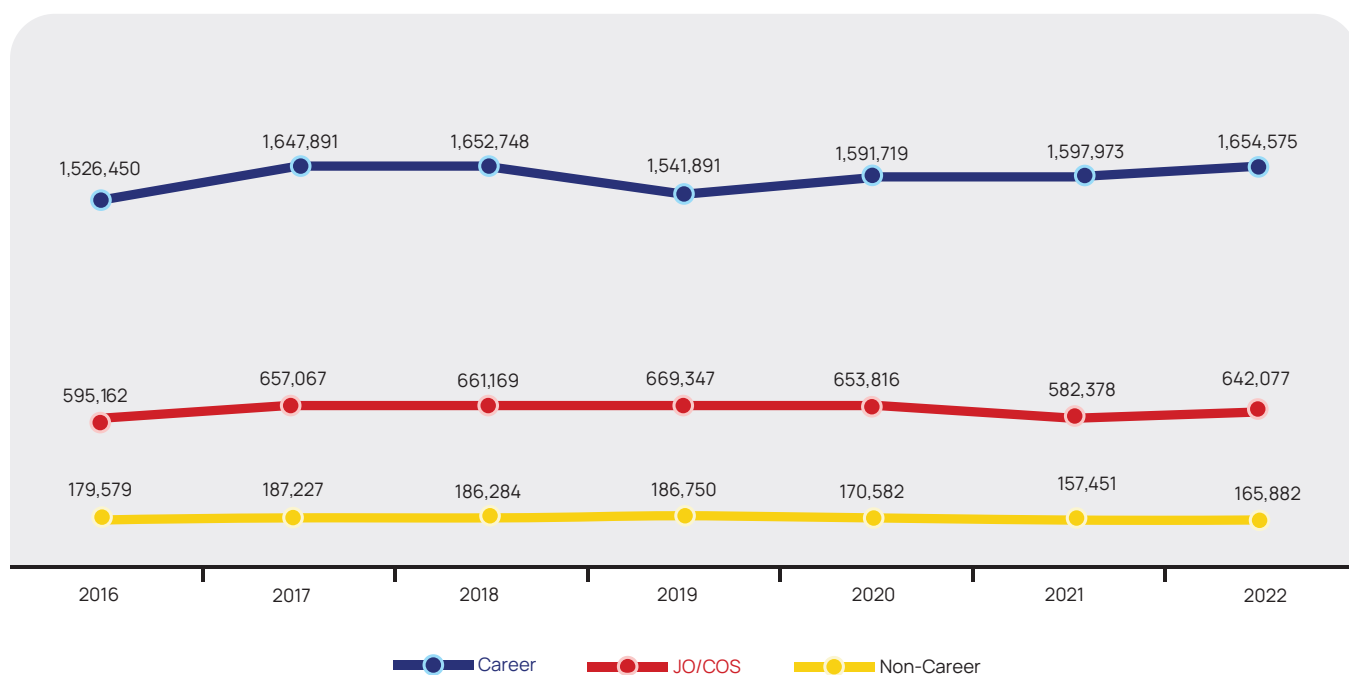


Figure 2.1.10
Inventory of Government Human Resource, 2016-2022

Source: Civil Service Commission, Inventory of Government Human Resource 2022



Rightsizing the bureaucracy. The national government has long been committed to rightsizing the bureaucracy to promote good governance and to improve bureaucratic efficiency. The PDP calls for the passage of a law rightsizing the government to facilitate transformational improvements and to streamline the functions, mandates, structure, and staffing of departments and agencies and simplify systems and processes to deliver public goods and services in the most efficient, effective, and economical manner. The overarching goal is to recruit, develop and retain competent, motivated, agile and resilient public servants who will ensure greater accountability and promote integrity in the government.¹² However, some sectors, including public sector unions, have raised concerns on the possibility that rightsizing may displace government personnel.¹³

Employment in MSMEs.¹⁴ In 2018, 5.71 million people were employed in micro-, small- and medium-sized establishments (MSMEs). In 2022, employment in MSMEs decreased by almost 2

percent to around 5.6 million people (Table 2.1.1). In 2022, MSMEs accounted for 65.1 percent of total employment in all establishments, which is 1.9 percent higher than the 63.19 percent recorded in 2018.

In terms of sectoral concentration, Table 2.1.2 shows that in 2022, MSMEs accounted for 99.59 percent of all the establishments in the country. Across the three economic sectors, the configuration is as follows: services, 99.69 percent; industry, 98.98 percent; and agriculture sector, 98.57 percent.

On the other hand, Table 2.1.3 provides a breakdown of total employment across MSMEs by sector in 2022. MSMEs employed seven out of every ten workers in the services sector. In contrast, only about half (49.34%) of employed workers in the industry sector were working in MSMEs, while nearly six out of ten workers (58.55%) in the agriculture sector were employed in MSMEs.

Table 2.1.1
Number of Establishments and Employment by Size of Establishments,
2018 vis-à-vis 2022

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, 2018 and 2022 List of Establishments (LE)¹⁵

Notes. The statistical unit in the LE is the establishment, defined as an economic unit: 1. under a single ownership or control, i.e., under a single legal entity; 2. engages in one or predominantly one kind of economic activity; and 3. at a single fixed physical location.

Size	Number of establishments		Percent share (%)		Total employment		Percent share (%)	
	2018	2022	2018	2022	2018	2022	2018	2022
Micro	887,272	1,004,195	88.45	90.49	2,610,221	2,816,091	32.86	32.69
Small	106,175	96,464	10.58	8.69	2,445,111	2,183,667	27.04	25.35
Medium	4,895	4,484	0.49	0.40	658,930	607,990	7.29	7.05
Large	4,769	4,541	0.48	0.41	3,328,801	3,006,821	36.81	34.90
Total	1,003,111	1,109,684	100	100	9,043,063	8,614,569	100	100
MSME	998,342	1,105,143	99.5	99.59	5,714,262	5,607,748	63.19	65.10

¹² PDP 2023-2028, Chapter 14-Practice Good Governance and Improve Bureaucratic Efficiency, pp. 321 and 329.

¹³ On March 14, 2023, House Bill No. 7240, otherwise known as the proposed National Government Rightsizing Act, was passed on third reading in the House of Representatives. At least four counterpart measures are pending in the Senate. The National Government Rightsizing Program (NGRP) is a priority of the administration.

¹⁴ The Philippines Statistics Authority classifies an enterprise as a micro enterprise if it has less than 10 employees, small if it has 10-99 employees, medium with 100-199 employees, and large if it has 200 or more employees.

¹⁵ The List of Establishments (LE) of the Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA) is a register containing records of establishments operating in the Philippines that are captured through door-to-door canvassing, lists from secondary sources, and information from the submitted survey reports. The LE is maintained by the PSA primarily to serve as the source of sampling frame for all the establishment-based surveys and censuses conducted by the PSA. See Explanatory Notes of PSA. https://psa.gov.ph/sites/default/files/attachments/ird/-pressrelease/3_List%20of%20Establishments%20Explanatory%20Notes_rev31dec_RRDH_CRD.pdf.

Table 2.1.2
Number of Establishments by Size and Sector, 2022

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, 2021 List of Establishments

Sector	Number of Establishments by Size and Sector							
	Micro	Small	Medium	Total MSMEs	Share %	Large	Share %	TOTAL
Philippines	1,004,195	96,464	4,484	1,105,143	99.59	4,541	0.41	1,109,684
Agriculture, Forestry, and Fishery	6,474	2,674	177	9,325	98.57	135	1.43	9,460
Industry	125,225	14,859	1,390	141,474	98.98	1,459	1.02	142,933
Services	872,496	78,931	2,917	954,344	99.69	2,947	0.31	957,291

Table 2.1.3
Total Employment by Size of Establishment and Sector, 2022

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, 2021 List of Establishments (LE)

Sector	Total Employment by Size of Establishment and Sector							
	Micro	Small	Medium	Total MSMEs	Share %	Large	Share %	TOTAL
Philippines	2,816,091	2,183,667	607,990	5,607,748	65.1	3,006,821	34.9	8,614,569
Agriculture, Forestry, and Fishery	22,799	69,076	23,722	115,597	58.55	81,822	41.45	197,419
Industry	366,369	403,704	190,518	960,591	49.34	986,484	50.66	1,947,075
Services	2,426,923	1,710,867	393,750	4,531,560	70.04	1,938,515	29.96	6,470,075

Labor productivity. All broad sectors have registered increased overall labor productivity from 2010 to 2019, with shifts of employment away from agriculture towards industry and to a greater extent to the services sector. The growth in economy-wide labor productivity in the past ten years has been primarily driven by the productivity growth in the services sector (Figure 2.1.11). The World Bank notes that the overall enhancement of educational attainment of the workforce must have also contributed to productivity growth in the country.¹⁶

During the pandemic, certain industries¹⁷ such as information and communication and financial and insurance activities, remained resilient in terms of employment and productivity. This can be associated with the high proportion of occupations with telework potential, or the degree to which

jobs can be feasibly done off-site or at home, in these industries, in the context of strict mobility restrictions.¹⁸ Overall, it was observed that labor productivity started to recover in 2022, but was still below pre-pandemic levels (Figure 2.1.11).

¹⁶ World Bank. 2023. *Philippine Jobs Report: Shaping a Better Future for the Filipino Workforce*.

¹⁷ Generalao, I.N. 2021. *Measuring the telework potential of jobs: evidence from the International Standard Classification of Occupations*. *Philippine Review of Economics*, 58(1&2): 92-127. DOI:10.37907/5ERP1202JD, as cited in ILO. forthcoming. *Decent Work Country Diagnostics: Philippines*.

¹⁸ Asian Development Bank. 2021. *COVID-19 and Labor Markets in Southeast Asia: Impacts on Indonesia, Malaysia, the Philippines, Thailand, and Viet Nam*, as cited in ILO. forthcoming. *Decent Work Country Diagnostics: Philippines*.

Figure 2.1.11
Labor Productivity Levels (Peso/Employed Person) and Growth Rates (%), Philippines: 2010-2022

Source: National Accounts, PSA

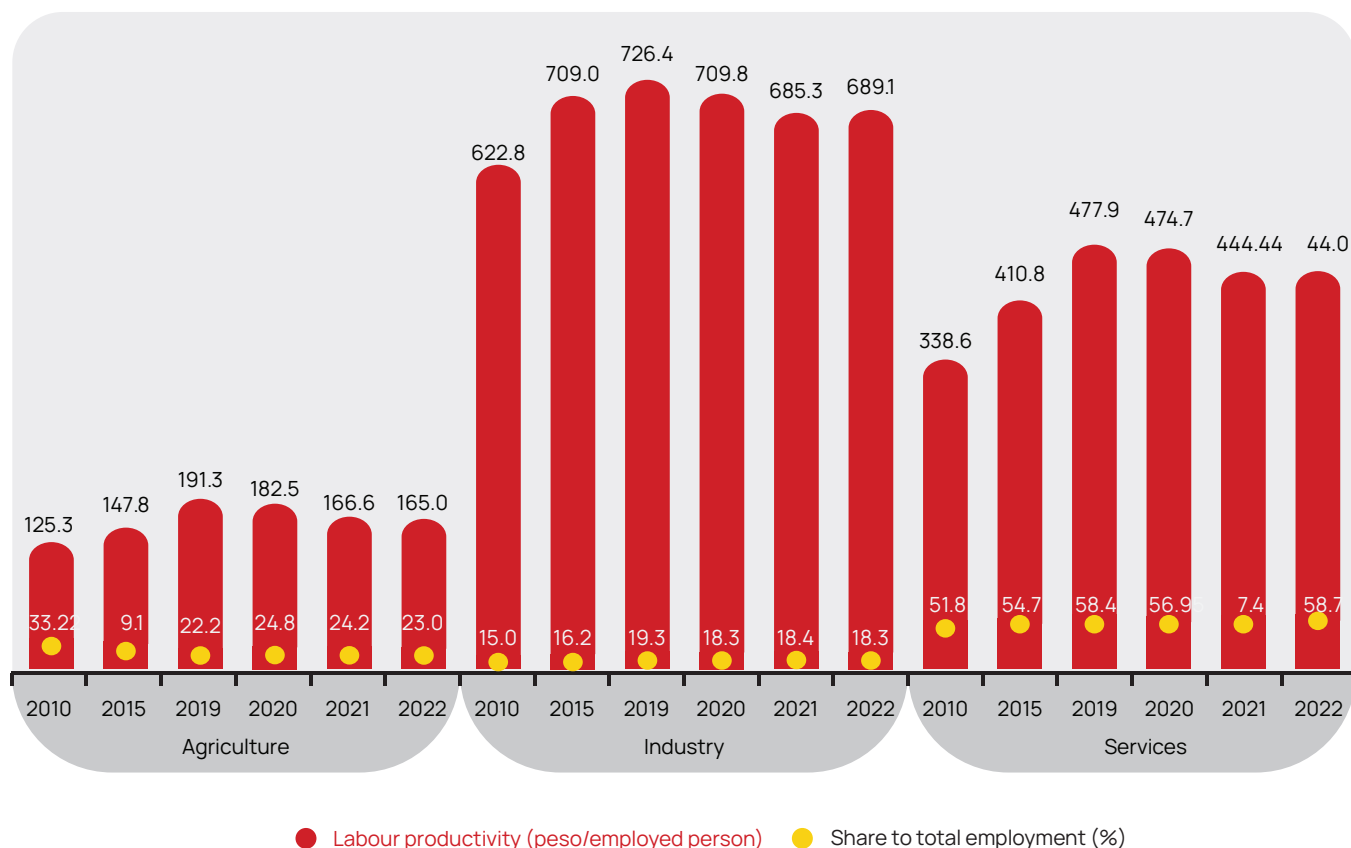
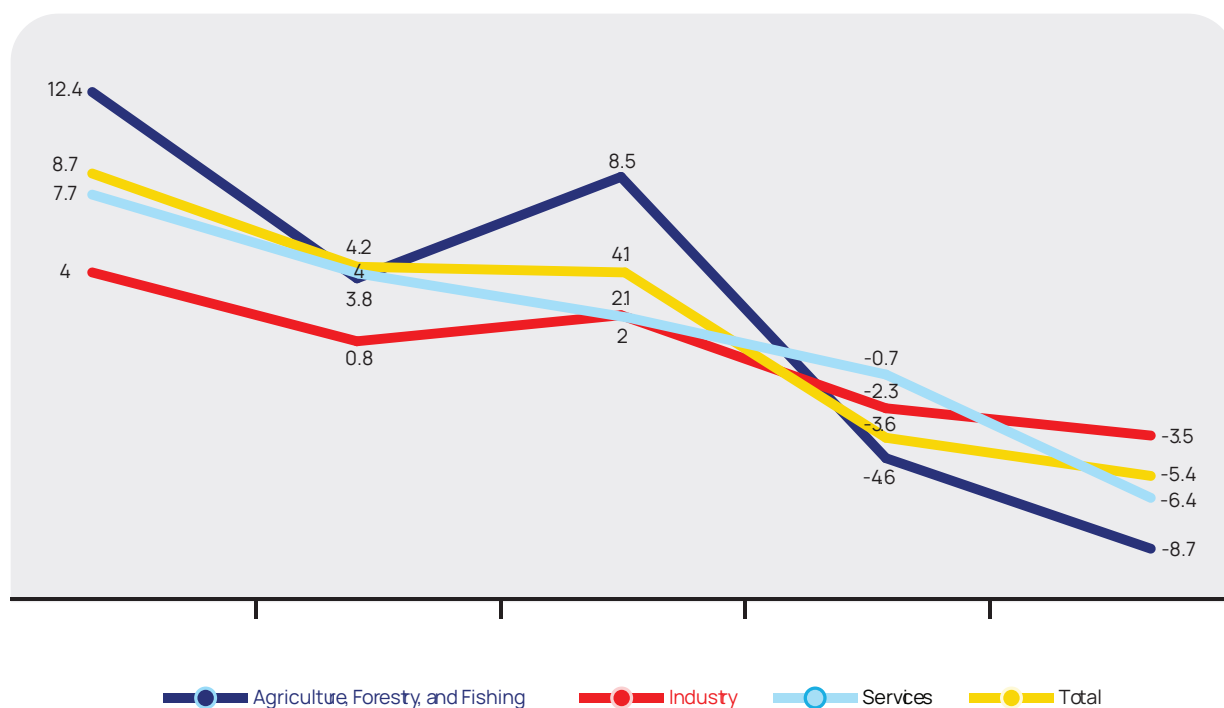


Figure 2.1.12
Labor Productivity by Sector (Growth Rates, in %), Philippines: 2017-2021

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, National Accounts



Youth not in employment, education or training.

The share of the youth not in employment, education or training (NEET), comprised mostly of inactive non-students, has been declining prior to the pandemic. In 2019, the proportion of youth NEET to total youth population was 18.8 percent, which is lower by 6.5 percentage points than in 2010 at 25.2 percent. However, the pandemic aggravated the NEET situation in 2020 (21.1%) due to closures of schools and training institutions, and the closing down of entry level jobs in the labor market, which also included internships and apprenticeships. Moving towards recovery in 2021, as the economy as well as schools and training institutions gradually reopened, youth NEET situation has started to improve and mostly back to its pre-pandemic level. The declining proportions in NEET suggest that the young are increasingly participating in training (Figure 2.1.13).

Nonetheless, the youth continue to face challenges in their employment prospects, resulting in persistent inactivity rates in education, training, and employment. The COVID-19 crisis has resulted in multiple shocks for the youth—including disruptions in their education and training, employment and earnings, and increased job search constraints. For this reason, the PDP encourages education and training institutions, and the private sector to proactively seek interventions and programs that promote employability of the youth, particularly those in senior high school. The PDP considers TVET as an effective mechanism to address the high incidence of youth NEET. Youth employability programs like the Special Program for Employment of Students (SPES), JobStart and Government Internship Program (GIP) of the DOLE are also seen as important interventions to open employment opportunities for the youth and other disadvantaged, marginalized, and groups in vulnerable situations.

NEET gender gap. As shown in Figure 2.1.13, the gender gap in the NEET situation has narrowed during the past 16 years. In 2012, the gender gap difference was at an all-time high of 14.4 percentage points (p.p.). In 2019, the difference was down to only 10.3 p.p. Despite the pandemic, the gender gap still fell by 2.8 p.p. to 7.5 in 2020, by 1 p.p. to 6.5 p.p. in 2021, and by 1.3 p.p. in 2022.

Sustaining the gains in closing the gender gap in the NEET situation will require gender-responsive approaches in labor market transitions, such as school-to-work and work-to-work transitions.

In analyzing the gender gap among youth not in employment, education, or training (NEET), it is essential to acknowledge the progress made over the years. The narrowing gender gap, as evidenced by a decrease in the disparity from 14.4 percentage points in 2012 to 6.5 percentage points in 2021, reflects the success of targeted interventions aimed at increasing female participation in the labor market. However, sustained efforts are needed to address persisting challenges, particularly in the context of the COVID-19 pandemic, which has disproportionately affected young women. Gender-responsive approaches should be further strengthened to support transitions from school to work and within the labor market, ensuring that both male and female youth are equally equipped to participate in economic activities

Education, skills and professional development interventions. Recent data show that around 3.63 million individuals, mostly part of the youth group, have benefited from government interventions on basic and higher education, TVET maritime education, and professional development, including the DOLE's youth employability programs (Table 2.1.4). The outputs of basic and higher education, TVET and professional development systems represent the labor supply of the country.

Employability of the workforce. Based on a series of Labor Force Surveys, high school graduates comprised the largest share of employed persons from 2015 to 2020. College and elementary graduates also accounted for significant shares (Figure 2.1.14).

Profile of Senior High School graduates. Available data from the Department of Education's Learner Information System show that the Academic Track registered the highest share of SHS graduates from SY 2017-2018 to SY 2021-2022, followed by the Technical-Vocational-Livelihood Track. Meanwhile, the Arts & Design Track and Sports Track had a consistent low share among SHS graduates (Figure 2.1.15).

Figure 2.1.13
Share of Youth Not in Employment, Education, or Training (NEET)
by Sex (%), Philippines: 2006-January 2023

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, National Accounts

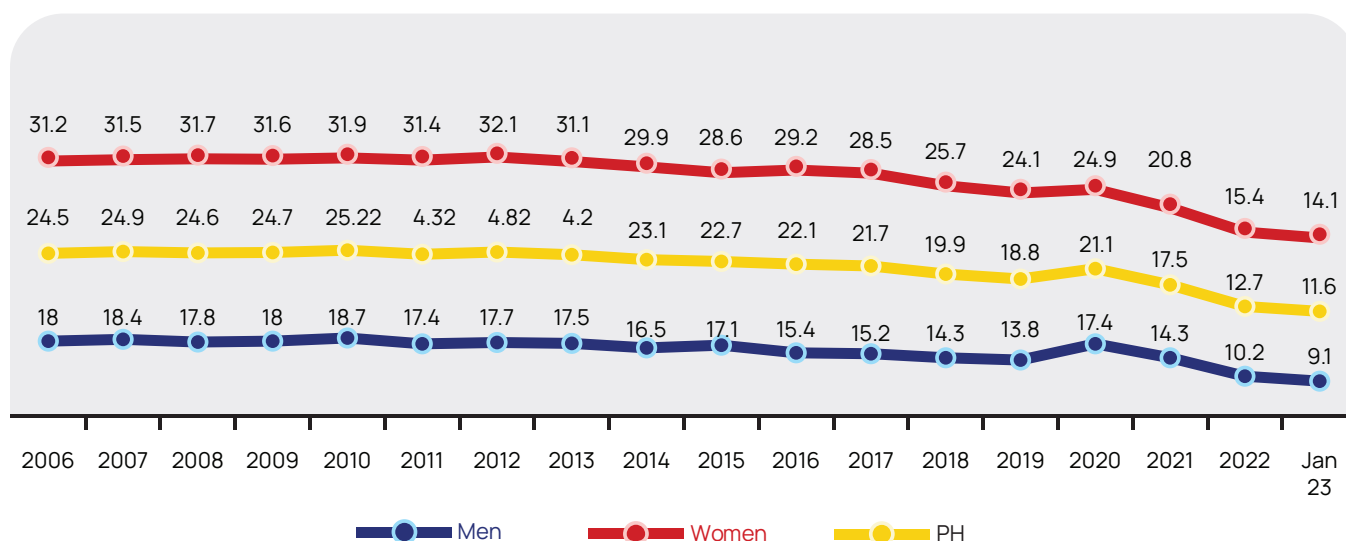


Table 2.1.4
Beneficiaries of Education, Skills, Maritime and Professional Development Interventions,
Various Years

Sources: BLE, DepEd, CHED, TESDA, PRC, and NMP administrative data, various years

BENEFICIARIES	TOTAL	MALE	FEMALE
Youth Employability Program Beneficiaries (2022)	184,376	75,043	109,333
Senior High School Graduates (S.Y. 2021-22)	1,613,220	754,062	859,158
College Graduates (A.Y. 2018-19)	796,576	321,252	475,324
TVET Graduates (2022, Q4)	1,024, 266	488,126	536,140
Professional Licensure Exam Passers (2022)	313,795	105,027	209,421
Maritime Trainees (2022, Q4)	12,530	11,548	982

SHS curriculum exits. The DepEd also conducted a National Tracer Study among SHS graduates for SY 2017-2018, the first batch to graduate from SHS. Table 2.1.5 shows the distribution of SHS graduates based on their curriculum exits.

Majority of the graduates surveyed (95%) are within the desired outcomes in terms of curriculum exit. Around 83 percent of the graduates pursued higher education, 10 percent were already employed, one percent opted for entrepreneurship, and 0.42 percent underwent middle-level skills training. Meanwhile, 5 percent or 5 to 6 in every 100 graduates were found to be not in any of the desired outcomes.

Employability of SHS graduates. A recent study conducted by JobStreet Philippines in partnership with DOLE,¹⁹ found that hirers (employers) have a better general understanding of the SHS (K-12) program post-pandemic compared to the pre-pandemic period.

Also, 6 out of 10 respondents indicated willingness to hire SHS graduates. However, the study also noted the lack of job-ready skills and the need for upskilling among SHS graduates so that they are not relegated to low-skilled jobs and manual-intensive roles.

¹⁹ The study, titled "Senior High School Survey Report 2023", released on 10 September 2023, is a collaboration between DOLE and Jobstreet Philippines.

Figure 2.1.14
Employment by Highest Grade Completed (in '000), Philippines: 2015-2020

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, National Accounts

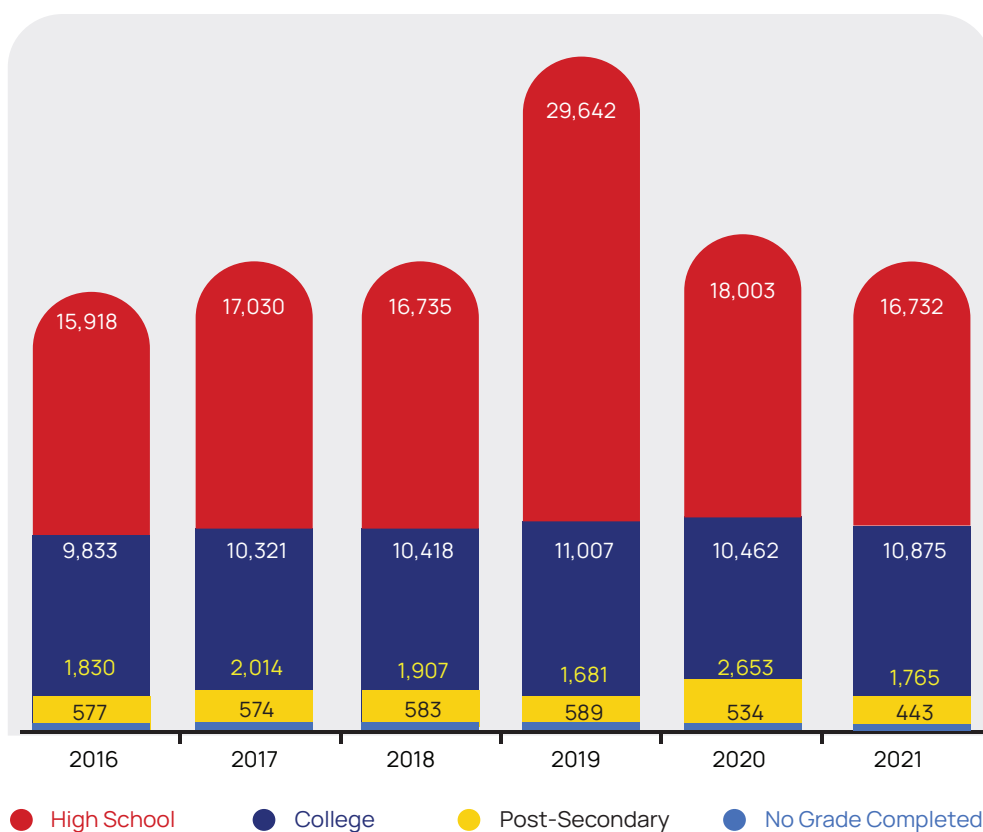
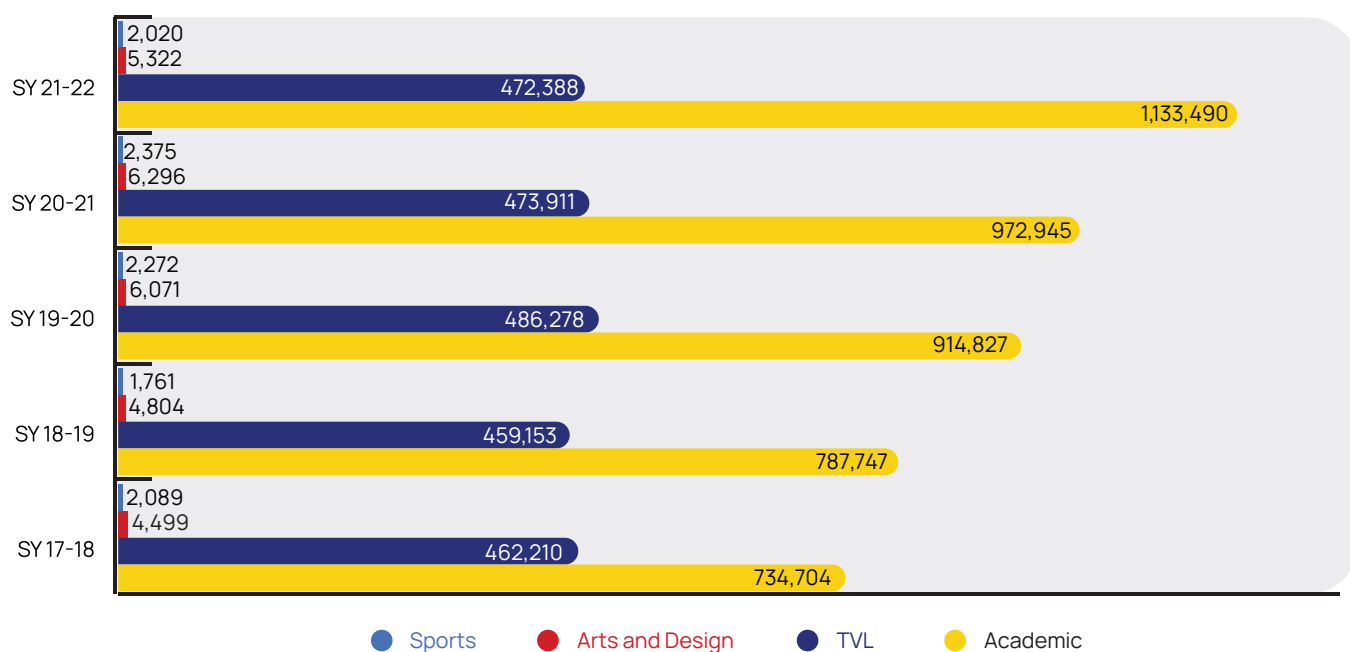


Figure 2.1.15
Number of Graduates in Senior High School, SY 2021-2022
Based on End of School Year (EOSY) LIS Cut-off Date as of 7 September 2022

Source: Department of Education



The employability of SHS graduates hinges on the alignment between their acquired skills and the demands of the labor market. Studies have identified ‘job-ready’ skills such as critical thinking, problem-solving, communication, and technical competencies relevant to specific industries as crucial for employment. However, the current SHS curriculum requires enhancement to better equip students with these skills, ensuring they are not limited to low-skilled or manual-intensive roles. There is a need for a stronger collaboration between educational institutions and industry players to continuously update the curriculum and provide targeted training that meets the evolving needs of employers.

Distribution of TVET graduates by sector and sex.²⁰ The distributional pattern of TVET graduates across sectors has not changed since the 2016 survey. In 2020, 21.64 percent of graduates completed agriculture, forestry, and fishery (AFF), with the tourism sector, which includes hotel and restaurant, electrical & electronics, and automotive and land transportation accounting for 16.08 percent, 9.38 percent, and 8.98 percent of the total graduates, respectively. Only tourism is female-dominated out of these top four sectors (Table 2.1.6).

Employment of TVET graduates. TESDA conducts regular tracer studies on the employment of TVET graduates. Results of the 2021 survey round show that TVET graduates have become more employable and competitive with a notable recorded employment rate of 78.6 percent in 2021. The employment rate was 68.6 percent in 2018, 84.2 percent in 2019, and 70.5 percent in 2020 (Table 2.1.7).

Employment of TVET graduates by sector. The same study also show the estimated employment rate of TVET graduates by sector. From these data, it can be inferred that there is increasing need for highly skilled workers in IT-BPM, construction, logistics, agriculture, and health, sectors expected to support digital transformation and sustainability. Examples of occupations in human health/health care include barangay health workers, contact tracers, caregivers, nursing assistants, and healthcare assistants (Table 2.1.8).

TVET infrastructure in priority sectors. The results of the TESDA’s Workplace Skills and Satisfaction Survey showed the performance of these sectors, particularly in terms of the number of training regulations, registered programs, enrollment, and graduates. For the IT-BPM sector, for instance, there were 19 training regulations and 518 registered programs as of mid-2022. For the period 2017-2021, more than 478,000 students enrolled in IT-BPM-related training courses, of which close to 438,000 graduated. Increasing enrollment has been observed in these sectors with majority of those enrolled having completed their respective programs (Table 2.1.9).

In terms of employment, the IT-BPM sector employed 1.22 million full-time employees (FTEs) in 2018 and 1.29 million FTEs in 2019. The pandemic did not diminish the capacity of the sector to generate employment as full-time jobs continued to grow.

²⁰ NTESDP 2023-2028, p. 36.

Table 2.1.5
Distribution of Graduates in Senior High School, SY 2017-2018

Source: Department of Education, National Tracer Study of SHS Graduates of SY 2017-2018

Curriculum Exit	Percent Share
Higher Education	82.67
Employment	10.22
Entrepreneurship	1.30
Middle-Level Skills	0.42
Not in any exit	5.39

Table 2.1.6
Weighted Distribution of TVET Graduates by Sector, by Sex. Philippines: 2020

a. Percentage over the row total; b. Percentage over the total number of graduates
Source: NTESDP 2023-2028, p. 36.

Sector	Female		Male		Total	
	Freq	% ^a	Freq	% ^a	Freq	% ^b
Agriculture Forestry and Fishery	68,187	53.28	59,800	46.72	127,987	21.64
Automotive and Land Transportation	11,586	21.80	41,549	78.20	53,134	8.98
Construction	4,590	13.90	28,421	86.10	33,011	5.58
Creative	905	65.25	482	34.75	1,387	0.23
Electrical and Electronics	14,793	26.65	40,706	73.35	55,499	9.38
Entrepreneurship	14,354	59.38	9,820	40.62	24,174	4.09
Footwear and Leathergoods		0.00	146	100.00	146	0.02
Garments	9,719	97.25	275	2.75	9,994	1.69
Heating, Ventilation, Airconditioning and Refrigeration	71	2.89	2,371	97.11	2,442	0.41
Human Health/Healthcare	19,169	78.50	5,250	21.50	24,420	4.13
Information & Communications Technology	9,751	56.93	7,376	43.07	17,127	2.90
Language	7,113	70.04	3,043	29.96	10,156	1.72
Maritime	298	3.28	8,803	96.72	9,101	1.54
Metals and Engineering	4,442	11.80	33,200	88.20	37,643	6.36
Others	33,023	73.30	12,026	26.70	45,049	7.62
Processed Foods & Beverages	14,672	76.71	4,454	23.29	19,126	3.23
Social, Community Development and Other Services	12,911	79.39	3,351	20.61	16,262	2.75
Tourism (Hotel and Restaurant)	70,298	73.92	24,800	26.08	95,097	16.08
Transport and Logistics	428	34.57	809	65.43	1,237	0.21
TVET	3,195	57.38	2,374	42.62	5,569	0.94
Visual Arts	825	50.90	796	49.10	1,622	0.27
Wholesale and Retail Trading	895	66.50	451	33.50	1,345	0.23
Total	301,226	50.92	290,304	49.08	591,530	100.00

Table 2.1.7
Employment Rate of TVET Graduates by Year, 2018-2021

Source: TESDA, Results of the Study on Employment of TVET Graduates

Survey Round	Employment Rate (%)
2018	68.6
2019	84.2
2020	70.5
2021	78.6

Table 2.1.8
Estimated Employment Rate of TVET Graduates by Sector (%): 2018 to 2021 Survey Round

Source: TESDA, Results of the Study on Employment of TVET Graduates

Sector	2018	2019	2020	2021
Information and Communication	72.23	83.54	64.46	73.49
Construction	70	76.23	74.57	76.71
Logistics				52.08
Agriculture, Forestry, and Fisheries	79.35	88.57	77.11	87.32
Human Health/Health Care	71.35	88.39	71.92	78.5

In 2020, IT-BPM generated 1.32 million FTEs, 1.44 million in 2021, 1.57 million in 2022, and 1.7 million FTEs in 2023. Further, IBPAP estimated that the IT-BPM sector generated some 4.2 million indirect jobs in 2023.²¹

Pursuant to the PLEP, the NTESDP has also designated these priority industries as key employment generators along with manufacturing (including food manufacturing and electronics), creative industries, transportation and logistics, energy, tourism, health, construction, and education.

Labor force participation of TVET graduates by region.²² In 2020, a total of 591,530 trainees graduated from TVET. The big industrial regions accounted for the highest number of graduates, as follows: National Capital Region, 12.69 percent; Region III (Central Luzon), 9.02 percent; Region VI (Western Visayas), 8.17 percent, and Region

4-A (CALABARZON), 7.75 percent. Meanwhile, BARMM registered the lowest number of graduates at 2.63 percent of the total, followed by Region 12 (SOCCSKSARGEN), 3.35 percent, CAR, 3.84 percent, Region 11 (Davao Region), 4.30 percent, and Region 13 (Caraga), 4.34 percent (Table 2.1.10).

In terms of labor force participation, 411,011 (69.48%) of the graduates were found to be active in the labor market. The rate (LFPR) across regions ranged from as low as 55.93 percent (NCR) to as high as 80.69 percent (Region 11). On average, 69.48 percent of the graduates were surveyed to be active in the labor force.

²¹ See the 2023 edition of "The IBPAP Official" titled, "Forging Ahead: Tech-Forward Philippines", and IBPAP presentation during "Second Workshop on Skills for Employment Design" organized by TESDA and World Bank in Makati on 21 February 2024.

²² NTESDP 2023-2028, p. 37.

Table 2.1.9
TVET Infrastructure vis-a-vis Priority Sectors

Source: TESDA, Results of the Study on Employment of TVET Graduates

Sectors	Training Regulations as of May 2022	Registered Program as of June 2022	Enrolled 2017-2021	Graduates 2017-2021
IT-BPM	19	518	478,697	437,752
Construction	43	1,478	402,658	364,378
Logistics	33	1,088	47,484	44,479
Agriculture	38	2,554	822,509	760,685
Health	23	1,273	498,111	455,302

Eight out of every 10 graduates in Region 11, CAR and Region 3 were found to be economically active during the survey. The lowest LFPRs were recorded in NCR (55.93%), Region X (57.34%), and Region IV-B (66.23%). Overall, the estimates for this survey were lower than the 2019 estimated 71.2 percent LFPR.

Estimated employment rate of female TVET graduates by sector. TESDA conducts regular survey on the employment of TVET graduates but does not yet reflect gender disaggregation of their employment. However, these surveys and other similar TESDA studies may provide estimates on the employment rate of TVET female graduates as shown in Table 2.1.11. For instance, female graduates dominated the garments sector with 97.25 percent

share of the total TVET graduates in 2020. Based on the survey round in 2020, 83.12 percent of graduates in the garments sector were found to be actively working when the survey was conducted in that year. Similarly, 75.13 percent of tourism graduates (hotel and restaurant), 78.86 percent of graduates of processed foods and beverages course, and 70.77 percent of those who finished social, community development and other services courses, were found to be working in 2020.

Table 2.1.10
Labor Force Participation Rate of TVET Graduates by Region. Philippines: 2020

a. Percentage over the row total; b. Labor Force Participation Rate;
c. Percentage over the total number of TVET graduates
Source: NTESDP 2023-2028

	Not in the Labor Force		In the Labor Force		Total Graduates	
	Freq.	% ^a	Freq.	LFPR ^b	Freq.	% ^c
NCR	33,067	44.07	41,975	55.93	75,042	12.69
CAR	4,475	19.69	18,252	80.31	22,727	3.84
I	10,995	32.39	22,948	67.61	33,943	5.74
II	9,694	25.53	28,273	74.47	37,967	6.42
III	11,159	20.91	42,196	79.09	53,355	9.02
IV-A	14,796	32.27	31,057	67.73	45,853	7.75
IV-B	10,083	33.77	19,776	66.23	29,859	5.05
V	7,185	26.40	20,036	73.60	27,221	4.60
VI	14,162	29.29	34,185	70.71	48,347	8.17
VII	6,669	26.76	18,254	73.24	24,923	4.21
VIII	9,042	26.97	24,487	73.03	33,529	5.67
IX	10,532	31.31	23,217	68.79	33,749	5.71
X	16,443	42.66	22,103	57.34	38,546	6.52
XI	4,914	19.31	20,535	80.69	25,449	4.30
XII	4,366	22.07	15,421	77.93	19,787	3.35
XIII	8,601	33.50	17,075	66.50	25,676	4.34
BARMM	4,336	27.87	11,221	72.13	15,557	2.63
TOTAL	180,519	30.52	411,011	69.48	591,530	100.00

Making TVET more inclusive, equitable and accessible remains a challenge. The reach and coverage of TVET remains limited especially in geographically isolated and disadvantaged areas (GIDAs). The NTESDP aims to address this gap by providing opportunities and access to all learners, especially among members of marginalized communities. TESDA will expand public TVET provision in poor regions and remote areas, with a focus on local needs, including agriculture and sectors of rural economies. It is also recognized that TVET enrollment remains highly segregated, with females clustering in programs leading to lower productivity work. To address this gender gap, it will promote the enrollment of females and disadvantaged groups in courses leading to high productivity employment.

This area-based and demand-driven strategy intends to make TVET more accessible, inclusive, relevant, and equitable.²³ But beyond ensuring that

TVET is also a positive force for social equity, it must also be harnessed to produce skills for the 21st century and the fourth industrial revolution.

It is for this reason that TVET must be more responsive to industry needs and make enterprise-based training (EBT), which includes the apprenticeship program and dual training system, more effective and acceptable to industry. The limited participation of enterprises in TVET is reflected in the low number of graduates that EBT modalities produce. In 2020, for instance, barely 2 out of 10 TVET graduates came from enterprise-based trainings. During the same year, only 4,834 or 45 percent of 10,750 enterprise-based trainees graduated from the apprenticeship program. This number represented just 0.82 percent of the total 591,530 TVET graduates in 2020.

²³ NTESDP 2023-2028, pp. 80-81.

Table 2.1.11
Estimated Employment Rate of Female TVET Graduates by Female-Dominated Sector
Philippines: 2017-2020

Note: Table 2.1.11 should be cross-referenced with Table 2.1.6.
Source of basic data: NTESDP 2023-2028, pp. 36 and 39.

Female-Dominated and Fishery	Female Graduates (2020)		Employment Rate by Survey Rounds			
	Freq.	%Share	2020	2019	2018	2017
Agriculture Forestry and Fishery	68,187	53.28	87.32	77.11	88.57	73.95
Garments	9,719	97.25	83.55	83.55	86.67	76.59
Human Health/Healthcare	19,169	78.50	78.50	71.92	88.39	71.35
Information and Communications Technology	9,751	56.93	73.48	64.46	83.54	72.23
Language	7,113	70.04	65.38	64.42	88.89	70.47
Others	33,023	73.30	86.47	72.25	72.73	66.44
Processed Foods & Beverages	14,672	76.71	78.86	73.40		58.62
Social, Community Development and Other Services	12,911	79.39	70.77	64.15	86.02	77.81
Tourism (Hotel and Restaurant)	70,298	73.92	75.13	67.42	82.43	60.14
TVET	3,195	57.38	92.72	87.80	86.59	83.51
Visual Arts	825	50.90	61.12	50.50	93.22	
Wholesale and Retail Trading	895	66.50	60.78	90.98	88.69	67.73

On the other hand, the dual-training system (DTS) appears to be in a more precarious situation. In 2020, only 375 trainees graduated through the DTS. This number represented less than one percent of the total TVET graduates for the same year (Table 2.1.12).²⁴

The issue of limited industry participation in TVET was also highlighted in the EDCOM II year one report for 2023. The report noted that “[t]he persistent gap between industry needs and the education system involves limited industry participation, slow policy adjustments, and challenges in the adoption of effective TVET programs, ultimately impacting the quality and relevance of education and training opportunities.” The report also found that “the most acute challenges in enabling industry involvement” are in the following areas: (a) the engagement of industry in the development and implementation of responsive competency standards and training

programs; (b) the rationalization of guidelines on EBT; and (c) the lack of palatable incentives for enterprises to engage in EBT. Further, the report cited the need to rationalize policies governing enterprise-based training to make it relevant to the evolving landscape of industries and the world of work.²⁵

Top disciplines by enrollment and graduates. With respect to higher education, the top disciplines in terms of enrollment and graduates are business administration and related courses, education science and teacher training, engineering and technology, and IT-related disciplines (Tables 2.1.13 and 2.1.14).

²⁴ NTESDP 2023-2028, pp. 30-31.

²⁵ EDCOM II Year One Report: Miseducation - The Failed System of Philippine Education. 2024. Second Congressional Commission on Education. pp. 216-220.

Table 2.1.12
Weighted Distribution of TVET Graduates by Training Venue, Philippines: 2020

Source of basic data: NTESDP 2023-2028

Training Venue	No. of Graduates	Percent Share
Institution-based	380,943	64.40%
Enterprise-based	10,750	1.82
Apprenticeship	4,834	0.82
Dual-Training System	375	0.06
Farm schools/enterprise training	848	0.14
Industry-based/in-company training	1,398	0.24
Learnership	3,295	0.56
Community-based	199,838	33.78
Total	591,530	100%

Table 2.1.13
Top Five Disciplines in Terms of Enrollment: AY 2019-2020

Source: Commission on Higher Education Administrative Data

Discipline	Enrollment
Business Administration and Related Disciplines	233,194
Education Science and Teacher Training	169,832
Engineering and Technology	87,083
IT-related Disciplines	81,477
Other Disciplines	46,645

Professional development. Based on the results of licensure examinations administered by the the Professional Regulation Commission (PRC) during the period 2021-2023, professional teachers, nurses, and criminologists are the top professions with the highest number of passers during the past three years. A total of 344,184 or 50.46% of the total 682,095 teacher-examinees passed the licensure examinations for teachers (LET) during this period. On the other hand, 72,764 or 72% of the 100,773 nurse-examinees passed their licensure. Of the three professions, criminology registered the lowest passing rate at 32.36%, as only 45,288 of the total 139,961 examinees hurdled the examinations (Table 2.1.15).²⁶

Overseas employment and migration. As a pioneer in overseas employment and managed migration, the Philippines has well-established institutional and legal framework and migration-related policies and programs to manage overseas employment and international migration. It is estimated that 1 out of 10 Filipinos is overseas for gainful employment. The number of Overseas Filipino Workers (OFWs) or Filipino workers who worked abroad during the period April to September 2021 was estimated at 1.83 million. The number of OFWs increased by 3.0 percent, or over 54,000, from 2020 to 2021 (Figure 2.1.16). In 2021, 60 percent of OFWs were female.

OFWs occupations. The 2021 Survey on Overseas Filipinos showed that about four in every ten OFWs (43.2%) in 2021 were engaged in elementary and low-skilled occupations, such as domestic workers

who are predominantly female. A substantial number of migrant workers, mostly male, were in service and sales sector (16.5%) and industry, who were mostly plant and machine operators and assemblers (13.6%). The survey also found a small number of migrant professionals and OFWs occupying managerial positions (Figure 2.1.17).

Meanwhile, administrative data from the Department of Migrant Workers (DMW) showed a 50 percent increase in the deployment of seabased workers from 385,239 in 2022 to 578,626 in 2023. Of the 2023 total, 543,274 (93.89%) were male, and 35,352 (6.11%) were female. By major category, 248,534 (43%) of the deployed seafarers were non-marine, 207,114 (36%) were ratings, and 122,927 (21%) were officers. The DMW has listed the top ten skills that 41 percent or 283,647 of these seafarers occupy, namely, able and ordinary seaman, oiler, waiter/waitress, bosun, second mate, chief cook, third engineer officer, messman, and third mate. The remaining 59 percent occupied other skills.²⁷

Inclusivity and international labor migration. The DWCP has earlier recognized the challenges facing international migration of Filipinos, particularly the inclusivity of labor standards to realize labor guarantees for OFWs, especially temporary migrant workers who work overseas while maintaining their residency in the Philippines.

²⁶ The number of licensure examinations conducted for the three professions during this period are as follows: for teachers -7; nurses-6; and criminologist-4.

²⁷ See DMW Overseas Deployment Statistics, 4th Quarter 2023, and Overseas Employment Statistics Compendium, 2023-January-2024. Figures for 2023 are preliminary. www.dmw.gov.ph.

Table 2.1.14
Top Five Disciplines in Terms of Graduates: AY 2019-2020

Source: CHED Administrative Data

Discipline	Enrollmet
Business Administration and Related Disciplines	878,661
Education Science and Teacher Training	671,421
Engineering and Technology	442,064
IT-related Disciplines	324,696
Other Disciplines	252,824
Medical and Allied Disciplines	234,204

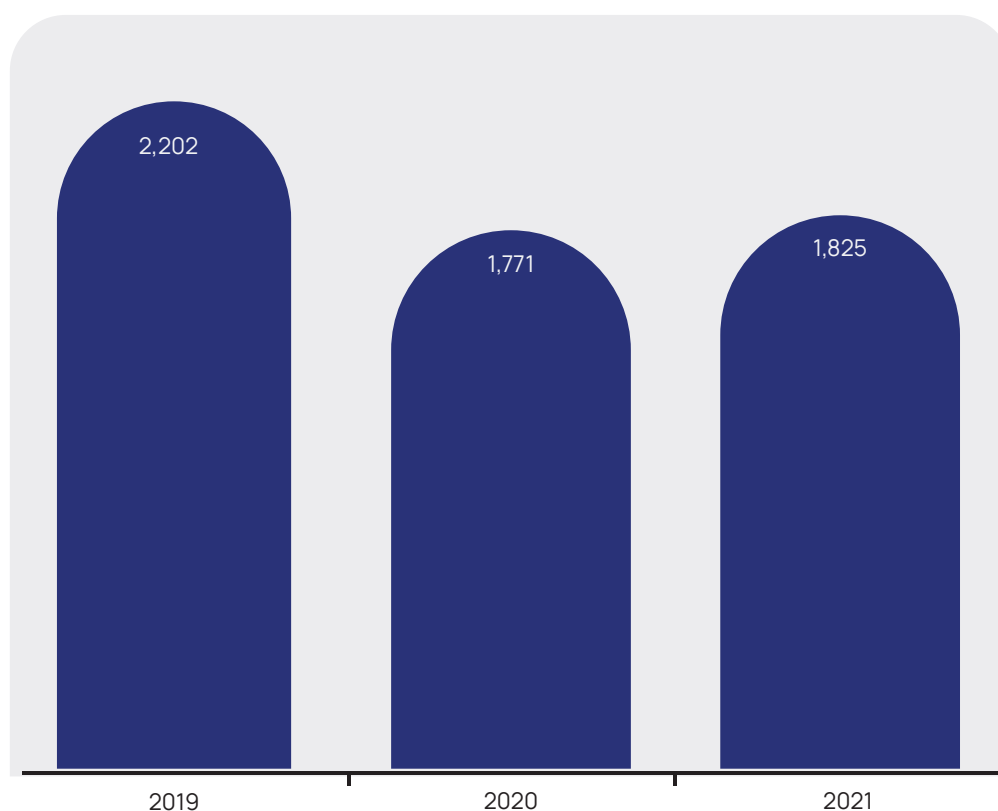
Table 2.1.15
Disciplines with Highest Number of Board Passers: 2021-2023

Source of basic data: Professional Regulation Commission Official Statements and Press Releases on the results of licensure examinations for the period 2021-2023. <https://www.prc.gov.ph>

Discipline	No. of Examinees		No. of Passers		Passing Rate
Education	682,095		344,184		50.46%
- Elementary		265,095		130,710	49.31%
- Secondary		417,000		213,474	51.19%
Criminology	139,961		45,288		32.36%
Nursing	100,773		72,764		72.21%

Figure 2.1.16
Number of Overseas Filipino Workers (in '000): 2019-2021

Source: 2021 Survey on Overseas Filipinos, PSA



The policy and regulatory framework on temporary labor migration covers the full cycle of an OFW's journey – from recruitment to deployment to re-integration. The situation of OFWs is more precarious because of the short-term nature of their employment and the different levels of treatment and protection afforded by host countries. They also continue to be employed mostly in low-skilled categories and “3-D” occupations (dirty, dangerous and demanding) where workers, particularly women, face higher risks. Documented and reported instances of illegal recruitment within the country

and abuses committed by employers abroad as well as situations that may constitute trafficking in persons are also not uncommon. Oftentimes, OFWs do not have ready access to dispute resolution or redress mechanisms in their host countries. Consequently, the effective implementation of existing laws and labor standards protecting them becomes particularly challenging.²⁸

²⁸ Decent Work Country Programme Philippines 2022-24, p. 12.

Green jobs and just transition. The Philippines is the first country in the Asia-Pacific region to adopt a green jobs law. The law aims to help ensure the sustainable development of the country and its transition to a green economy. It is envisioned to create job opportunities and encourage increased investment in the “green” sector, which includes industries such as renewable energy, sustainable agriculture, waste management, and eco-tourism. Its implementation is also expected to help mitigate environmental damage caused by traditional industries, improve business competitiveness, and reduce public cost in building green skills by stimulating private sector investment in green skills training and research and development.²⁹

In mid-2016, the Philippines became one of the three pilot countries for the application of the Policy Guidelines on Just Transition towards Environmentally Sustainable Economies and Societies for All in the Philippines (Just Transition). The initiative aimed to support the tripartite partners and other stakeholders in promoting decent work and inclusive growth towards pursuing a greener economy within the context of the green jobs law and in managing structural changes brought about by the shift to an environmentally sustainable and climate-resilient pathway.³⁰

Assessment and certification standards. However, 7 years after its enactment, the law has yet to be fully implemented to produce the desired economic and labor market outcomes. Its effective implementation is hampered by the lack of appropriate standards that will govern the assessment and certification of green goods and services, and green technologies and practices for the purpose of regulating the availment of financial incentives and ensuring green jobs content.³¹

Since the law does not explicitly assign to any agency the main responsibility of its implementation, ensuring effective coordination among the 21 government agencies which have different but complementary mandates under the law, has been a challenge since day one.³² To address this concern, the DOLE spearheaded in 2019, with ILO support, the constitution of a high-level inter-agency body to ensure better coordination in implementing the law. It is important to put in place a responsive governance structure to ensure the effective implementation of the green jobs law.

Presently, the DOLE is updating the National Green Jobs Human Resource Development Plan 2020-2030 in consultation with concerned agencies, social partners, and other stakeholders including the ILO. The updated plan will set national targets on green jobs and just transition anchored on PDP 2023-2028 and PLEP 2023-2028. It will also map out the goals and strategies to develop green jobs-ready workforce and accessible green jobs labor market, and ensure a shared just transition governance, among other major goals. With respect to the standards, the DOLE, CCC, DOF and DENR will establish a joint mechanism on green jobs assessment and certification.³³

Greening the economy through green jobs creation.

A 2021 study estimated new employment demand projections in the green and conventional sectors of the Philippine economy between 2016 and 2030. Using the Green Philippine Employment Projections Model (Green PEPM), the study found that about 7 million Filipinos or roughly 17 percent of all employed in 2016, were in the green subsector. Of this total, 4.3 million workers (61%) were in green services, 1.4 million (20%) were in green industry, and 1.3 million (19%) were in green agriculture (Table 2.1.16). In terms of gross value added (GVA), the green sub-sector recorded PhP 1.5 trillion, or 15.5 percent of the total PhP 8.1 trillion. It is expected to more than double to PhP 3.4 trillion in 2030, or 20.3 percent of the total PhP 16.7 trillion.

²⁹ RA 10771, or the Philippines Green Jobs Act of 2016, passed in April 2016, defines green job as “employment that contributes to preserving or restoring the quality of the environment, be it in the agriculture, industry or services sector. Specifically, but not exclusively, this include jobs that help to protect ecosystems and biodiversity, reduce energy, materials and water consumption through high efficiency strategies, decarbonize the economy, and minimize or altogether avoid generation of all forms of waste and pollution. Green jobs are decent jobs that are productive, respect the rights of workers, deliver a fair income, provide security in the workplace and social protection for families, and promote social dialogue.”

³⁰ See ILO. 2016. *Pilot Application of the Policy Guidelines on Just Transition towards Environmentally Sustainable Economies and Societies for All in the Philippines (Just Transition)*. <https://www.ilo.org/-wcmssp5/groups/public/-asia/--ro-bangkok/--ilo-manila/documents/publication/wcms501118.pdf>

³¹ Sec. 6(o), R.A. 10771.

³² These agencies include the DOLE, DOF (plus BOC, BIR and GFIs), BSP, DENR, DepEd, CHED, TESDA, PRC, NEDA, PSA, DTI, DOST, DOTC (now DOTr), DOT, DPWH, DA, DILG and CCC.

³³ This will be done through a joint issuance among the 4 agencies, setting out their respective roles, responsibilities, and programs relative to the development and administration of the standards. The development of the assessment and certification system and guidelines is also among the target outcomes of the pilot project for the application of the ILO Just Transition policy guidelines.

The same table shows that in terms of employment by the end of the projections period in 2030, the green subsectors are expected to generate 10.1 million jobs, equivalent to 18 percent of the total 55.9 million. Of this total, 62 percent or nearly 2 out of 3 will be in services, 29 percent in industry, and 9 percent in agriculture. This means that under the baseline business-as-usual (BAU) scenario, the green agriculture sector is expected to demand just one of every ten agricultural workers in the medium-term.

On the other hand, the green industry is expected to require 2.9 million workers in 2030. Of this number, 91 percent will be required in green construction, which is expected to employ 2.7 million workers in 2030. Meanwhile, the green services sector is projected to need about 6.3 million workers in 2030, compared to 4.3 million it employed in 2016. Wholesale and retail trade and transportation and storage subsectors together will account for 56 percent of this total demand, with 1.8 million workers and 1.7 million workers, respectively. Employment demand in the green services sector is expected to grow by 2.8 percent annually on average between 2016 and 2030.

The study noted the potential benefits that greening the economy might bring, particularly in the labor market. However, it also cautions that greening may also result in job losses in certain industries, depending on the country's development targets and the extent to which the country might pursue green initiatives. For this reason, it emphasizes the important role a strengthened social protection system plays as the country transitions to a greener economy.

Overcoming gender gaps. A look at the labor statistics by gender shows that employment, unemployment, and labor force participation showed gender gaps biased against women in the recent past. A narrowing of the gender gaps was noticed in 2019. The gaps, however, resurfaced in the course of the pandemic in 2020. It should be noted that the women have been one of the most vulnerable groups affected by the pandemic. Jobs and incomes losses were particularly high among women. They were providing essential and frontline services while being exposed to the risk of the coronavirus. Further, women were affected by the increased burden of unpaid care work.

The existence of gender gaps can be attributed to traditional gender roles since family and home care responsibilities have always been assigned to women. Closing the gender gaps and ensuring gender parity in the labor market will require pursuing more gender equal and inclusive approaches to economic policy making and government budgeting. It would also require addressing all forms of workplace discrimination, preventing violence and harassment at work, enhancing occupational safety and health, promoting care policies and services that support workers to manage work alongside family responsibilities, and upholding equal pay for work of equal value.

The country's performance in addressing gender gaps over the years is captured in some cross-country assessment reports. For instance, the World Economic Forum's Global Gender Report 2023 ranked the Philippines 16th among 146 nations in the Global Gender Gap Index. This was 3 notches higher than the country's 19th ranking in 2022. In the economic participation and opportunity sub-index, the Philippines was ranked 17th in 2023, which is one notch lower than the 2022 ranking.³⁴ The PLEP supports collective efforts to narrow the gender gaps in the labor market and increase the participation of women in the economy.

However, the Philippines performed poorly in terms of gender equality based on UNDP's Gender Inequality Index (GII). In 2021, the country recorded a value of 0.419562, which is worse than the average in East Asia and the Pacific (0.337), and other regions, such as Latin America and the Caribbean (0.381), and Europe and Central Asia (0.227). The big disparity can be attributed to the low levels of female labor force participation and the differences in the assignment of weights of this indicator in the calculation of overall gender parity.³⁵

³⁴ World Economic Forum. 2022/2023. *Global Gender Report 2022 and Global Gender Report 2023*.

³⁵ ILO. forthcoming. *Decent Work Country Diagnostics: Philippines*.

Figure 2.1.17
Distribution of OFWs by Major Occupation Group and by Sex (%), 2021

Source: 2021 Survey on Overseas Filipinos, PSA

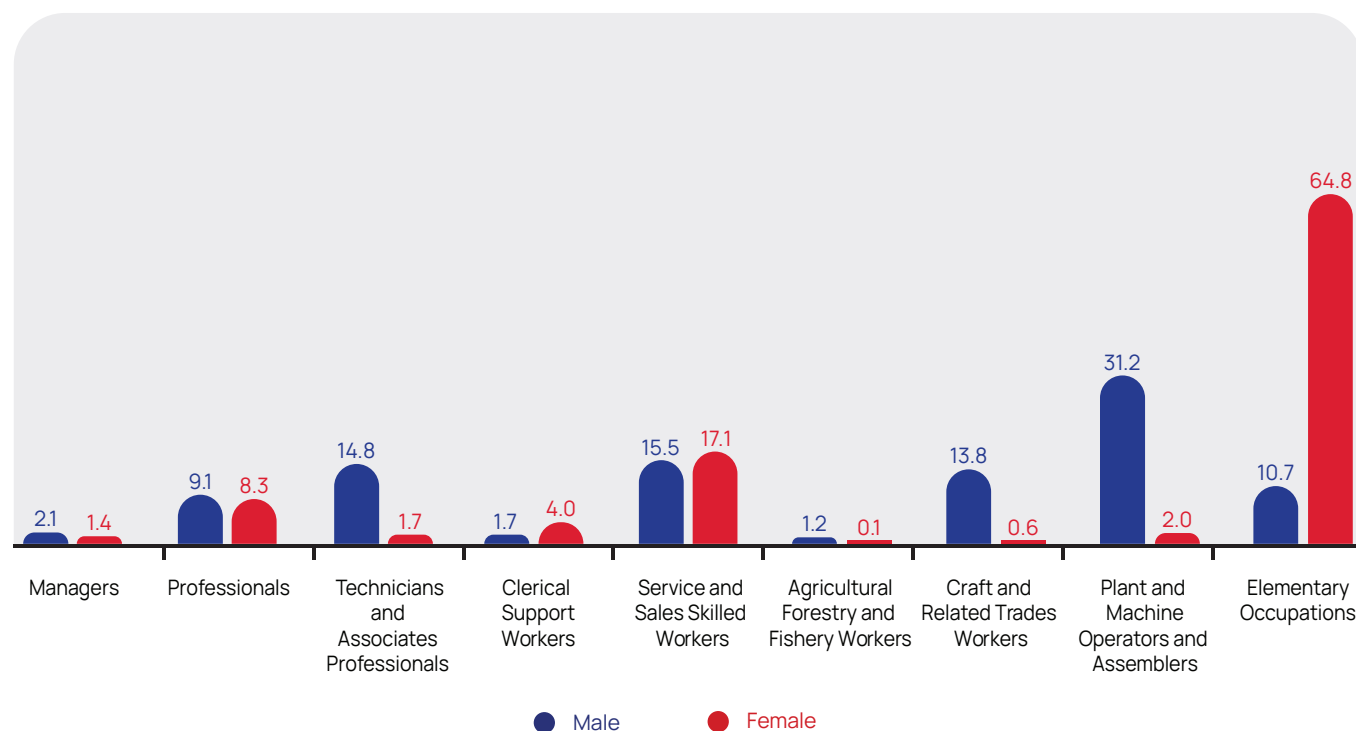


Table 2.1.16
Employment Demand (millions) by Sector: Philippines, 2016-2030

Source: Abrigo, M. et al. (2021). Greening the Philippine Employment Projections Model: New Estimates and Policy Options. Discussion Paper Series No. 2021-26. PIDS

	Conventional Sub-sector (Millions)				Green Sub-sector (Millions)				All Sub-sectors (Millions)			
	2016	2020	2025	2030	2016	2020	2025	2030	2016	2020	2025	2030
Agriculture	9.9	9.2	8.5	8.1	1.3	1.1	1.0	0.9	11.2	10.3	9.5	9.0
Industry	5.9	6.6	7.6	8.8	1.4	1.8	2.3	2.9	7.3	8.4	10.0	11.7
Services	18.2	21.6	25.5	28.8	4.3	4.9	5.7	6.3	22.5	26.5	31.2	35.1
Total	34	37.3	41.6	45.7	6.9	7.8	9.0	10.1	41.0	45.2	50.6	55.9

Subchapter 2.2. Forging labor market governance that ensures respect for all fundamental principles and rights at work, international labor standards and human rights

Creating decent work and productive employment opportunities requires a labor market governance that facilitates better application of fundamental principles and rights covering child laborers and domestic workers, non-discrimination and forced labor, as well as freedom of association and right to collective bargaining. It also requires ensuring

that workers' right to humane working conditions and safe and healthy workplaces is promoted and respected. The PLEP shall be a platform where the social partners could articulate their aspirations and pursue their development agenda through tripartite mechanisms and social dialogue.

Assessment and Challenges

State policy of protection to labor. The 1987 Philippine Constitution enshrines the overarching State policy of “protection to labor”. The Constitution provides labor guarantees to all Filipino women and men workers, organized or unorganized, whether working locally or overseas. These guarantees cover full employment and equal employment opportunities, self-organization, collective bargaining and negotiations, peaceful concerted activities including the right to strike, security of tenure, humane conditions of work, living wage, participation in policy and decision-making processes affecting workers' rights and benefits, and just sharing in the fruits of production. The enabling laws and institutions to operationalize these guarantees are found in the Labor Code of 1974, as amended by other related laws. The country's labor institutions are comprehensive and well-developed, many of which are patterned after international labor standards, including the ten ILO fundamental Conventions – all of which the country has ratified. Given the accelerated pace of transformations in the world of work, the challenge lies in improving implementation, modernizing the existing policy design and instruments of labor market governance, and ensuring effective and inclusive protection to all workers.³⁶

Right to self-organization. An assessment of the workers' right to self-organization shows that the number of registered unions is increasing both in the private and public sectors over the years

(Figure 2.2.1). In terms of trade union density, however, the number of unions relative to the number of existing establishments needs to increase further, especially outside the traditional bastions of union organizing such as manufacturing and big enterprises.

But the other side of the story paints a different picture. Unionization rate in both the private and public sectors shows that trade union density has generally declined over the years. Unionization rate in the private sector has dropped from 7.8 percent in 2017 to 6.9 percent in 2022, although it peaked at 8.3 percent in 2020. Likewise, the unionization rate in the public sector has dropped from 13.3 percent in 2017 to 12 percent in 2022, although it peaked at 13.3 percent in 2020 (Figure 2.2.2).

Declining number and coverage of collective bargaining agreements (CBAs).³⁷ The number of collective bargaining agreements and workers covered by existing CBAs had been declining pre-pandemic, but has been increasing since 2020. Prior to the COVID-19 crisis, the number of CBAs had been declining since 2017. From as high as 1,159 CBAs in 2017, it dropped to 800 in 2020, its lowest for the period from 2016 to 2024 (as of March).

³⁶ *Decent Work Country Programme Philippines 2020-24*, p. 11.

³⁷ ILO (forthcoming). *Decent Work Country Diagnostics: Philippines*.

Figure 2.2.1.
Registered Enterprised-Based and Public Sector Labor Organizations, 2017-March 2024

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, LFS 2001-March 2024

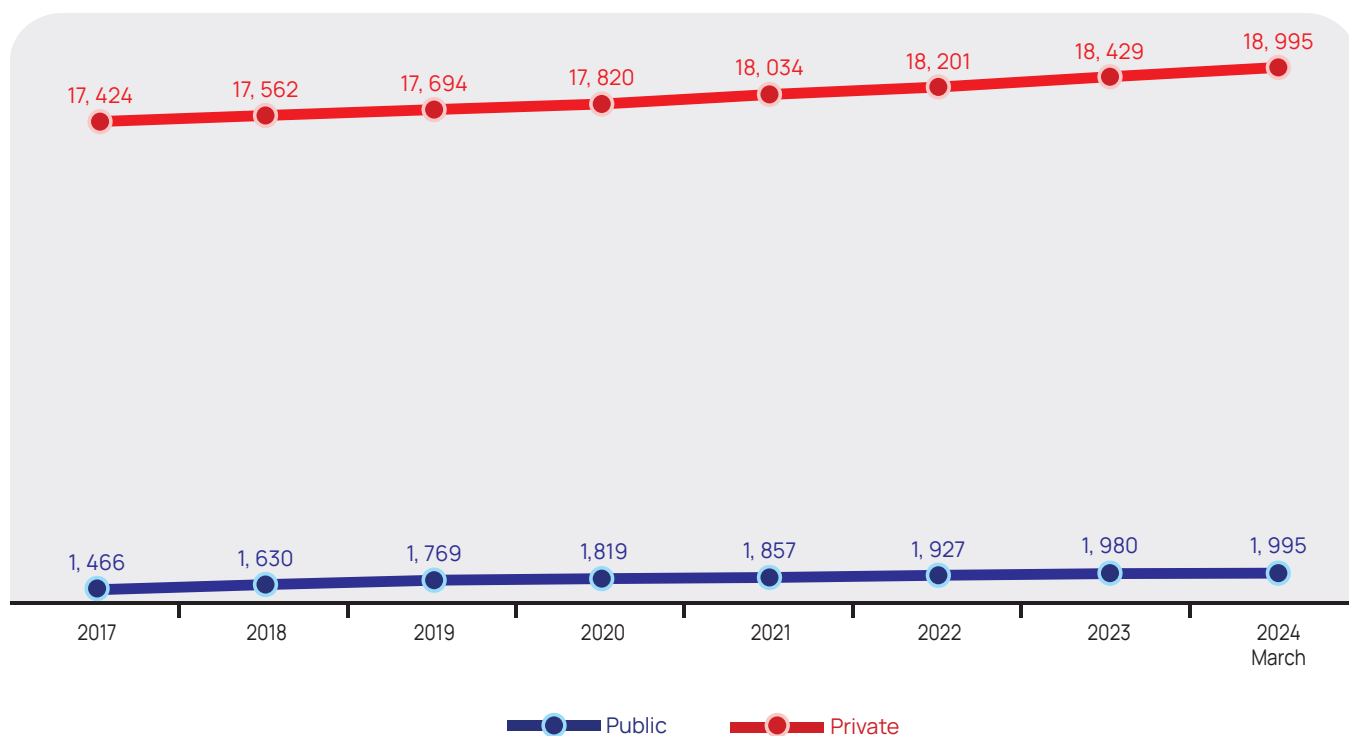
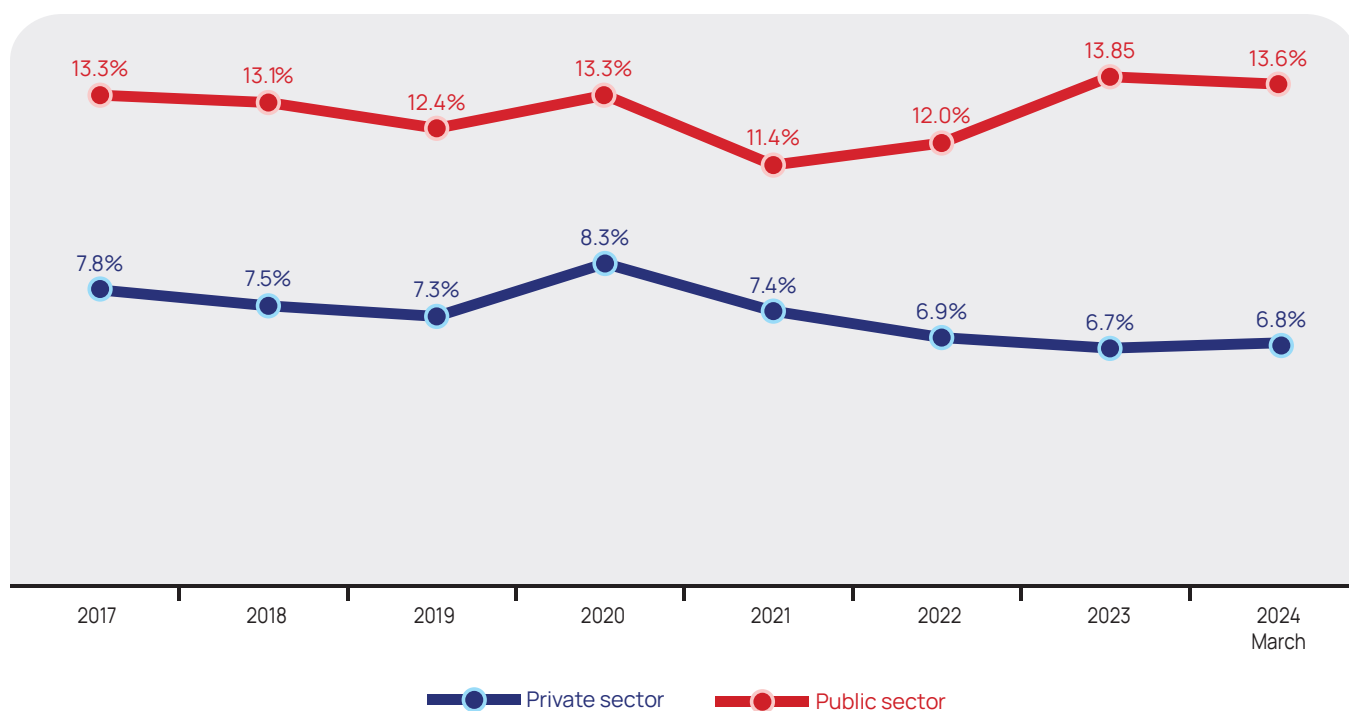


Figure 2.2.2
Unionization Rate in the Private and Public Sectors, 2017-March 2024

*The data represents union membership over the total number of employees in the private and public sector.
Source: DOLE-Bureau of Labor Relations (DOLE-BLR)



This means that the rate at which CBAs had been expiring was outpaced the number of new CBAs during the same period. The number of workers covered by CBAs had been fluctuating over the same period, hovering from around 180,000 to 290,000 workers. Starting in 2020, the number of CBAs has been steadily increasing to as high as 1,206 as of March 2024. This also resulted in the steady increase of workers covered by existing CBAs from 2020 to more than 290,000 workers in 2024 (March). This marks the highest number of workers covered by CBAs for the period 2016 to March 2024.

Collective bargaining coverage rates have been recently declining, especially in establishments in the industry and services sectors. Table 2.2.1 shows that collective bargaining coverage rates or the ratio of total employees covered by CBAs to total employees, have been decreasing from as high as 8.1 percent in 2014 to 6.3 percent in 2020. This is primarily due to declining coverage in establishments in the industry and services sectors. CBA coverage is the lowest in establishments in the services sector, which continued to decline from 5.7 percent in 2014 to 4.6 percent in 2020. One key driver of the overall decline in 2020 is the massive drop in CBA coverage in agriculture establishments from 20.1 per cent in 2018 to 5.6 percent in 2020.

Labor dispute resolution. Since its institutionalization in 2013, the Single Entry Approach (SEnA) has facilitated a more expeditious and non-litigious settlement of labor disputes. An increasing trend in the settlement rate for the period 2018-2023 is notable, except for 2020 when it significantly

dropped because of the COVID-19 pandemic. The highest SEnA settlement rates were recorded in 2023 at 90.41 percent (excluding NLRC) and 68.06 percent [including NLRC] (Figure 2.2.3).

Meanwhile, conciliation-mediation continues to play a major role in the settlement of labor disputes, preventing actual work stoppages, maintaining industrial harmony, and preserving jobs. Since 2018, Strike Incidence Rate among Notices of Strike/Lockout has been maintained at 5.58 percent (Figure 2.2.4).

From 2018 to 2023, a total of 2,601 preventive mediation cases were handled. Of this, 2,339 or 90 percent were settled (Figure 2.2.5).

At the national level, the settlement rate for notices of strike and lockout remained at 76 percent (on average) for the past 6 years. Of the 1,084 notices of strikes/lockout handled from 2018 to 2023, 816 or 75 percent were settled (Figure 2.2.6).

For the same period, a total of 61 actual strikes/lockouts were handled. Of this, 49 or 80.3 percent were disposed. Of the disposed cases, 31 were settled amicably (Figure 2.2.7).

Table 2.2.1
Number of Employees with Unions and CBA Coverage Rates by Sector, 2014 to 2020

Note: This only covers all establishments employing 20 or more workers.
Source: PSA, BLES Integrated Survey, Industrial Relations at the Workplace Survey, Integrated Survey on Labor and Employment

	Number of Employees with Union				CBA Coverage Rates			
	2014	2016	2018	2020	2014	2016	2018	2020
TOTAL	359,745	313,267	361,632	333,776	8.1	7.2	7.1	6.3
Agriculture, forestry, and fishing	34,077	30,499	30,916	8,554	14.4	19.8	20.1	5.6
Industry	161,073	131,800	160,881	153,852	12.1	9.9	10.8	10.9
Services	164,597	150,970	169,835	171,370	5.7	5.3	5.0	4.6

Figure 2.2.3
DOLE-wide Single-Entry Approach Settlement Rate, 2018-2023

Source: National Conciliation and Mediation Board

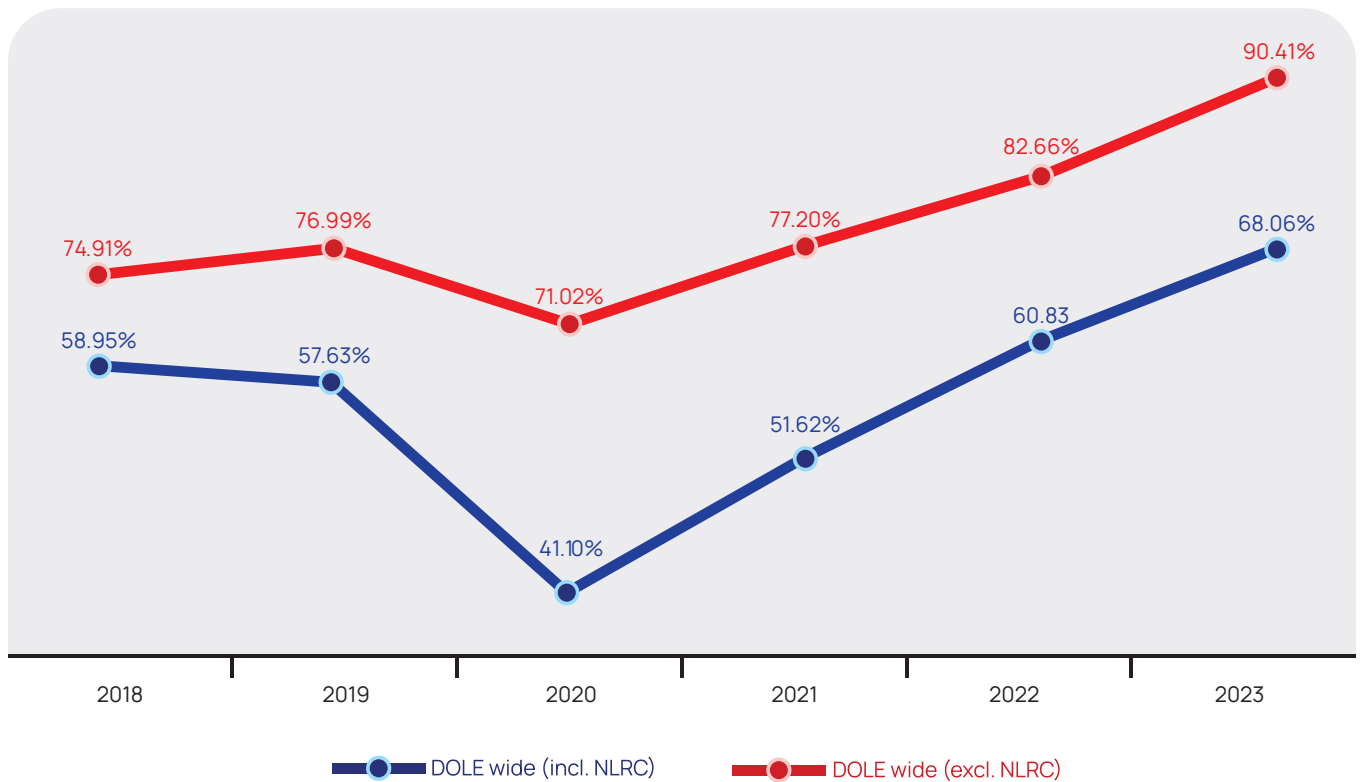


Figure 2.2.4
Strike Incidence Rate, 2018-2023

Source: National Conciliation and Mediation Board

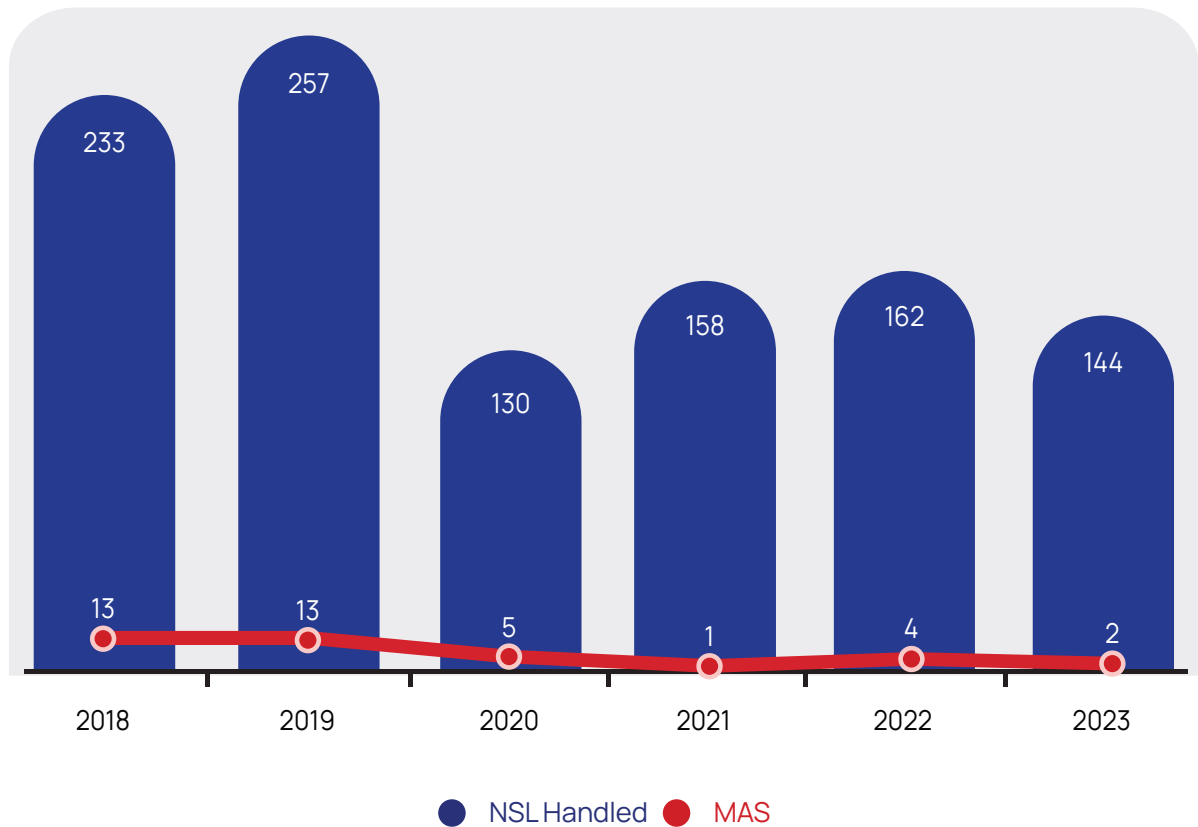


Figure 2.2.5
Preventive Mediation Cases Handled and Settled, 2018-2023

Source: National Conciliation and Mediation Board

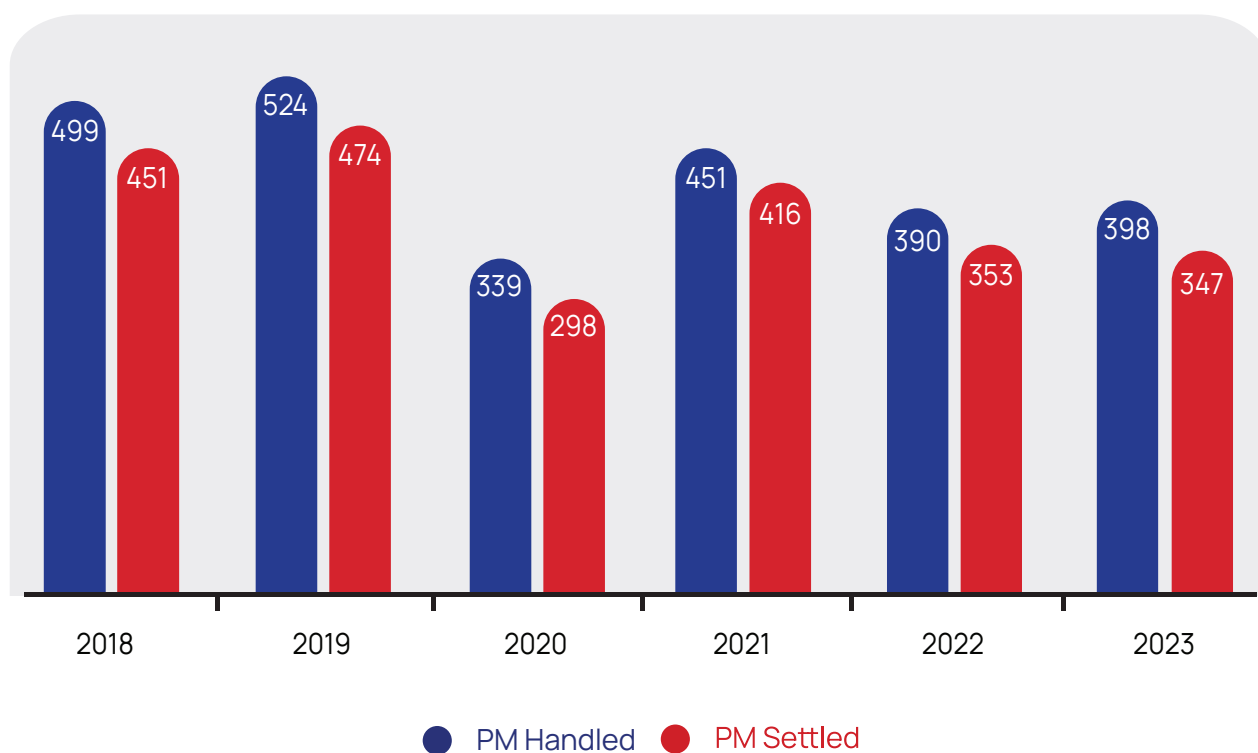


Figure 2.2.6
Notices of Strike/Lockout Handled and Settled, 2018-2023

Source: National Conciliation and Mediation Board

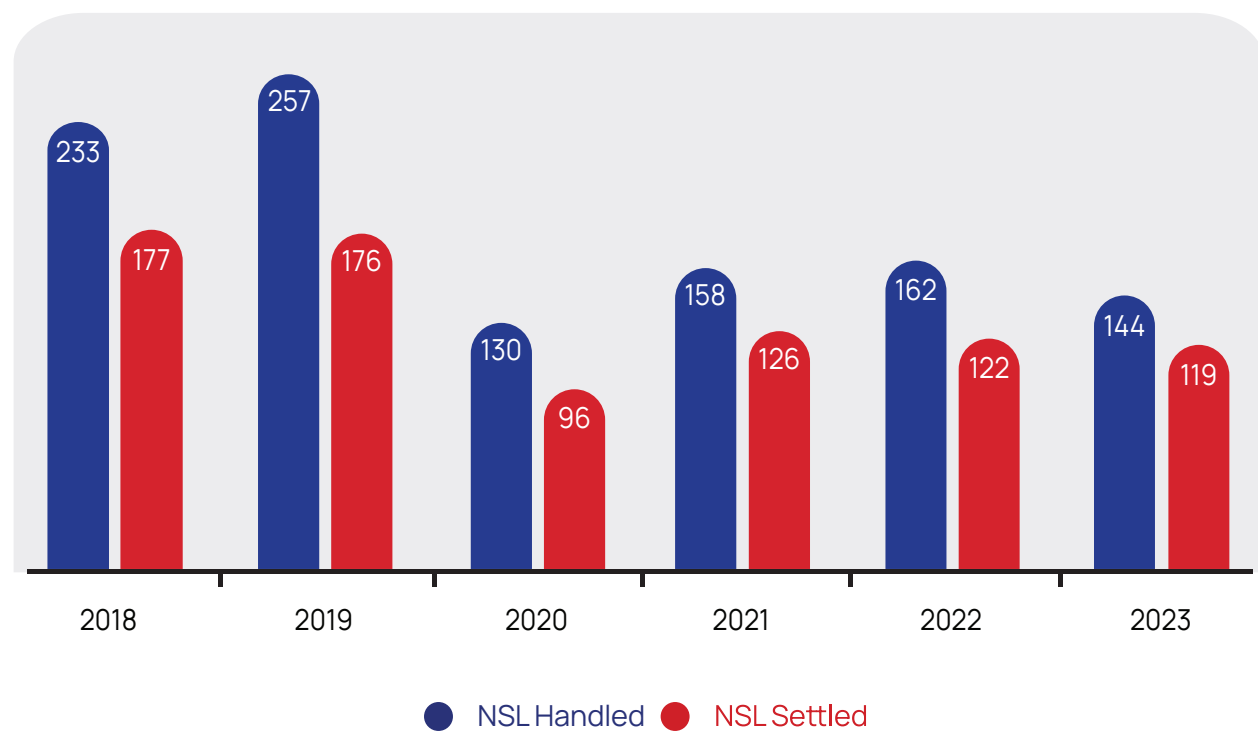
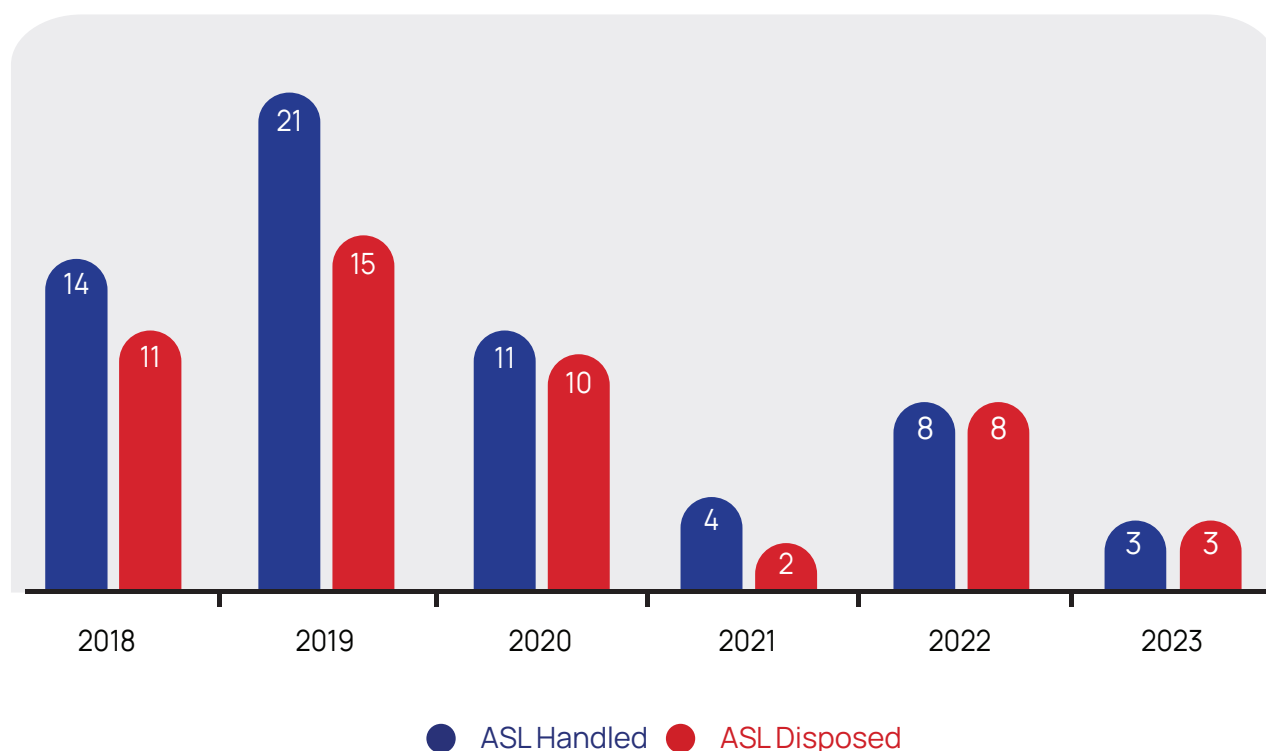


Figure 2.2.7
Preventive Mediation Cases Handled and Settled, 2018-2023

Source: National Conciliation and Mediation Board



Voluntary Arbitration (VA) complements conciliation and preventive mediation in resolving labor disputes through cooperative and non-adversarial modes. VA is a third party settlement of labor disputes whereby management and workers agree by mutual consent to submit their case to a neutral third party who decides the case based on merits. Table 2.2.2 shows an upward trend of VA cases for the period 2018-2022. Of the total 6,928 cases handled, 68 percent were disposed. Close to 92 percent or 6,342 of cases involved seafarers.

Key issues in labor dispute resolution. Against the backdrop of positive trends in labor dispute management as indicated in the foregoing data, much still needs to be done to improve the capacity of the labor dispute resolution system to handle, manage and dispense labor justice. There is a need to effectively operationalize the principle of shared responsibility between workers and employers and progressively rationalize the system to make it more responsive. In addition, the use of grievance and other similar plant-level mechanisms, including voluntary modes, to resolve disputes must be continuously promoted.

Review and simplification of rules of procedures must be done, including the rules on execution and satisfaction of judgments.

Administration and enforcement of general labor standards, occupational safety and health standards, and social legislation. For the period 2018-2022, there was an increasing trend in the number of establishments inspected under the Labor Inspection Program. The labor inspectorate was able to cover a total of 388,854 establishments during this period. The number of establishments inspected peaked at 91,505 in 2021, but drastically decreased to 81,314 during the height of the pandemic in 2022 when most firms stopped operations and resorted to work-from-home arrangements (Figure 2.2.8).

While this upward trend may be considered a good indicator of the increasing capacity of the labor inspectorate, the challenge remains in terms of its capacity to cover some 1,080,638 registered establishments in the country based on PSA data.

Table 2.2.2
Disposition Rate and Nature of Cases (Voluntary Arbitration): 2018-2022

Source: National Conciliation and Mediation Board

Indicators	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	Total
Cases Handled	867	963	1,331	1,764	2,003	6,928
Cases Disposed	513	492	868	1,331	1,480	4,684
Disposition Rate	59%	51%	65%	75%	74%	68%
Type of Cases						
Landbased	120	133	89	111	133	586
Landbased (%)	13.84%	13.81%	6.69%	6.29%	6.64%	8.46%
Maritime	747	830	1,242	1,653	1,870	6,342
Maritime (%)	86.16%	86.19%	93.31%	93.71%	93.36%	91.54%
Total	867	963	1,331	1,764	2,003	6,928

Size of inspected establishments by employment.

Majority or around 61 percent of establishments inspected were micro establishments. This can be expected because micro enterprises comprise more than 90 percent of the total establishments in the country. Based on the PSA 2022 List of Establishments, 90.5 percent or 1.004 million of the 1.109 million establishments in the country, were micro. Of this total, 96,464 or 8.7 percent were small, 4,484 or 0.49 percent were medium, and 4,541 or 0.41 percent were large.

This means that 9 out of 10 establishments operating in the country, are micro, or those employing less than 10 workers (Figure 2.2.9).

In terms of gender disaggregation, labor inspection covered more male than female workers during the period 2018-2022. Out of the 14.769 million covered workers, 58 percent or 8.576 million were male, and 42 percent or 6.193 million were female (Figure 2.2.10).

Figure 2.2.8
Number of Inspected Establishments, 2018-2022

Source: Bureau of Working Conditions

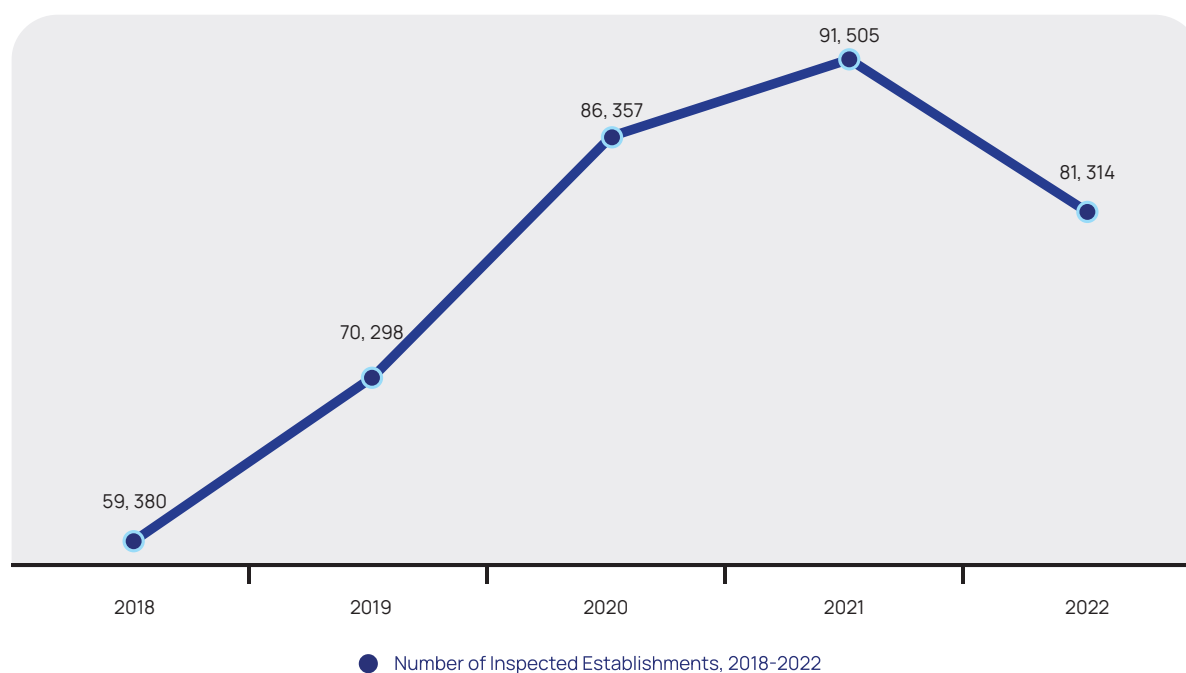


Figure 2.2.9
Inspected Establishments by
Employment Size, 2018-2022

Source: Bureau of Working Conditions

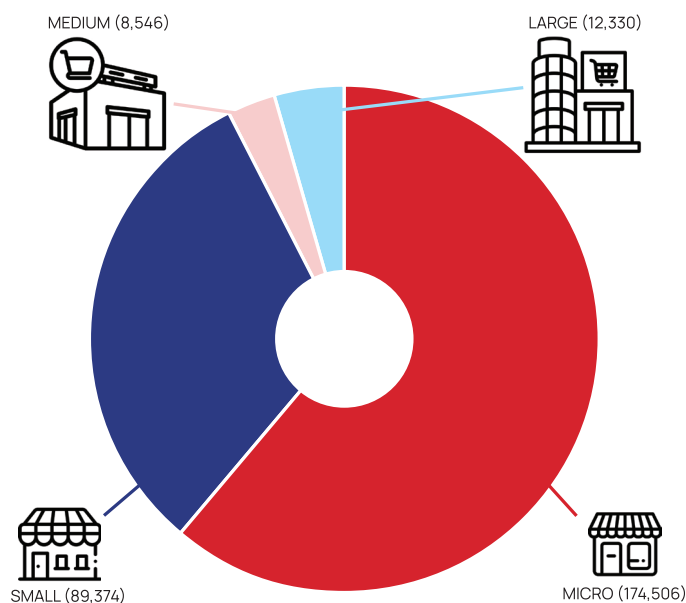


Figure 2.2.10
Workers Covered by Labor Inspection
by Gender, 2018-2022

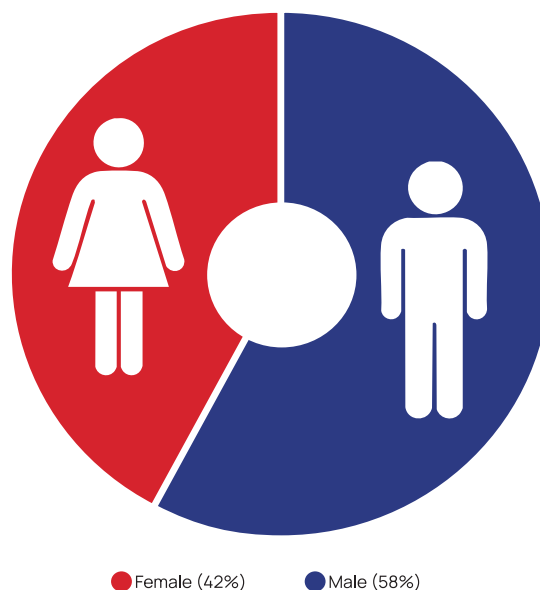
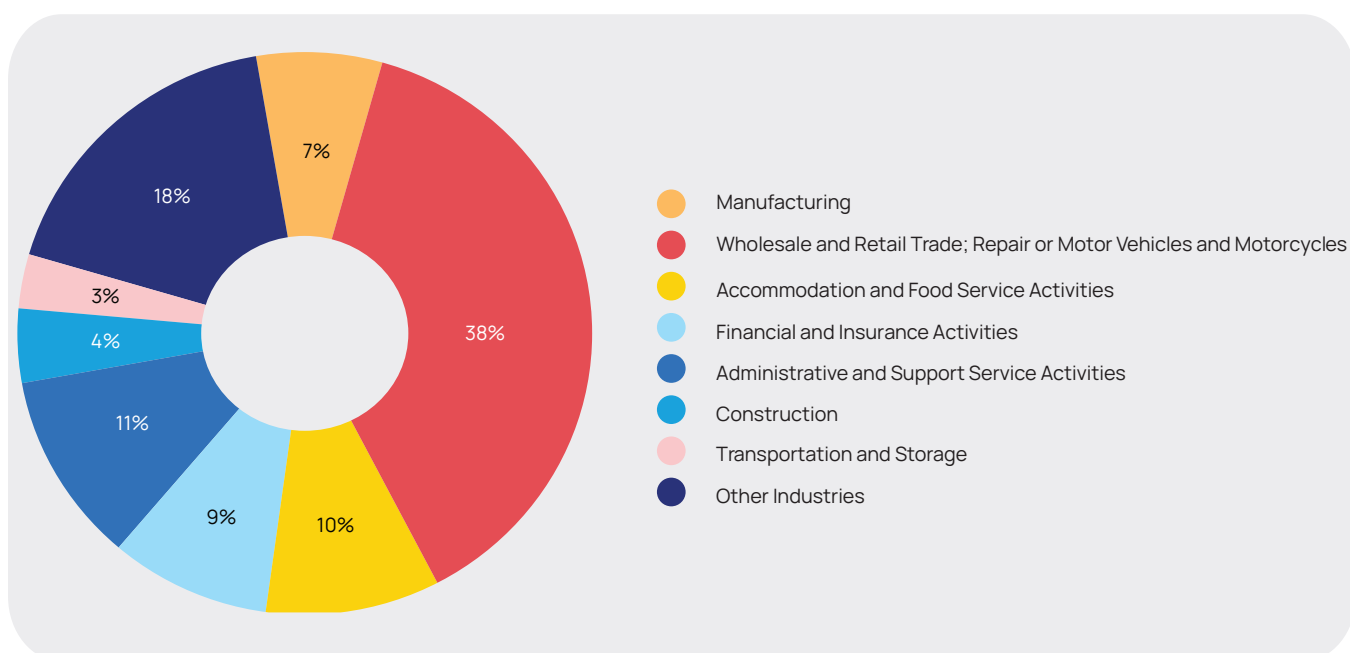


Figure 2.2.11
Inspected Establishments by Industry, 2018-2022

Source: Bureau of Working Conditions



Sectoral coverage. Inspection activities during the same period covered mostly the wholesale and retail trade sector at 38 percent. Industries that have low inspection coverage have relatively high compliance rates. Figure 2.2.11 presents the top seven industries which labor inspection covered during the period 2018-2022.

Compliance with labor standards. The initial compliance of the establishments inspected was below the 70 percent target; however, after the remediation period, the compliance rates exceeded the set target. Data show that compliance with general labor standards (GLS) remained high in the past five years. However, for the period 2018-2022, inspected establishments encountered difficulties in complying with OSHS, particularly with the statutory requirements on OSH personnel and facilities mandated under R.A. 11058.³⁸ Initial compliance rate of the establishments inspected were below the 70 percent target. In 2019 and 2020, even after the remediation period, compliance rate remained below the 70 percent target with 58.36 percent and 60.75 percent, respectively. Challenges in OSHS compliance may be attributed to the fact that the amended OSHS law which introduced additional standards, became effective in 2019.

The transition was further impeded by the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020 during which many OSHS training institutions temporarily halted the conduct of safety training. In contrast, compliance with GLS remained high during the same period.

Compliance by industry. The construction industry has the lowest compliance rate with GLS at 69.1 percent, while the education industry has the lowest compliance rate with OSHS at 42.8 percent (Figure 2.2.14). The low GLS compliance rate of the construction industry could be attributed to short employment duration and invisible employer-employee relationship in sub-contracting arrangements. On the other hand, resource and capacity challenges constrain educational institutions to engage competent OSH personnel and provide OSH services to their employees.

³⁸ "An Act Strengthening Compliance with Occupational Safety and Health Standards and Providing Penalties for Violations Thereof".

Figure 2.2.12
Compliance with Occupational Safety and Health Standards, 2018-2022

Source: Bureau of Working Conditions

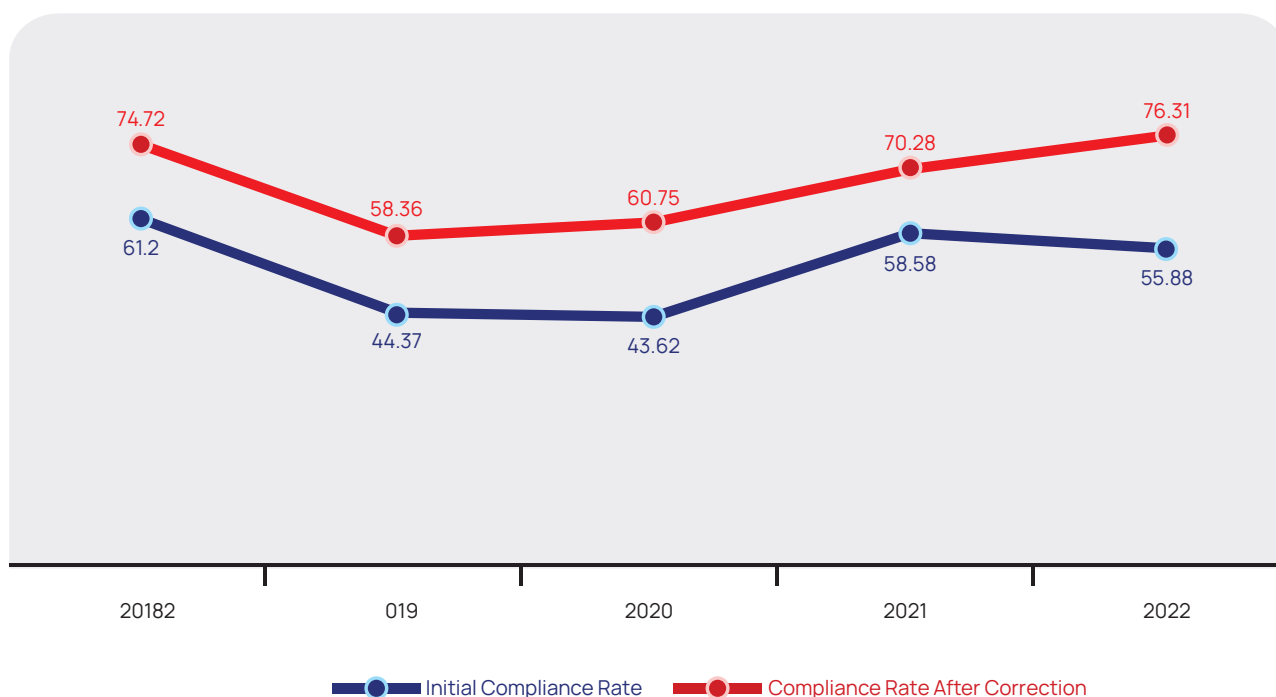
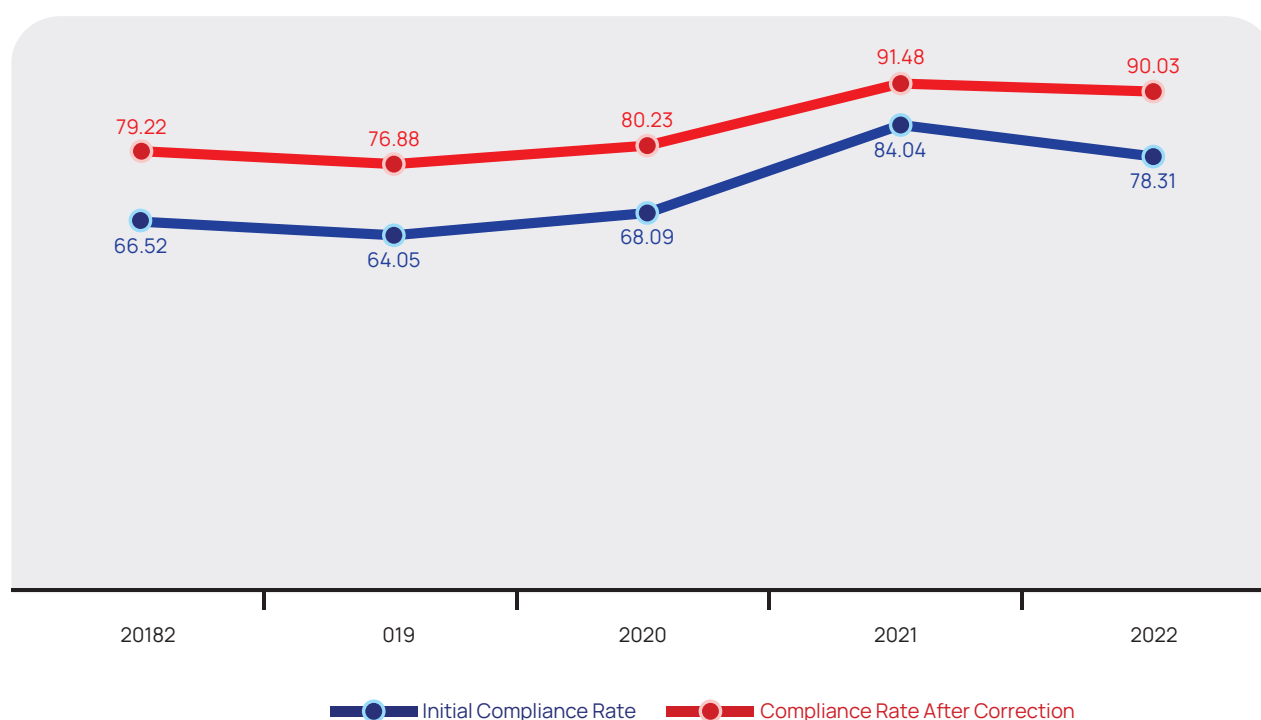


Figure 2.2.13
Compliance with General Labor Standards, 2018-2022

Source: Bureau of Working Conditions



Compliance with social security. Compliance of establishments with social security regulations means that their workers are not only registered members of the Social Security System (SSS), PhilHealth, and Pag-IBIG, but that their premium contributions are remitted properly and on time. Active membership in these social security systems assures workers access and entitlement to benefits in times of emergency and need. In other words, noncompliance of employers with social security regulations not only violates the right of workers to basic social security and social protection, but also constrains the capacity of social security agencies to sustain more robust and financially stable social security systems. The labor inspection program is a critical tool of government to achieve positive outcomes in these areas.

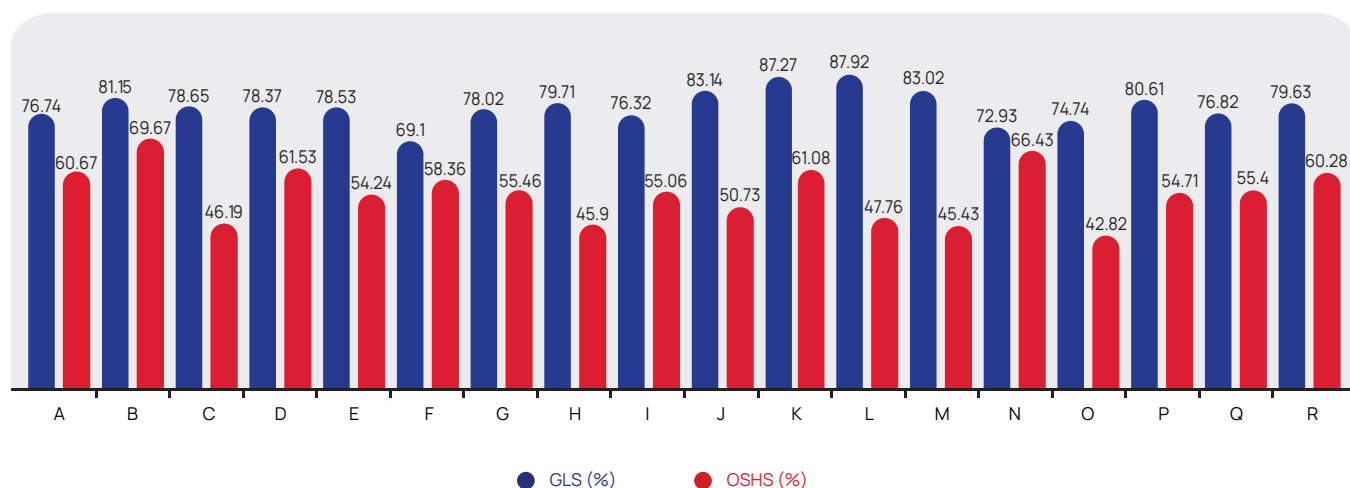
Table 2.2.3 shows this compliance rates of inspected establishments with social security regulations in terms of coverage and premium remittance in 2022 and 2023. While compliance of covered establishments in both areas during the past two years was recorded at above 90 percent, it is clear that much remains to be done to ensure that every Filipino worker in the formal sector is covered by social security (Table 2.2.3). Greater cooperation and sustained partnership among DOLE, SSS,

PhilHealth, and Pag-IBIG in facilitating remittance of social security contributions and in enforcing social security laws and regulations are crucial in attaining full coverage of formal sector workers under social security systems.

Compliance with GLS women-related rights. Meanwhile, there was also high compliance among inspected establishments with GLS women-related rights in 2022. These include compliance with mandated policies and programs promoting women's physical and mental well-being. For instance, almost all inspected establishments have existing program and policy on anti-sexual harassment and workplace breastfeeding. Likewise, almost all inspected firms have designated areas for lactation, and have set committees on decorum and investigation pursuant to the anti-sexual harassment and the safe spaces laws (Figure 2.2.15).

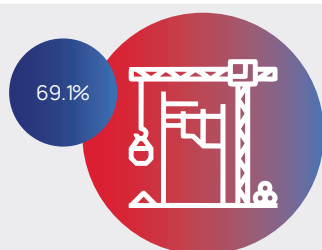
Figure 2.2.14
Compliance Rate by Industry, 2022

Source: Bureau of Working Conditions



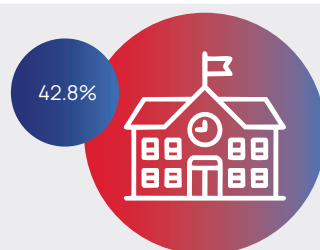
A	Agriculture, Forestry and Fishing
B	Mining and Quarrying
C	Manufacturing
D	Electricity, Gas, Steam and Air Conditioning Supply
E	Water Supply; Sewerage, Waste Management and Remediation Activities
F	Construction
G	Wholesale and Retail Trade; Repair of Motor Vehicles and Motorcycles
H	Transportation and Storage
I	Accommodation and Food Service Activities

J	Information and Communication
K	Financial and Insurance Activities
L	Real Estate Activities
M	Professional, Scientific and Technical Activities
N	Administrative and Support Service Activities
O	Education
P	Human Health and Social Work Activities
Q	Arts, Entertainment and Recreation
R	Other Service Activities



Construction

Establishments Inspected: 2,090
Establishments Inspected: 217,787



Education

Establishments Inspected: 1,605
Establishments Inspected: 65,085

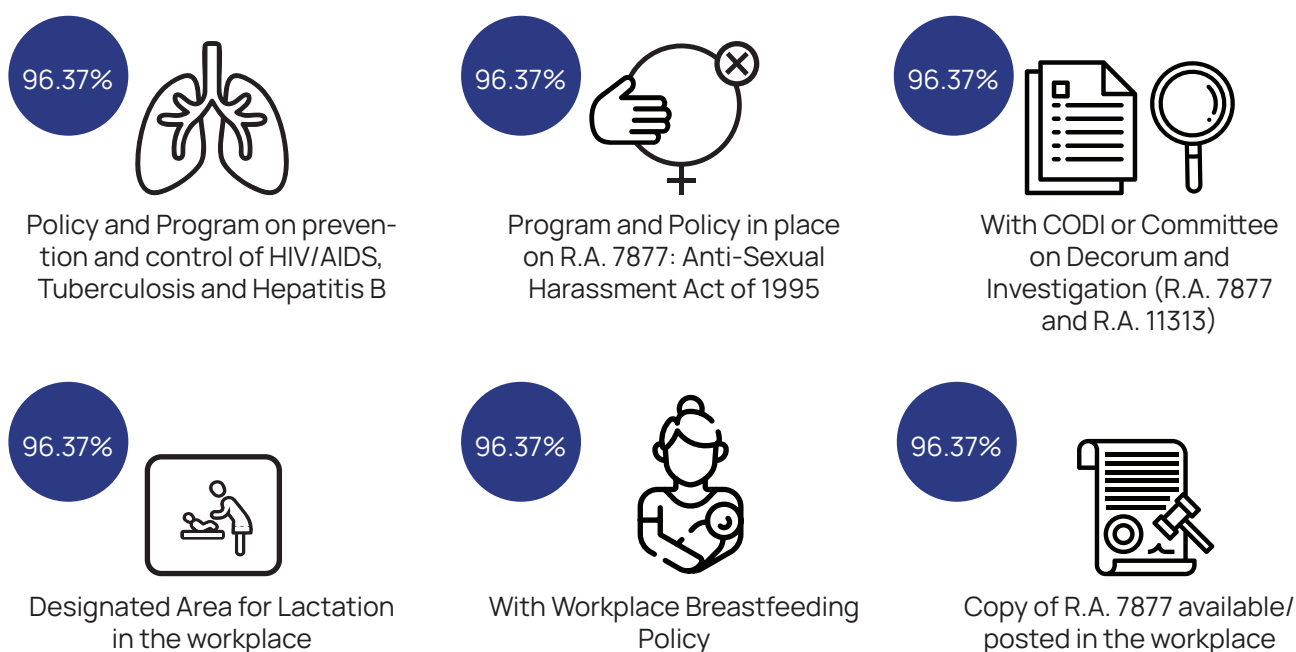
Table 2.2.3
Compliance Rate with Social Security, 2022-2023

Source: Bureau of Working Conditions

Compliant with	SSS		PhilHealth		Pag-Ibig	
	2022	2023	2022	2023	2022	2023
Coverage	93.48%	91.1%	94.02%	90.97%	92.67%	90.62%
Remittance	94.17%	92.34%	94.02%	92.37%	93.78%	92.16%

Figure 2.2.15
Compliance Rate with GLS Women-Related Rights, 2022

Source: Bureau of Working Conditions



Strengthening further the labor inspection system.

To widen the net and coverage of labor inspection and make it more effective and responsive, the DOLE issued new rules further strengthening the exercise of the visitorial and enforcement power of the Secretary of Labor and Employment. The new rules aim to “secur[e] a higher level of compliance with general labor standards, occupational safety and health standards, and other social legislations; and ensure continuity and sustainability of compliance in all workplaces.”³⁹ Labor standards will now be administered and enforced through three approaches, namely: a) Technical and Advisory Visit (TAV); b) Labor Inspection; and c) Occupational Safety and Health Investigation.

TAV is designed for micro establishments which dominate MSMEs. It may be conducted through online session wherein micro establishments may enroll in self-paced technical advisory modules through the learning management system. The establishment shall complete the modules within one month from registration.

Micro establishments may also attend technical and advisory module in an onsite session organized by the DOLE regional office in coordination with the LGU and/or other partners. Finally, micro establishments may also enroll in the onsite sessions

and attend virtual meetings and webinars through various online collaboration platforms.

Regularization of contractual workers. The previous administration adopted new rules on job contracting/sub-contracting⁴⁰ and used the inspectorate system to prevent non-permissible forms of contracting and subcontracting arrangements which undermine the constitutional and statutory right of workers to security of tenure. Based on the DOLE administrative data, and as Figure 2.2.16 shows, the campaign against illicit forms of contractualization, mainly pursued through labor inspection, is reported to have led to the regularization of 653,528 contractual workers during the period 2016-2022. In 2018 and 2019, it is reported that 321,351 and 183,373 contractual workers were regularized, respectively.

However, it was also in 2019 when the incidence of regularization started to decline significantly. During the height of the pandemic in 2020, the number of regularized workers dropped to 27,400, further sliding to 23,181 in 2021 and 5,283 in 2022.

³⁹ DOLE Department Order No. 238, Series of 2023, or the Rules on the Administration and Enforcement of Labor Standards, was issued on April 12, 2023.

⁴⁰ Department Order No. 174, Series of 2017, or the Rules Implementing Articles 106 to 109 of the Labor Code, as renumbered.

The same data also show that 486,694 workers or 74.5 percent of the total were voluntarily regularized by their principals. On the other hand, 166,477 workers were regularized as a result of labor inspection. The remaining 357 were regularized through NCMB mechanism.⁴¹ Further analysis of available data might provide additional insights on the demographics of regularized workers, including the nature of their jobs and skills and the period of their employment as contractual workers, the nature of their work assignments as regular workers, and the sector or industry of the principals that absorbed them as permanent workers.

Challenges to realize labor guarantees. The DWCP has also recognized that despite the presence of comprehensive legislations on GLS, OSHS, and standards relating to termination of employment, there are outstanding challenges that constrain the realization of the labor guarantees in the Constitution. There are still common violations of standards, some of which were discussed in the

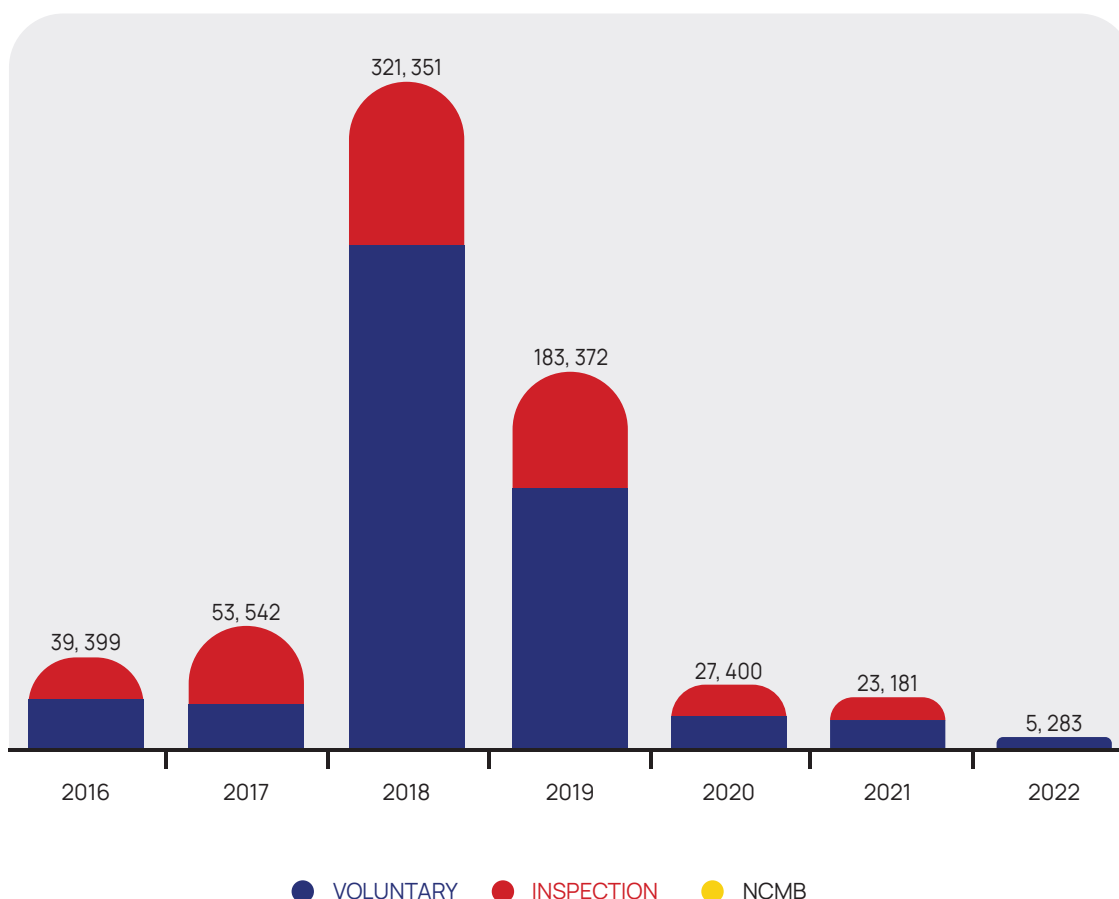
previous sections. Further, the effectiveness of inspection and labor dispute resolution mechanisms remain hampered by the high volume of cases, multiplicity or duplicity of mechanisms, complexity and litigiousness of procedures, and the need to continuously upgrade the administrative and technical capacity of officials to perform their functions.⁴² While the administrative data show high disposition rates, they also show low enforcement rates at the same time. This means that more should be done to ensure better execution of orders and judgments. In 2023, the DOLE started addressing this challenge through regular monitoring of satisfaction rates.

⁴¹ Regularization through inspection happens when a principal has regularized the contractual worker or workers deployed in their establishment in compliance with the order issued by the DOLE through its regional offices. On the other hand, voluntary regularization contemplates situations wherein the establishment has made a commitment to give their contractual employees regular or permanent status and making good of said commitment.

⁴² Decent Work Country Programme Philippines 2022-24, p. 12.

Figure 2.2.16
No. of Contractual Workers Regularized, 2016-2022

Source: Bureau of Working Conditions Administrative Data



Inclusivity of labor standards as instruments to realize labor guarantees is a key policy concern.

Labor standards are generally applicable to the formal sector where employer–employee relationships are clearer. Therefore, workers are covered by minimum legal protection, rights and remedies. The protective divide and corresponding inequality of social outcomes tend to widen in sectors where the existence of an employer–employee relationship is less clear, as well as in the country’s less industrialized and less urbanized regions where most employment is informal. With this, a broader policy challenge puts into question how the scope and protective coverage of labor standards can be adapted to apply to precarious and ambiguous work relationships and support the transition of the informal to the formal economy.⁴³

Labor migration governance. The DWCP notes that the ASEAN Consensus on the Protection and Promotion of the Rights of Migrant Workers (2017) can help improve governance of labor migration. This document renewed the call for cross-border recognition of the rights of migrant workers to organize and to bargain, as well as to be accorded portable social protection wherever they may be deployed. Another positive development that could present new opportunities is a gradual shift in perspective. Regional and global integration has brought migration for work to another frontier: sharing valuable resources consisting of professionals and highly skilled workers who freely move across borders. It is now an opportune time for the country to re-examine its international labor migration policy from that of temporary employment and welfare to a more comprehensive migration and development perspective.⁴⁴

Sectoral representation in tripartite bodies. Right after assuming office, the new DOLE leadership started to reconstitute tripartite mechanisms to address the shared concern among workers’ and employers’ organizations that they were not afforded the right to nominate the sectoral representatives appointed to tripartite bodies in accordance with the law. As a result of this initiative, all sectoral appointees to tripartite bodies under the DOLE’s umbrella have come from the sector being represented. In fact, based on BLR records, for the period November 2022 to April 2024, a total of 200 sectoral representatives had been appointed to various tripartite bodies with policymaking,

regulatory, and consultative functions. Of this total, 95 were appointed by the President, while the remaining 105 were appointed by the Secretary of Labor and Employment to various Regional Tripartite Industrial Peace Councils (RTIPCs).⁴⁵

The challenge now is how to ensure the effectiveness and inclusiveness of representation given the declining union membership. Corollary to this is the long-standing issue on how to expand the space for social dialogue and make it more vibrant and inclusive, and to enhance the capacity of sectoral representatives to engage through tripartite consultation and decision making. Bringing in new blood and fresh ideas to the current crop of representatives as well as including non-traditional sectors including those from the informal economy and civil society can be beneficial.⁴⁶

⁴³ *Decent Work Country Programme Philippines 2022-24*, p. 12.

⁴⁴ *Decent Work Country Programme Philippines 2022-24*, p. 12.

⁴⁵ The breakdown of appointments are as follows: NWPC and RTWPBs - 52; NTIPC - 33; ECC - 1; NLRC - 1; TESDA - 2; TVAAC - 2; SSC - 3; BCDA - 1, and RTIPCs - 105.

⁴⁶ *Decent Work Country Programme Philippines 2022-24*, p. 13.

Sub-chapter 2.3. Building an equitable and inclusive social protection

An equitable and inclusive social protection (SP) is a critical element to ensuring decent work and productive employment. Toward this end, it is important to further strengthen and rationalize the country's SP system characterized by various programs and services scattered among different agencies. Streamlining these fragmented programs will maximize impact and help ensure adequacy and sustainability of benefits. The low expenditure on social protection and limited coverage of social protection must also be addressed, as majority of households in the lower 40 percent are not

covered by social protection. It is also necessary to refocus social protection programs by establishing a complementary mix of passive welfare measures and active labor market programs. Finally, a rationalized and integrated SP system must cover population groups in unique economic, social and geographic situations, such as persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples, workers in the informal economy, online and platform workers, migrant workers, especially the undocumented, and children who confront continuing political and governance challenges.

Assessment and Challenges

Moving towards universal social protection. Recent legislations have underpinned the expansion of the country's social protection coverage in terms of healthcare benefits,⁴⁷ maternity benefits,⁴⁸ institutionalization of unemployment insurance, and expanded compulsory coverage to migrant workers.⁴⁹ Steady and sustained increases in budgetary allocations to social protection programs over the years have also resulted in higher number of beneficiaries and bigger amount of assistance and benefits. The recent presidential approval of the implementation of the Social Protection Floor (SPF) seeks to ensure minimum social security guarantees over the life cycle of every Filipino.⁵⁰ However, despite these concrete measures, much remains to be done to realize the goal of a universal, modern, and integrated social protection system in the country.

Low social protection expenditure and coverage. The World Social Protection Report 2020–22 of the ILO (2022) shows that the country's SP expenditure in 2021 was only 2.6 percent of GDP. This is relatively lower than the Asia-Pacific average (7.5%) and that of Vietnam (4.3%), Malaysia (4.2%), and Thailand (3.0%). In terms of SP coverage of its population, the Philippines (36.7%) also lags behind the Asia Pacific region's average of 44.1 percent, as well as Thailand's (68%) and Vietnam's (38.8%), but ahead of Indonesia's (27.8%) and Malaysia's

(27.3%). In addition, the COVID-19 package as a percentage of GDP in the country (8.6%) is lower than the average in Asia and Pacific (Table 2.3.1).

The PDP noted the role of social protection programs in mitigating the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic, particularly the Social Amelioration Program (SAP) which prevented about four million Filipinos from falling into poverty. A World Bank (WB) estimate suggests that the poverty rate would have been almost 2 percentage points higher in 2020 in the absence of government assistance. However, the pandemic exposed the weaknesses of the SP system in terms of the lack of a single and unified database of beneficiaries.

⁴⁷ Republic Act No. 11223, or Universal Health Care Act.

⁴⁸ Republic Act No. 11210, or 105-Day Expanded Maternity Law.

⁴⁹ Republic Act No. 11199, or Social Security Act of 2018.

⁵⁰ The Social Protection Floor (SPF) is a nationally defined set of basic social security guarantees that secure protection aimed at preventing or alleviating poverty, vulnerability and social exclusion. The SPF includes access to essential health care, including maternity care; basic income security for children; basic income security for persons in active age; and basic income security for older persons.

This left various government agencies mandated to implement the SAP, such as the DSWD, DILG, LGUs, and even the DOLE, with no choice but to use different beneficiary targeting protocols. This situation hampered the efficiency and effectiveness of service delivery.⁵¹

Emergency employment programs like the Tulong Panghanapbuhay sa Ating Disadvantaged/Displaced Workers (TUPAD) and the Department of Social Welfare and Development's (DSWD) Assistance to Individuals in Crisis Situations (AICS) play a critical role in the social protection framework. These programs provide immediate, albeit temporary, financial relief and income support to vulnerable workers. While they contribute to social protection expenditure, they should not be considered standalone solutions. Instead, they should be integrated into a broader, more sustainable social protection system that includes long-term strategies for employment, income security, and access to social services.

Another challenge is to ensure equal access to SP programs and services, especially among vulnerable sectors and poor households. Based on the merged Labor Force Survey–Annual Poverty Indicator Survey (LFS–APIS), households in the bottom 40 percent of the income distribution consistently registered lower SP coverage in 2017, 2019, and 2020 (without the SAP grants) than for all households. Their coverage only increased, though minimally, in 2020 when the SAP grants were added.

Social insurance coverage. Table 2.3.3 shows the mixed impact of the pandemic on the number of economically active populations contributing to a pension scheme. For SSS, its contributing members declined by 1.446 million from 17.627 million in 2019 to 16.181 million in 2020. This slide continued in 2021 (15.445 million) and 2022 (15.441 million).

⁵¹ PDP 2023-2028, p. 84.

Table 2.3.1
Social Protection Coverage and Expenditure in Selected Countries

Source: International Labour Organization, 2021 as cited in PDP 2023-2028; Asian Development Bank (ADB)

Country	Social Protection Coverage of Population	Social Protection Expenditure Excluding Health as Share of GDP (%)	COVID-19 Package as Percentage of GDP (%)
Philippines	36.7	2.6	8.6
Indonesia	27.8	1.3	11
Malaysia	27.3	4.2	44
Thailand	68	3.0	22
Vietnam	38.8	4.3	7.9
Asia and Pacific Average	44.1	7.5	13.8

Table 2.3.2
Estimate of Social Protection Coverage among Philippine Households, 2017, 2019, and 2020

Source: NEDA Social Development Services estimates; Philippine Statistics Authority. Various years. LFP-APIS as cited in PDP 2023-2028.

Households	2017 (%)	2019 (%)	2020 (without SAP, %)	2020 (With SAP, %)
Bottom 40%	57.29	61.79	66.09	91.05
All Households	65.78	72.85	73.14	90.69

The obvious reason for this decline are the massive job losses in the private sector during the pandemic. In terms of percent share, it represented a substantial decline of 9.4 percent from 39.4 percent in 2019 to 24.3 percent in 2021. However, there was a notable recovery in 2022 as the share of active contributing members bounced back to 30 percent.

On the other hand, the number of contributing members to GSIS registered a modest increase of 39,000 from 1.873 million in 2019 to 1.912 million in 2020. This upward trend continued in 2021 (1.951 million) and 2022 (1.972 million). In terms of percent share, however, there were actually slight decreases in 2021 (4.1%) and 2022 (3.9%).

High income inequality and social protection coverage. The merged LFS-APIS survey also looked at households with at least one member covered by SSS, GSIS, Private Life Insurance and/or Health Maintenance Organization per income decile (%). As shown in Figure 2.3.1, there is consistently less coverage among households from the bottom 40 percent while more than half of the households from the 6th to 10th deciles have higher coverage. When income goes higher, the SP coverage goes higher too. As the income decreases, the SP coverage declines also. Through this figure, we can assess the need to address the SP coverage in the country. Low coverage and high income inequality are positively correlated (Figure 2.3.1).

The current design of social protection programs in the Philippines has often resulted in regressive outcomes, where benefits do not proportionately reach the most vulnerable, thereby exacerbating income inequality. To address these disparities, the Social Protection Floor (SPF) framework should be adopted as a guiding principle. The SPF ensures that all citizens, particularly those in lower-income brackets, have access to essential services and income security, thereby promoting fairness and equity. By restructuring social protection programs under the SPF, we can create a more inclusive system that effectively reduces inequality and provides equitable outcomes for all.

Child laborers and other vulnerable children. An equitable and inclusive social protection must also address the vulnerabilities of Filipino children, particularly those engaged in child labor, children in street situations, children in conflict situations,

and children in conflict with the law. The SP system must create the conditions and provide the tools toward the progressive elimination of child labor in the country. In 2021, the total number of children considered engaged in child labor was estimated at 935,000. This was higher than the 597,000 children in child labor situation reported in 2020, and the 640,000 children believed to be engaged in child labor in 2019 (Figure 2.3.2).

In terms of sectoral concentration, 62 percent or 579,000 child laborers were in the agriculture sector, with services and industry sectors accounting for 32 percent (299,000) and 6 percent (58,000), respectively (Figure 2.3.3). Meanwhile, in terms of geographical concentration, Northern Mindanao (Region 10) recorded the most number of child laborers, followed by Central Visayas (Region 7), SOCCSKSARGEN (Region 12), Western Visayas (Region 6), and CALABARZON (Figure 2.3.4).

Table 2.3.3
SSS/GSIS Contributing Members and Percent Share of Economically Active Population
Contributing to a Pension Scheme by Type of Pension, 2018-2022

¹ SSS data on Overseas Filipino Workers excluded in the computation as they are not counted as part of the country's economically active population labor force

² Refers to separated workers/members and non-working spouses (NWS)

Source: GSIS, SSS, PSA Labor Force Survey

	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022
Percent Share of Economically Active Population Contributing to a Pension Scheme (%)	41	43.6	32.4	28.5	33.9
GSIS	4.2	4.2	4.3	4.1	3.9
SSS¹	36.8	39.4	28.1	24.3	30.0
Contributing Members (000)	18,360	19,500	18,093	17,396	17,413
SSS	16,540	17,627	16,181	15,445	15,441
Employees	12,277	13,055	12,365	11,618	12,035
Domestic Workers	21	11	5	5	1
Self-employed	1,199	1,127	777	665	649
Voluntary ²	2,494	2,762	2,489	2,331	2,304
Overseas Filipino Workers	549	672	543	507	
Unidentified				318	
GSIS	1,820	1,873	1,912	1,951	1,972
Total Labor Force (000)	43,460	44,692	43,871	47,701	50,080
Employed	1,160	42,413	39,352	43,980	47,583

Figure 2.3.1
Social Protection Coverage by Income Decile, 2017, 2019 and 2020

Source: 2017, 2019, and 2020 merged data from Philippine Statistics Authority, Various years.
LFP-APIS as cited in PDP 2023-2028.

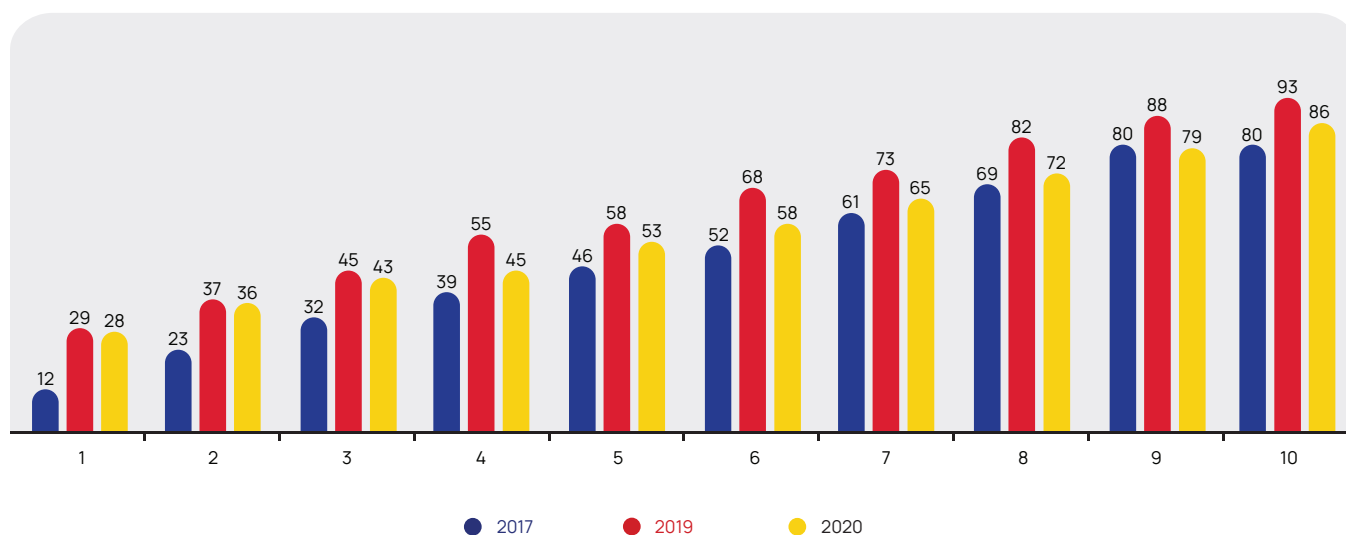


Figure 2.3.2
Total Number of Child Laborers 5 to 17
Years Old (in '000)

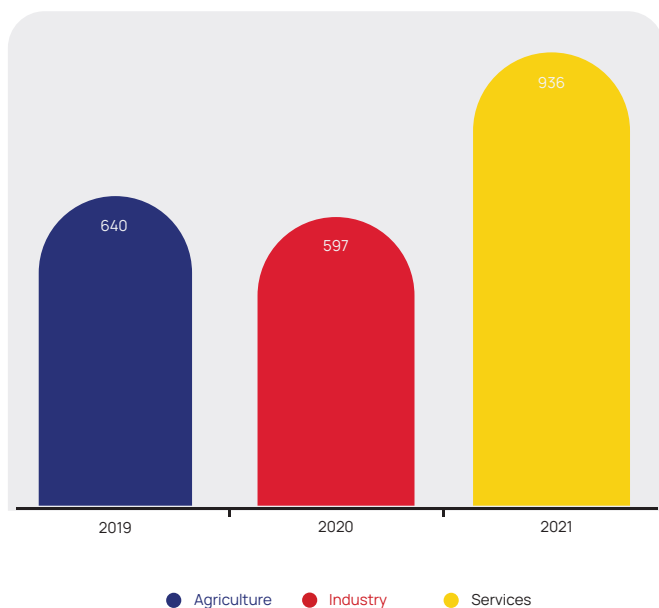


Figure 2.3.3
No. of Child Laborers 5 to 17 Years Old
by Industry (in '000)

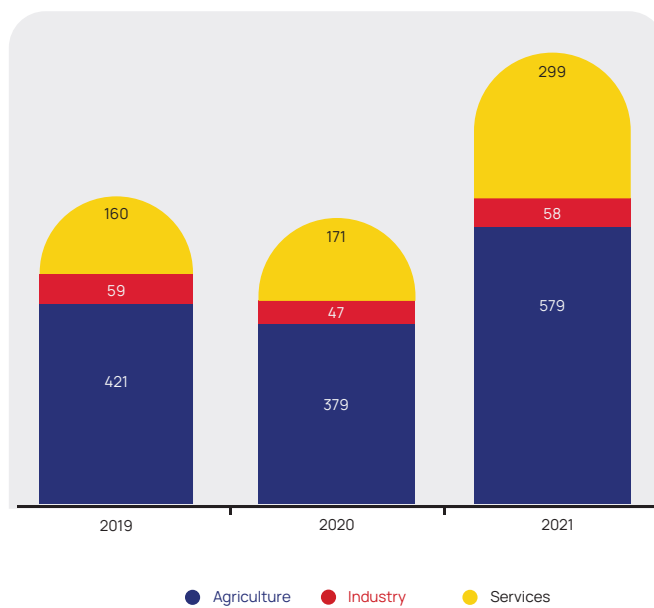
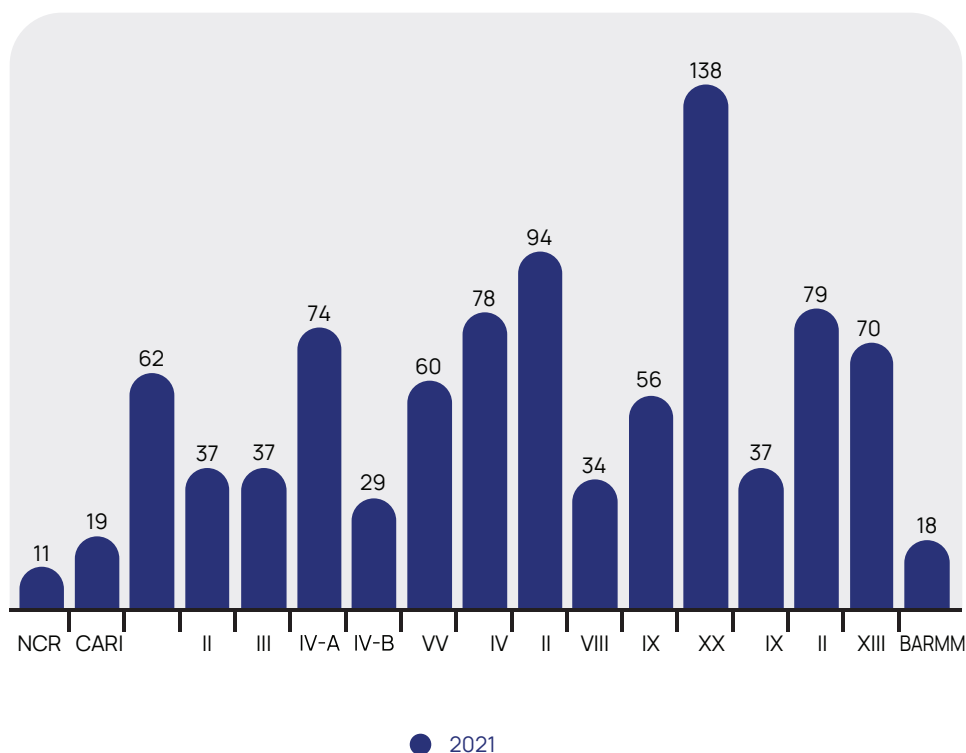


Figure 2.3.4
No. of Child Laborers 5 to 17 Years Old by Region: October 2021 (in '000)



Source: PSA

The specific strategies to build an equitable and inclusive social protection are discussed in detail in Chapter 3.

03

Priorities, Outcomes, Strategies, and Targets

Priorities, Outcomes, Strategies, and Targets

The PLEP envisions decent and productive work and employment opportunities for every Filipino worker willing to work. It recognizes the transformative capacity of decent and productive work to empower Filipino workers and their families, enable them to overcome economic challenges, allow them to unlock their full potentials and sustain quality lives, and become active and meaningful participants in nation-building and national development. This chapter outlines the strategies and action points and the desired outcomes in each of the three priority areas of the PLEP. These represent the shared development goals of the social partners and other stakeholders to bring about a world of work that we all want.

3.1. Maximizing Productive, Remunerative, Freely Chosen, and Sustainable Work and Employment Opportunities

This priority aims to bring about four specific outcomes: (1) increased employability; (2) expanded access to employment opportunities; (3) shared labor market governance; and (4) enhanced enabling

environment aimed at promoting sustainable and resilient enterprises, particularly, micro, small- and medium enterprises (MSMEs).

3.1.1. Increased Employability

Industrialization and full employment require specific policies on the labor-supply side, that is, building an educated and highly trained labor force across generations. Basic and higher education as well as technical and vocational education and training (TVET) must emphasize raising the quality of teachers and trainers; upgrading and modernizing course content and curricula; leveling up learning, skills and qualification standards with international standards; improving inputs and facilities such as computers, books, and school buildings; and ensuring affordable and equitable access to education and training institutions. A critical mass of educated and trained labor force supports employment creation, growth, productivity and incomes.

The full operationalization of the Philippine Qualifications Framework (PQF) and Philippine

Skills Framework (PSF) are key instruments in ensuring that education and TVET institutions are at par with international standards, and are attuned to industry requirements. The development and implementation of reliable achievement tests and skills assessment and certification methods facilitate matching of skills with work opportunities, minimize information asymmetry, reduce search and bargaining costs, and ultimately promotes fair exchanges between labor and employers.⁵²

⁵² The PDP recognizes the importance of “operationalizing the PQF” in the pursuit of lifelong learning. Toward this end, “the government will strengthen the PQF National Coordinating Committee and its governance structure, establish the PQF Secretariat, enable budgetary support mechanisms for institutionalized activities, develop monitoring and evaluation mechanisms, and make necessary revisions to the PQF” (p. 109). Likewise, the NTESDP aims to increase awareness and accelerate the operationalization of the PQF, and integrate PSF competencies in TVET courses (p. x and p. 85). However, neither the PDP nor the NTESDP provides a clear roadmap and funding mechanism for the “operationalization” of the PQF.

Supportive of industrial policy, education and TVET programs must be market-driven and must meet the requirements of industries identified to have high-growth potentials. Currently, industries with high-growth and job-rich potentials include Information Technology-Business Process Management (IT-BPM), which contribute to the rapid growth, for instance, of retailing and wholesaling; education; and financial services, including banking and insurance. Other key employment generators (KEGs) include construction, transportation and logistics, health and wellness, tourism, manufacturing, creative industries, education, and energy. These sectors have adopted their respective roadmaps identifying both in-demand and emerging occupations. The promising potential for decent work creation of green, digital and care economies has also been recognized. Learning-by-doing and increasing returns are growth-enhancing features of these industries, enhancing their demand for labor.

Rendering all education levels and making TVET training responsive to professional development and labor-market requirements, especially for the youth, are critical in reinforcing core employability skills. A national policy for lifelong learning is essential in a setting where new technologies continue to emerge, particularly those that put routine assembly work at risk from automation, robotics and artificial intelligence.

To bring about increased employability, the PLEP will pursue the following main strategies:

- **Align developmental objectives for basic and higher education, TVET and professional development based on labor-market requirements.**
- **Adapt content of training standards, modules and curricula to emerging, in-demand, and hard-to-fill occupations in identified key employment growth sectors (e.g., IT-BPM, agriculture).**
- **Constantly reinforce core employability knowledge and skills in basic and higher education and in TVET with emphasis on science, technology, engineering, and mathematics.**
- **Develop modern and responsive TVET**

apprenticeship, basic and higher education, and professional development interventions aligned with emerging trends or demands from industry, including green skills and green jobs.

- **Establish skills assessment mechanisms and certification programs to strengthen ladderized curricula and to recognize prior learning and micro-credentialing.**
- **Align professional standards and licensure examinations with international standards.**
- **Increase investments and subsidies in TVET human resources, basic and higher education, entrepreneurship, digitalization initiatives, and innovation facilities in response to or in anticipation of new work processes, particularly those brought about by Artificial Intelligence, the Fourth/Fifth Industrial Revolution, and the effects of and responses to climate change.**
- **Develop and promote a national policy for lifelong learning.**
- **Increase awareness and adoption of the Philippine Qualifications Framework and Philippine Skills Framework, especially in key employment generating sectors.**
- **Resolve the issue of qualification standards in hiring Senior High School (SHS) graduates through establishment of clear qualification standards that validate the skills and competencies of SHS graduates, ensuring they meet the minimum requirements for various job roles, particularly in sectors where SHS graduates are most likely to be employed.**
- **Intensify participation in youth employability programs.**

3.1.2. Expanded Access to Employment and Work Opportunities

As important as empowering workers with skills and competencies is ensuring that they have equal access to employment and work opportunities. The primary intervention for this purpose is an open, public and freely-accessible Labor Market Information System (LMIS) that facilitates the efficient flow of labor market information, matching of skills with jobs with reduced time and costs, and counselling and referral services. The institutionalized mechanisms for this are the Public Employment Service Offices (PESOs), which are managed by local government units under the technical supervision of DOLE. The technology backbone of the LMIS is the PhilJobNet and the PESO Employment Information System (PEIS). Consistent with international standards, the LMIS should be run by professional managers and technical staff.

To bring about equal and expanded access to employment and work opportunities, the PLEP will pursue the following main strategies:

- **Integrate and strengthen all employment facilitation services, including career development support and conduct of sector-specific job fair activities.**
- **Maximize and promote the utilization of PESOs and Community Training and Employment Coordinators (CTECs) towards the provision of core public employment services (PES) e.g., job placement and referral, provision of LMI, and career development support.⁵³**
- **Tap resources of local governments, including barangays, and capacitate them in profiling skills and training of jobseekers, especially self-employed. For self-employed individuals, the strategy should include providing access to business development services, financial literacy programs, and skills upgrading. This will help them formalize their businesses, improve productivity, and expand their income-generating opportunities.**
- **Anticipate skill needs in priority sectors through labor market forecasting, ensuring these are all market-driven initiatives.**
- **Strengthen technical capacity to develop robust, dynamic, and responsive labor-market information systems.**
- **Update the branding, user experience, structure, architecture, connectivity, and infrastructure of the PhilJobNet and PESO Employment Information System, as benchmarked against private job portals.**
- **Promote PhilJobNet as labor market information and job-matching portal, including development of digital platform (i.e., mobile app).**
- **Provide updated labor market information through PhilJobNet including graduates from education and training institutions, and develop the ability to filter locality.**
- **Intensify participation in employment programs for the youth, marginalized, disadvantaged, freelance, gig economy, vulnerable sectors, and in geographically isolated and disadvantaged areas.**
- **Provide emergency employment and training support to displaced workers due to manmade disasters and natural calamities.**
- **Develop programs and policies that address all forms of labor market discrimination in work, education, and training.**

⁵³ The DOLE and the DILG have partnered to ensure continuing PESO institutionalization at the local level. Institutionalization is among the five core agenda of PESOs, which also include digitalization, capacity-building, strengthening of government-industry-academe collaboration, and focus on its core functions, namely, job search and placement, LMI, implementation of active labor market programs, unemployment insurance, and labor policies, and provision of regulatory services.

- **Implement responsive regulation of recruitment, placement, and related activities such as job fair, contracting, alien and local employment (PEA), including digital labor-market intermediaries to ensure the protection of jobseekers.**
- **Strengthen the reintegration program of the Department of Migrant Workers (DMW), with the involvement of PESOs.**

3.1.3. Shared Labor Market Governance

Maximizing productive, remunerative, freely-chosen, and sustainable work and employment opportunities requires collaboration between government, workers and industry, consistent with the principle of tripartism and the recognition that as social partners, workers and employers preferably through their organizations, should be involved in policy and decision-making processes. For this purpose, the PLEP will pursue the following strategies:

- **Strengthen linkages and collaboration among government and industry associations, enterprises, youth organizations, PESOs, Job Placement Offices, and social partners to emphasize shared responsibility in promoting, implementing, and monitoring employment, skills, labor standards, and professional development policies and strategies, and fully supporting the innovation centers.**
- **Align policies on local and overseas employment by harmonizing standards on workers' rights, skills development, and social protection to prevent a brain drain and ensure that overseas Filipino workers (OFWs) are adequately prepared for reintegration into the local labor market. Collaboration between relevant agencies, including the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE) and the Department of Migrant Workers (DMW), is essential to streamline these policies and create a coherent framework that benefits all Filipino workers.**
- **Design mechanisms to ensure inclusive participation and equitable access to education and skills development programs.**
- **Tap the private sector towards financing skills trainings by allotting a portion of their sales to skills training programs.**
- **Map or forecast areas of industries to enable workers and employers to strategically adapt to the effects of technological change, climate change, green technologies, and situations of conflict.**
- **Intensify advocacy support of government and social partners through skills development programs to promote a sustainable environment and just transition.**
- **Mainstream gender and green competencies in training standards, modules, and curricula.**
- **Ensure that representation and participation in tripartite mechanisms are genuine, inclusive, and gender-responsive, including opening of opportunities for tripartite participation or consultation in the development and implementation of the Philippine Qualifications Framework and Philippine Skills Framework.**

3.1.4. Enhanced Enabling Environment to Promote the Development of Sustainable and Resilient Enterprises, particularly for MSMEs

About 99.6 percent of all enterprises in the Philippines are micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs). MSMEs have different types and structures, and include cooperatives and social enterprises. They account for 65 percent of total employment and contribute 36 to 40 percent to GDP. While recognized as a key growth engine, MSMEs are faced with many challenges, including bureaucratic requirements, technology capability, access to markets and access to credit. Key policy and program interventions to promote MSMEs are technical assistance and enhanced capacity-building programs, including toolkits to enhance the sustainability. There should also be focus on easing business requirements and facilitating access to finance, improving productivity, upgrading processes and technologies, and incorporating green and sustainable practices. To promote the growth and development of MSMEs, the PLEP will focus on the following strategies:

- **Ensure effective and efficient use of tripartite and bipartite wage and productivity mechanisms.**
- **Provide technical assistance and enhance capacity-building programs for MSMEs (e.g., emerging technologies), including toolkits, to enhance the sustainability of MSMEs, social enterprises, and cooperatives, with a focus on facilitating access to finance, improving productivity, upgrading processes and technologies, and incorporating green and sustainable practices.**
- **Scale-up MSMEs by facilitating their access to credit, markets, and learning or mentoring opportunities.**
- **Accelerate the digitalization and innovation of MSMEs, including the adoption of e-commerce and Science, Technology, and Innovation initiatives.**
- **Identify areas and products for the establishment of technologically enhanced**

common facilities to promote MSME productivity, innovation, competitiveness, and linkage to the value/supply chain.

- **Strengthen linkages between the government's MSME interventions on entrepreneurship development and business start-up, and expansion survival, including public employment services for employers.**
- **Build linkages among SHS students and MSMEs for possible employment, including support to youth entrepreneurial initiatives.**
- **Conduct studies on the impact of free trade agreements on employment.**
- **Make labor regulation more flexible and market-driven.**

3.2. Forging Labor Market Governance that Ensures Respect for all Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work, International Labor Standards and Human Rights.

The 1987 Constitution mandates the State to afford full protection to labor, local and overseas, organized and unorganized, and promote full employment and equality of employment opportunities for all. It also guarantees the rights of all workers to self-organization, collective bargaining and negotiations, and peaceful concerted activities, including the right to strike in accordance with law, as well as their right to security of tenure, humane conditions of work, and a living wage. It also participates in policy and decision-making processes affecting their rights and benefits; promotes the principle of shared responsibility between workers and employers and the preferential use of voluntary modes in settling disputes, including conciliation, and shall enforce their mutual compliance therewith to foster industrial peace; regulate the relations between workers and employers, recognizing the right of labor to its just share in the fruits of production and the right of enterprises to reasonable returns to investments, and to expansion and growth. The Philippines also ratified 39 ILO Conventions, including the ten core conventions. These conventions are part of the law of the land.

For the private sector, the Labor Code of the Philippines and related laws put into effect the Constitution and the ILO conventions ratified by the Philippines. Under the Labor Code, the policy instruments to promote and protect rights at work are labor education, labor-management cooperation, collective bargaining, labor inspection, conciliation and mediation, and voluntary or compulsory arbitration. The laws provide for minimum labor standards, covering both general labor standards and occupational safety and health standards, as baselines in regulating employer-employee relationships. As a matter of policy, there is a preference for voluntary and consensual bipartite mechanisms such as collective bargaining and negotiation to regulate terms and conditions of employment over and above minimum labor standards. For this purpose, the right to organize is promoted and protected.

In the public sector, terms and conditions of employment are fixed by law. Public sector labor relations is regulated through Executive Order No. 180 and its implementing rules and regulations. Public sector employees have the right to self-organization and are allowed to negotiate with the agency where they are employed on matters that do not involve monetary or economic benefits.

The PLEP aims to promote and protect the fundamental principles and rights at work with three main outcomes:

- 1. Improved capacity of labor administration authorities to implement and enforce labor standards and social and welfare legislations, and to eliminate all forms of unacceptable work.**
- 2. Strengthened capacity of government and social partners in ensuring compliance with labor standards and effective participation in social dialogue and tripartite processes toward better, consensus-driven policies and decisions.**
- 3. Strengthened, modernized, and balanced policy, legal, and institutionalized frameworks on labor protection for all.**

3.2.1. Improving labor administration capacity

The main strategies in improving labor administration capacity to efficiently and effectively implement and enforce labor standards are the following:

- **Continuously enhance and upgrade the capacity of labor inspectors, conciliators, med-arbiters, regional directors, labor arbiters, voluntary arbitrators, and commissioners to efficiently and effectively administer, enforce or resolve cases arising from the application of labor laws.**
- **Implement a strategic compliance program and rationalize labor inspection approaches:**
- **Improve inspection targeting. Focus inspection and enforcement activities on establishments or industries which are subject of complaints, or those which are identified as highly-susceptible to violations.**
- **Use technical assistance visits to provide advisory services to micro and small enterprises to address general labor standards (GLS) and occupational safety and health standards (OSHS) compliance gaps.**
- **Harmonize inspection procedures of DENR, DOE, and DOLE on the mining industry.**
- **Observe timetables in the disposition of cases.**
- **Ensure prompt and effective execution and satisfaction of judgments.**

3.2.2. Strengthening capacities of Government and Social Partners

The main strategies in strengthening the capacity of the government and social partners in ensuring compliance with labor standards and effective participation in social dialogue and tripartite processes toward better, consensus-driven policies and decisions are as follows:

- **Enhance knowledge and common understanding of tripartite partners on the substantive and technical aspects of freedom of association, the rights to organize and to bargain, bipartism and tripartism, and shared responsibility in regulating labor-management relations.**
- **Design and implement modernized, updated, and problem-solving focused labor education programs for the tripartite partners.**
- **Improve capacity of social partners to effectively participate in crafting policies concerning terms and conditions of employment through participative workplace mechanisms.**
- **Design and implement technical assistance and capacity-building to strengthen workers' and employers' organizations in assisting and advising their members on labor relations matters.**
- **Complete and implement the Tripartite Roadmap on freedom of association consistent with Philippine laws and institutions and taking into account the recommendations of ILO supervisory bodies.**
- **Strengthen tripartism at national, regional and industry levels and ensure genuine and competency-based representation of workers and employers in tripartite consultative and decision-making bodies.**
- **Mobilize tripartite partners to strengthen**

advocacy efforts and to take action on social concerns affecting the world of work, such as promoting non-discrimination,

diversity and inclusion, and preventing gender-related violence and sexual harassment.

3.2.3. Modern and balanced policy, legal and institutional frameworks on labor protection for all

The major interacting forces in what has been described as a volatile, uncertain, complex and ambiguous world are globalization; the effects of climate change; the fourth and fifth industrial revolutions driven by technology, digitalization and artificial intelligence; cultural and geo-political tensions; stronger calls for equality, inclusion and social justice; and the effects of COVID-19. These forces have engendered profound transformations which, in turn, present continuing opportunities and challenges that have direct and indirect effects on employment and work relations. For workers, employers and entrepreneurs to get the most benefit from these transformations, responsive and adaptive policies and regulatory frameworks in the labor market that prioritize core issues and incorporate labor standards must be in place. In crafting adaptive policies and regulatory frameworks, and within the framework of tripartism and social dialogue, the following strategies shall be pursued:

- **Conduct review and regulatory impact assessment of laws, rules and regulations, particularly on the following:**
 - **Republic Act No. 6727 (Wage Rationalization Act).**
 - **Provisions of the Labor Code on contracting and subcontracting, including implementing rules and regulations.**
 - **Provisions of the Labor Code on freedom of association and the rights to organize and to bargain.**
 - **Provisions of the Labor Code on security of tenure.**
 - **Executive Order No. 180 and its implementing rules and regulations, in relation to ILO Convention No. 151 (Public sector labor relations).**
- **Devise recommendations on policy and regulatory frameworks for emerging work**

arrangements where employer-employee relationship is ambiguous.

- **Effectively operationalize the principle of shared responsibility between the social partners in settling labor disputes or conflicts at plant level and progressively modernize the labor dispute resolution system to speed up the resolution of cases and accommodate new and emerging work arrangements.**
- **Continuously promote use of labor-management cooperation, grievance and other similar plant-level mechanisms to prevent or resolve disputes, in both organized and unorganized establishments.**
- **Review provision of the Labor Code on small money claims and consider adopting summary procedures on such claims and similar claims.**
- **Continuously promote voluntary modes of settling or resolving disputes.**
- **Review the rules of procedure on voluntary arbitration and progressively strengthen and professionalize the voluntary arbitration program.**
- **Simplify rules on execution and satisfaction of judgments.**

The PLEP recognizes the labor sector's proposals to review Labor Code provisions on contracting and subcontracting, the rights to organize and to bargain, and security of tenure. These proposals will continue to be discussed through tripartite processes and social dialogue, with the expectation that eventual tripartite consensus on these issues will help facilitate positive legislative actions in due time.

3.3. Building an equitable and inclusive social protection

The PLEP seeks to extend social protection to all through enhanced and inclusive implementation of social protection policies, programs and mechanisms, as well as through strengthened policy and legal framework supported by research. There are many social protection programs implemented by various agencies. However, a rapid assessment reveals the low expenditure on social protection and coverage over a long period of time. Majority of households in the lower 40 percent are not covered by social protection, including indigenous peoples and informal sector workers. On the other hand, while the Philippines has been making steady progress in the elimination of child labor, the pandemic has brought about a slight increase in the number of child laborers across the country.

The major challenge involves rationalization of scattered social protection programs for maximum impact and refocusing social protection programs to combine passive welfare measures with more active labor market measures such as training and employment facilitation. A social protection database with adequate budgetary allocation will also be critical. Involvement of local government

units (LGUs) can also help optimize the delivery of social protection services. The enhanced social protection operational framework⁵⁴ seeks to address these challenges by adopting participatory and gender-sensitive strategies, which include strengthening SP implementation by LGUs, non-government organizations (NGOs) and civil society organizations (CSOs), building resilient and adaptive capacities, ensuring fiscal stability, institutionalizing monitoring and evaluation system, and ensuring convergence and community-driven development in the delivery of programs. The framework also adopted the progressive realization approach toward universal coverage through the social protection floor.

Equitable social protection that is accessible to all calls for two major outcomes: (1) enhanced and more inclusive implementation of social protection policies, programs, mechanisms, and; (2) strengthened policy, legal and institutional framework of social protection for all.

⁵⁴ The framework was adopted by the Social Development Committee in February 2019.

3.3.1. Enhanced and Inclusive Implementation of Social Protection

Under this outcome, the following strategies will be pursued:

- **Continue to implement emergency employment, subsidies, and cash transfers, and livelihood skills training program to vulnerable and marginalized workers linking it to active labor market policies and interventions**
- **Harmonize and streamline employment, livelihood, and support programs of government**
- **Conduct impact assessment and evaluate selected existing social protection programs for vulnerable and marginalized workers**
- **Strengthen convergence and collaboration (integrated approach, institutional strengthening) among government agencies on social protection programs to ensure sustainability of livelihood programs and greater impact**
- **Strengthen monitoring and control mechanisms in the implementation of programs**
- **Strengthen targeting of beneficiaries and monitoring of interventions**
- **Coordinate with DSWD and PSA (which is mandated to implement CBMS) on harmonization database/profiling of**

- beneficiaries to ensure coverage of intended beneficiaries.
- Strengthen data-collection mechanisms (including data disaggregation from a unified database) on the beneficiaries of social protection programs (guided by the Data Privacy Act).
- Intensify information dissemination of existing government programs at the local level including use of social-media platforms and other innovative communication strategies
- Development of IEC materials to educate and capacitate the beneficiaries about the benefits and requirements of SP programs.
- Intensify the role of LGUs on implementing SP programs on the following:
 - Monitoring, information dissemination, advocacy on child laborers with the support of local governments and improved delivery of services toward the progressive elimination of child labor.
 - Budget allocation for SP programs at local level.
- Strengthen advocacy for sustainable community or sector-specific micro-insurance schemes:
 - Promote savings, loan assistance, and insurance for the self-employed workers through micro-insurance schemes.
 - Link beneficiaries of the Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program (4Ps) to the active labor market with focus on providing them with comprehensive support that enables sustainable income generation. While micro-insurance can be part of the broader financial inclusion strategy, it should not be the primary focus of labor market interventions. Instead, efforts should be made to connect 4Ps beneficiaries with job placement services, entrepreneurship programs, vocational training, and productivity enhancement training that align with market demands. These initiatives will equip beneficiaries with the skills needed to thrive in a competitive labor market, increase their employability, and foster long-term economic independence.
- Develop insurance schemes for low-wage earners and informal sectors.
- Enhance and promote social insurance products and simplify the processes of availment.
- Ensure the adequacy of SP coverage on specific sectors (rural workers, PWDs, migrant workers, returning OFWs, women and youth, child laborers and families, etc.) and workers from new work arrangements (e.g., gig workers)
- Strengthen Gender and Development (GAD) Programs in the workplace to address discrimination including gender-based violence and harassment

The ratification by the Philippines of ILO Convention 190 (Violence and Harassment Convention, 2019) will further solidify the gains achieved so far to prevent and address violence and harassment in the country's workplaces, including gender-based violence and harassment.⁵⁵ It must be noted that in 2019, Republic Act No. 11313, or the "Safe Spaces Act" was enacted to provide protective measures against gender-based sexual harassment in streets, public spaces, online, workplaces, and educational or training institutions.⁵⁶ This law will help ensure that C190 will be enforced in both law and practice in the country.

⁵⁵ The Philippines ratified C190 on 11 December 2023 and deposited the instrument of ratification to the ILO on 20 February 2024. It is the first Asian country, and the 38th country in the world, to ratify the Convention. C190 was adopted in June 2019 by the International Labour Conference of the International Labour Organization, and came into force on 25 June 2021.

⁵⁶ R.A. 11313 was enacted on 17 April 2019.

In fact, R.A. 11313 has been incorporated into several DOLE issuances which provide appropriate mechanisms and interventions, including redress mechanisms, in cases of gender-based sexual harassment in the workplace.⁵⁷

⁵⁷ For instance, DOLE Department Order No. 230-21, which applies to: 1) employees covered by R.A.10361, or the "Domestic Workers Act" or "Batas Kasambahay"; 2) those employed in the informal economy; and, 3) those employed in establishments with ten or fewer employees. Another is Labor Advisory No. 03, Series of 2023, on Gender Equality in the Workplace, which aims to ensure women employees' protection against any form of gender-based sexual harassment (GBSH) in the workplace through the creation of a workplace policy against GBSH and the establishment of a Committee on Decorum and Investigation in cases of sexual harassment and gender based-sexual harassment in the workplace.

3.3.2. Strengthened Policy, Legal and Institutional Framework

In April 2023, the President and the NEDA Board approved the Social Protection Floor framework. This provides access to mandatory health care under the Universal Health Care Act (UHCA). To finance and sustain the latter, the need to appoint only competent people of integrity to head PhilHealth is essential. Equally important is a legal and administrative system that dictates strict compliance with the various laws governing social insurance, namely, GSIS, SSS, Pag-IBIG, and PhilHealth and their respective IRRs. The major strategies to strengthen social protection and make it more inclusive are as follows:

- **Implement Social Protection Floor (SPF) guarantees for healthcare, women and children, working age, and elderly.**
- **Develop policy advocacy agenda for recognition, promotion and enforcement of legal rights for informal-sector workers, IPs, PWDs and other vulnerable and marginalized groups.**
- **Allocate funds for SP programs through legislation and/or incorporation in LGU budgets.**
- **Intensify the enforcement of social-insurance benefits (SSS, Pag-IBIG, PhilHealth) towards improved coverage.**
 - **Simplify processes to facilitate better access to SP programs**
 - **Partner with the private sector in the delivery of social insurance and provision of assistance to preserve employment during crisis.**
 - **Access to more flexible financing schemes, particularly during crisis (emerging and re-emerging infectious diseases.**
- **Design SP programs that best cater to workers in alternative work arrangements**
- **Strengthen monitoring mechanisms, including harmonizing data for the effective planning and implementation of SP policies and programs.**
 - **Establish a data-sharing system among government agencies.**
 - **Enhance unified information system for access and availment of SP programs, such as pension.**
 - **Enhance data collection capacity of LGUs, NGAs, CSOs, and private sector.**
 - **Collect data on IPs, informal sector, and senior citizens**
- **Conduct technical study on a viable unemployment-insurance scheme with active labor market component.**
- **Introduce amendment to the Social Security Act (SSS) to create special programs for the special groups.**
- **Propose disability support allowance that will be linked to the active labor market by providing financial assistance to cover costs associated with workplace accommodations, skills training, and other support services that enhance employability. The goal should be to empower PWDs to participate fully in the labor market, reducing dependency on social assistance while promoting their economic and social inclusion.**

04

Legislative Agenda



Legislative Agenda

The PLEP will pursue a legislative agenda built on tripartite consensus to support its action points and strategies requiring legislation. The series of area-based consultations conducted as part of the PLEP formulation, has produced a comprehensive list of proposed bills encompassing the three priority areas. The proposals which are also included in the legislative agenda of both the PDP and the NTESDP shall form part of the PLEP legislative agenda. Other proposed legislative measures with tripartite consensus and support will also be part of the plan's legislative agenda.

4.1. Legislative Agenda

The legislative agenda under the PLEP should emphasize the immediate constitution of an oversight committee with high-level sectoral representation. This committee will be responsible for monitoring the implementation of the PLEP, ensuring that legislative measures are aligned with the plan's objectives, and providing oversight to the execution of key programs and policies. The establishment of this committee is critical for ensuring accountability, transparency, and the successful realization of the PLEP's goals.

Robust and well-functioning tripartite mechanisms are in place to enable the social partners to discuss issues of mutual concern and interest, including sectoral legislative priorities. These mechanisms will be further strengthened to provide the social partners with an effective platform where consensus on legislative priorities could be achieved. The PLEP Tripartite Oversight Committee will work with concerned agencies and other stakeholders to ensure that the plan's legislative agenda is properly communicated to, and effectively coordinated with Congress and the Presidential Legislative Liaison Office (PLLO).

Proposed bills with tripartite consensus will be submitted to the PLLO for possible inclusion in the Common Legislative Agenda (CLA). Proposals that are still in the early stages will continue to undergo tripartite consultations. To ensure evidence-based policymaking and enhance the political feasibility and administrative sustainability of the proposed measures, regulatory impact assessment (RIA)

will be made an integral part of the formulation and consultation process. Any proposed rules and regulations, whether new or amendatory, will be subjected to RIA as a matter of procedure. This approach supports the PDP goal of reducing the burden of regulation by streamlining unnecessary rules, reducing compliance costs, and constantly improving good regulatory practices in the public service.⁵⁸

Table 4.1.1 presents the proposed legislative measures covering the three priority areas on employment, labor market governance, and social protection.

⁵⁸ PDP 2023-2028, Chapter 10 - Promote Competition and Improve Regulatory Efficiency, pp. 205-206.

Table 4.1.1
Legislative Agenda⁶⁰

Legislative Agenda	Rationale/Key Features	Responsible Agency
Priority 1 - Employment		
Enterprise-Based Education and Training (EBET) Framework Act; Enterprise-Based Education and Training (EBET) Program Act	Aims to strengthen the enterprise-based apprenticeship program and training to raise the level of skills and competencies of Filipino students and fill the labor and personnel demands of industries, and rationalize the middle-level workers' training system by consolidating apprenticeship, dual training, on-the-job training programs and all other forms of industry-based training arrangement.	TESDA
Lifelong Learning Development Bill	Develop a Lifelong Learning Development Framework through the Philippine Qualifications Framework-National Coordinating Council (PQF- NCC). The PQF-NCC shall determine and set standards for developing action components and desirable success measures for promoting lifelong learning in cities, municipalities, and educational institutions.	PQF-NCC DOLE
Enterprise Productivity Act (Amendments to Productivity Incentives Act)	Fortify the intentions of the "Productivity Incentive Act of 1990" by promoting inclusive and sustainable work productivity programs. The Act aims to reinforce labor productivity by: (a.) establishing a Productivity Incentives Committee; (b.) adopting productivity incentive programs; (c.) granting productivity incentives to employees; and (d.) providing a tax incentive to business establishments for granting incentives to employees.	DOLE DTI
Magna Carta for MSMEs (R.A. 9501, amending R.A. 6977) amendment	Improved financial support and technical capacity-building programs for micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs). To support the recovery and growth of MSMEs, especially those hit hard by the pandemic, the amendment of the Magna Carta for MSMEs will provide access to support services, including financial support and technical capacity-building programs and reduce barriers to entry of new MSMEs by streamlining permitting requirements. To mainstream competition issues among MSMEs, the Amendment will also include the PCC in the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise Development Council.	DTI
Priority 2 - Labor Market Governance		
Ratification of ILO Convention 81- Labor Inspection Convention	Convention No. 81 is an international legal instrument that provides the international standards for labor inspection in industrial and commercial establishments. (Ongoing)	DOLE DFA
Ratification of ILO Convention 183 - Maternity Protection Convention	Convention No. 183 is an international legal instrument that provides rules for the adoption of national legislation for the promotion of health and safety of the mother and child, notably concerning the protection for pregnancy, the right to a maternity leave period, maternity benefits, and the right to return to the same position after giving birth.	DOLE DFA
Priority 3 - Social Protection		
Universal and Integrated Social Protection System	The need for a legal framework that will rationalize SP programs toward an integrated system where there is: 1) Recognition of SP as a basic right provided by the state; 2) Institutionalization of SP floor; 3) Establishment of effective coordination structures; 4) Establishment and updating of social registries; 5) Enhancement of digital payment platforms; and 6) Sustainable financing (See Subchapter 11.1) and partnerships with the private and civil society sectors.	DSWD NEDA DOF SSS GSIS
Expansion of Unemployment Insurance	This will expand the coverage and benefits of unemployment insurance under the Social Security System (SSS) and Government Service Insurance System (GSIS).	SSS GSIS DOLE
Disability Support Allowance	The bill seeks to grant a cash subsidy to supplement incomes of households with persons with disability.	National Council on Disability Affairs

⁶⁰ See PDP 2023-2028 (various chapters), pp. 98, 113, and 219; and NTESDP 2023-2028, pp. 95-96.

Work Protect Act of 2022	The proposed bill seeks to rationalize the Employees' Compensation Program by expanding the Employees' Compensation Commission (ECC), further defining its powers and functions, instituting reforms, and establishing the Philippine Workers' Safety and Health, Rehabilitation, and Compensation Corporation (Workprotect), repealing for this purpose Article 172 to Article 215 of Book IV, Title II of the Labor Code of the Philippines, otherwise known as Presidential Decree No. 626.	DOLE ECC SSS GSIS PhilHealth
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Cross-Cutting Bills and Other Non-Legislative Proposals. The sectoral consultations also produced proposals that cross-cut the three priorities. There are proposals to strengthen the skills profiling system through the National Skills Registration Program (NSRP), include barangay health workers (BHWs) in social protection programs and insurance, provide social pension to PWDs aged 59 years and below, extend additional leave benefits for parents with children with special needs, set up financing program for employers in case of national emergencies, and strengthen legal assistance in legal disputes. These proposals may be integrated in the other priority bills on employment, labor relations, labor standards, and social protection.

Other proposals are not necessarily legislative in nature, such as the one calling for review of the implementation of the First Time Jobseekers Act (R.A. 11261). These also include proposals which aim to: 1) laymanize or localize the DOLE's labor education program; 2) revisit the involvement and engagement of workers as members of the corps of labor laws compliance officers (who are now again officially called labor inspectors); 3) enhance digital infrastructure; 4) promote the use of social media and other online platforms; and 5) provide capacity-building and training to allow the delivery of modern technology to far-flung areas for information dissemination. These proposals will be further discussed and continue to be part of social dialogue and tripartite consultations.

Pending Bills in the 19th Congress. A number of bills relating to employment, labor market governance and social protection are presently pending in both the Senate and the House of Representatives. For instance, at least six bills have been filed in the Senate seeking reforms in the national apprenticeship program and strengthening of TVET and enterprise-based training program. Other pending bills cover a broad range of policy issues, such as the rights of government employees to self-organization, collective negotiation and peaceful concerted activities, minimum wage-

setting, security of tenure and contractualization, social security and unemployment insurance, protection and welfare of migrant workers and online platform workers, employment of foreign nationals, amendment of the Cooperative Code, and even omnibus revision of the Labor Code. Bills related to lifelong learning, MSMEs and entrepreneurship, and social protection are also pending in both Houses.

Meanwhile, amendments to R.A. 10912, or the Continuing Professional Development (CPD) Act of 2016, were already adopted. In May 2023, the House of Representatives passed on third and final reading House Bill No. 7744 seeking to enhance the CPD of Filipino professionals as an integral component of career progression and specialization programs.⁵⁹ HB 7744 is now pending at the committee level in the Senate, just as Senate Bill No. 1162, which is seeking repeal of R.A. 10912, is also pending in the same committee.

⁵⁹ HB7744 has amended the following sections of RA 10912, namely: Sec. 3 - Definition of Terms; Sec. 5 - Nature of CPD Programs; Sec. 10 - CPD as Mandatory Requirement in the Renewal of Professional License and Accreditation System for the Practice of Professions; Sec. 12 - Career Progression and Specialization; Sec. 13 - Role of Concerned Government Agencies and the Private Sector; and Sec. 14 - Funding. It also created new sections, as follows: Sec. 10-A - Exemptions from CPD Requirements; Sec. 14-A - Free or Inexpensive Seminars and Similar Training Programs; and Sec. 15 - Administrative Penalties. Finally, it renumbered Section 15 of the existing law to Section 16 (Implementing Rules and Regulations).

05

Implementation, Evaluation and Monitoring



Implementation, Evaluation and Monitoring

Existing tripartite mechanisms at all levels-national, regional and local, industry and sectoral--will be harnessed to ensure the successful implementation of the plan. The social partners will have a direct role in the overall management and supervision of the PLEP, including the formulation and implementation of the monitoring, evaluation, advocacy and communication plan. Government agencies and inter-agency bodies where the DOLE and the social partners are represented provide a good platform to articulate the core messages of the PLEP, raise awareness about the decent work agenda among policymakers and decision-makers of these institutions, and mainstream decent work terminologies and indicators in their policy, planning, programming and operational processes.

5.1. Management Structure

A Tripartite Oversight Committee (hereinafter the Committee) composed of NTIPC members has been organized to coordinate, monitor and evaluate the implementation of the PLEP. It is chaired by the Secretary of Labor and Employment or his designated representative. The Director of the ILO Country Office may be invited to join the Committee's meetings as resource person or observer. The Committee is also tasked to provide policy guidance and oversight functions, and communicate to government, tripartite constituents and the general public the progress and achievements of the plan.

The Committee will be supported by a tripartite Technical Working Group (TWG) composed of equal number of representatives from the tripartite partners. A DOLE senior official will head the TWG. The TWG shall be responsible for developing specific action plans over the next five years. For this purpose, it shall develop, subject to the Committee's approval, a framework and mechanism to monitor, measure and evaluate progress and achievements in the three priority areas based on the results matrix. The TWG shall meet on a regular basis and render periodic progress reports to the Committee.

A joint Secretariat composed of DOLE's Planning Service (PS), Institute for Labor Studies (ILS), Bureau of Labor Relations (BLR), Bureau of Local Employment (BLE), and Bureau of Workers with Special Concerns (BWSC), shall assist and provide administrative support to the TWG.

5.2. Monitoring and Evaluation

Regular and periodic monitoring and evaluation using a results-based management system, will be done to correct deviations and to measure the progress and achievements of the PLEP. A mid-term review on the 3rd year and a final review in 2028 will be conducted. The mid-term review is intended to determine and address implementation gaps, and to guide the updating of the plan. For this purpose, two reports covering each review will be prepared. The first will be an updated PLEP containing mid-term results and achievements, while the second will be the final accomplishment report to serve as a transition document for the next administration.

Under the technical guidance and overall supervision of the TWG, concerned DOLE offices such as the Bureaus and Attached Agencies, as well as other government agencies with mandates in education and skills development, overseas employment and migration, business and entrepreneurship development, and social services and social protection, are expected to take a direct role in the monitoring and evaluation of the plan. The legislative liaison offices of all concerned departments shall ensure that the plan's legislative agenda is properly and effectively coordinated with the PLLO and relevant committees in both the Senate and the House of Representatives.

5.3. Result Matrix

The Results Matrix (RM) accompanying the PLEP will guide the monitoring, measurement and evaluation of physical accomplishments in terms of outputs and outcomes. The RM contains the desired results (outputs and outcomes), performance targets and measures of success, baseline indicators, means of verification, and timelines that will guide the implementation, monitoring, and evaluation of the plan. It reflects sectoral and shared ownership of programs and activities enrolled in the plan, and highlights the mutual accountability of all sectors and stakeholders who have contributed in the achievement of results.

Presented on the next page are the Results Matrix for the three priorities on employment, labor market governance, and social protection.

Table 5.3.1
Results Matrix for Priority 1 - Employment
Maximizing productive, remunerative, freely chosen, and sustainable work
and employment opportunities

Outcome Indicators	Baseline	Targets				Means of Verification	Responsible Agency	
		2024	2025	2026	2027			2028
11. Increased Employment								
Align development objectives for basic, higher education, tvet and professional development based on labor-market requirements								
Philippine Qualifications Framework implemented and operationalized								
Number of curriculum standards in the basic education curriculum reviewed and updated based on jobs and labor market forecasts increased						DepEd Admin Data	DepEd, DOLE	
Percentage of SHS graduates under TVL track who earned National Certification (%) increased						DepEd Admin Data	DepEd, DOLE	
Percentage of ALS JHS graduates who passed (Accreditation and Equivalency examination %)						DepEd Admin Data	DepEd, DOLE	
Number of courses on indemand, emerging, and hard-to-filljobs and labor market forecasts increased	60 (2021)	65-70	65-70	65-70	70-75	75-80	CHED DOLE	
Number of competency standards/ training regulations reviewed, aligned, and updated to the skills demands of the industry increased	10 TRs reviewed	25	30	34	40	45	TESDA Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI), Labor Sector, Academe
Number of higher level TVET qualifications developed (NC III, NC IV) increased	102 CS/TR	25	30	34	40	45	TESDA Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI), Labor Sector, Academe
Number of microcredentials in emerging, in-demand, and hard-to-fill occupations developed increase	N/A	2 new	3 new	4 new	5 new	6 new	TESDA Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI), Labor Sector, Academe
Number of professional regulatory boards which reviewed and updated their Tables of Specifications (TOS) increased	10	11	12	14	17	20	PRC Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI), Labor Sector
Constantly reinforce core employability knowledge and skills in basic and higher education and in TVET with emphasis on science, technology, engineering and mathematics								
Competency standards/training regulations reviewed and updated								
Percentage increase (%) in competency standards training regulations with integrated 21st century skills (%) reviewed and updated	315	2% (327)	2% (333)	2% (339)	2% (345)	2% (351)	TESDA Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI), Labor Sector, Academe

Table 5.3.1
Results Matrix for Priority 1 - Employment
Maximizing productive, remunerative, freely chosen, and sustainable work
and employment opportunities

Develop modern and responsive TVET apprenticeships, basic and higher education, and professional development interventions aligned with emerging trends or demands from the industry, including green skills and green jobs									
Enterprise-Based Training implemented									
Number of graduates from Enterprise-Based Training (EBT) programs increased	79,100	82,264	83,846	85,428	87,010	88,592	TESDA Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), Labor Sector, Academe	
Number of EBT programs offered	1,067 EBT TVET Programs	1,109	1,130	1,151	1,172	1,193	TESDA Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), Labor Sector, Academe	
Apprenticeship program implemented									
Number of enrollees in apprenticeship program increased	9,785 (10,721 - 2021)	10,177	10,373	10,569	10,765	10,961	TESDA Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI)	
Number of establishments with apprenticeship program increased	65 (49 - 2021)	67	68	69	70	71	TESDA Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI)	
TVET standards developed and reviewed									
Number of training regulations aligned to the skills demands of the industry reviewed and updated	10 CS/TRs developed	25	30	34	40	45	TESDA Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), Labor Sector, Academe	
Number of Diploma (PQF Level V) Programs recognized	N/A	34	51	68	85	102	TESDA Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), Labor Sector, Academe	
Continuing Professional Development implemented									
Number of CPD programs integrating environmental, climate change and green economy, etc. offered	10	11	12	14	17	20	PRC Admin Data	DOLE	
Percentage (%) of professionals attended CPD programs increased	1170M (2022)	3% (1.241M)	5% (1.303M)	5% (1.368M)	5% (1.437M)	5% (1.509M)	PRC Admin Data	DOLE	
Number of accredited CPD Programs and Providers increased	420 Providers 11,339 Programs (2022)	457 Providers 12,359 Programs	470 Providers 12,699 Programs	483 Providers 13,039 Programs	495 Providers 13,380 Programs	508 Providers 13,720 Programs	PRC Admin Data	DOLE	
Establish skills assessment mechanisms and certification programs to recognize prior learning									
Competency Assessment and Certification implemented									

Table 5.3.1
Results Matrix for Priority 1 - Employment
Maximizing productive, remunerative, freely chosen, and sustainable work
and employment opportunities

Number of new mechanisms in competency assessment and certification piloted and implemented	Philippine TVET Competency Assessment and Certification System	1 new mechanism in CAC being developed	1 new mechanism in CAC being developed	1 new mechanism in CAC piloted	1 new mechanism in CAC piloted	1 new mechanism in CAC implemented	TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), Labor Sector
Align professional standards and licensure examinations with international standards								
Professionals registered under various mutual recognition agreements within ASEAN and other countries								
Number of professionals registered under MRAs including international trade agreements where the Philippines is a signatory (i.e., ASEANMRA, APEC Engineer, APEC Architect)	115 (2022)	131	138	146	154	163	PRC Admin Data/Reports	DOLE
Professional licensure programs rolled-out								
Number of examinees who passed the licensure examinations increased	314,448	333,598	350,278	367,792	386,181	405,490	PRC Admin Data/Reports	DOLE
Licensure examination passing rate (%) for elementary teachers (LET) increased	52.36%	56%	68%	60%	62%	64%	PRC Admin Data/Reports	DOLE
Licensure examination passing rate (%) for secondary teachers (LET) increased	51.13%	55%	57%	59%	61%	63%	PRC Admin Data/Reports	DOLE
Licensure examination passing rate (%) for overall takers across all disciplines increased	38.8% (2019)	42%	44%	46%	48%	50%	PRC Admin Data/Reports	DOLE
Licensure examination passing rate (%) for first-time takers across all disciplines increased	57% (2019)	61%	63%	65%	67%	69%	PRC Admin Data/Reports	DOLE
Increase investments in tvet human resources, basic and higher education, entrepreneurship, digitization initiatives, and innovation facilities in response to the future of work, artificial intelligence, and fourth/fifth industrial revolution								
Innovation centers operationalized								
Number of operational TESDA Innovation Center	N/A	6 additional	5 additional	5 additional	5 additional	7 additional	TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DOLE
Number of higher level TVET qualifications developed (NC III, NC IV)	102 CS/TR	109	114	120	127	163	TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, Industry (e.g. ECOP/PCCI), Labor Sector, Academe
Number of graduates in higher-level TVET programs offered by TESDA Technology Institutions (TTIs) including their innovation center increased	270 (2019)	270 (2019)					TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, DTI

Table 5.3.1
Results Matrix for Priority 1 - Employment
Maximizing productive, remunerative, freely chosen, and sustainable work
and employment opportunities

Number of TVET Trainers increased	7,742 (2021)	8,540	8,697	9,415	9,886	10,380	TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, DTI						
Develop and promote a national policy for lifelong learning														
Lifelong Learning Policy issued and implemented														
National policy/legislation for lifelong learning adopted and implemented	1 pending bill in Senate and Congress	1 national policy adopted and implemented (2023-2028)					Bill passed	DepEd, CHED, DOLE, DTI						
Number of TVET Trainers increased	7,742 (2021)	8,540	8,697	9,415	9,886	10,380	TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DepEd, CHED, DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), Labor Sector						
Number of individuals who underwent upskilling or reskilling increased	Guidelines on recognition of microcredentials for lifelong learning	System updated to prioritize, monitor reskilling/upskilling												
Increase awareness and adoption of the Philippine Qualifications Framework and Philippine Skills Framework, especially in key employment generating sectors														
Philippine Qualifications Framework implemented and operationalized														
Number of Professional Regulatory Boards (PRBs) which constituted their CPSP-CATS Committee increased	28	34	37	40	43	46	PRC Admin Data/Reports	DOLE						
Number of advocacy activities increased	N/A	5	5	5	5	5	PQF-NCC Reports	DOLE, CHED, DepEd						
Philippine Skills Framework developed in key employment generating sectors														
Number of completed and published PSFs increased	6	12	15	18	21	25	Published PSFs	DTI, DOLE, DICT, DOE						
Resolve the issue of qualification standards in hiring SHS graduates														
Qualification Standards revised and implemented														
Number of SPES beneficiaries increased	128,284 (2022)	73,793	77,482	81,357	85,425	89,695	DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, LGU-Youth Development Offices, DSWD						
Number of GIP beneficiaries increased	4,953 (2022)	12,613	13,314	14,014	14,715	14,715	DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, LGU-Youth Development Offices, DSWD, NYC						
Number of JobStart beneficiaries increased	1,315 (2022)	5,200	5,200	5,200	5,200	5,200	DOLE Admin Data	DOLE LGU-Youth Development Offices, DSWD						

Table 5.3.1
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Percentage (%) of youth beneficiaries assessed with the prescribed testing mechanisms	N/A	75%-80%	75%-80%	75%-80%	75%-80%	75%-80%	75%-80%	DOLE Admin Data	DOLE LGU-Youth Development Offices, DSWD
Participation rate (%) of industry associations and trade unions in youth employability programs increased	N/A	25%-50%	25%-50%	25%-50%	25%-50%	25%-50%	25%-50%	DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI), Labor Sector
1.2. Expanded Access to Employment and Work Opportunities									
Integrate and strengthen all employment facilitation services, including career development support and conduct of sector-specific job fair activities									
Job fair activities conducted, including technology-based or online job fairs									
Number of job fairs conducted/ monitored increased	1,051	1,062	1,093	1,124	1,155	1,186		DOLE Admin Data	DOLE LGU-Youth Development Offices, DSWD
Number of registered applicants in job fair activities increased	318,549	337,661	347,217	356,773	366,329	375,885		DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, LGU-Youth Development Offices, DSWD, NYC
Number of applicants hired-on-the-spot (HOTS) increased	53,462	57,000	57,000	57,000	57,000	57,000		DOLE Admin Data	DOLE LGU-Youth Development Offices, DSWD
Number of fkey employment generating sector with job fair activities increased	3	4	5	6	8	10		DOLE Admin Data	DOLE LGU-Youth Development Offices, DSWD
Career development support (CDS) services provided									
Number of CDS advocacies conducted increased	6,112 (2022)	6,484	6,678	6,879	7085	7298		DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, CDSP Working Group, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI), Labor Sector
Number of students/ parents provided with CDS increased	271,311 (2022)	287,834	296,469	305,363	314,524	323,960		DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, CDSP Working Group, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI), Labor Sector
Number of CDS advocacies conducted with the participation of the private sector increased	N/A	3,240	3,333	3,426	3,519	3,612		DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, CDSP Working Group, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI), Labor Sector
Number of schools/ universities/ colleges provided with CDS increased	1,905 (2022)	2,021	2,082	2,144	2,208	2,274		DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, CDSP Working Group, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI), Labor Sector

Table 5.3.1
Results Matrix for Priority 1 - Employment
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Career development support (CDS) services provided									
Career Development Plan implemented	Support Plan	1 (2017-2022)	1	DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, CDSP Working Group, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI), Labor Sector				
Joint Memorandum issued	Circular on CDSP	1 existing (previous administration)	1	DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, CDSP Working Group, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI), Labor Sector				
Maximize and promote the utilization of Public Employment Service Offices (PESOs) and community training and employment coordinators (ctecs) towards the provision of core PES e.g., job placement and referral, provision of career development support).									
Public employment services promoted and maximized									
Number of increased	institutionalized PESOs	643 (2022)	703	733	763	793	823	DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, PESOMAP
Number of increased	Job Placement Offices	334 (2022)	338-340	341-344	345-347	348-350	351-353	DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, PESOMAP, Education Sector
Number of increased	job applicants registered in PJN/PEIS	2,856,359 (2022)	1,990,800	2,150,100	2,322,100	2,507,800	2,708,500	DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, PESOMAP, Education Sector
Number of increased	job applicants assisted by PESOs for wage employment	2,642,192 (2022)	1,851,400	1,999,600	2,159,600	2,332,200	2,518,900	DOLE Admin Data	DOLE, PESOMAP, Education Sector
Tap resources of local governments, including barangays, and capacitate them in profiling skills and training of jobseekers, especially self-employed									
Skills profiling of individuals and jobseekers rolled-out (National Skills Registry Program)									
Number of increased	job applicants registered in PEIS	2,185,503 (2022)	10% (2,644,459)	10% (2,908,904)	10% (3,199,795)	10% (3,519,774)	3,10% (3,871,752)	DOLE Admin Data/ Report	DOLE, PESOMAP
Percentage increase (%) of job applicants through industry associations registered in PEIS		-	25%	25%	50%	50%	50%	DOLE Admin Data/ Report	DOLE, PESOMAP, Education Sector
Number of increased	establishments registered in PEIS	29,588 (2022)	35,801	39,382	43,320	47,652	52,417	DOLE Admin Data/ Report	DOLE, PESOMAP, Education Sector
Community-Based Training Programs implemented to LGUs									
Percentage (%) of technical assistance in the delivery of community-based training	of LGUs provided with assistance in the delivery of community-based training	Policy on Pathways to TVET devolution developed	15%	30%	65%	80%	100%	TESDA Admin Data/Report	DOLE, DILG, PESOMAP, LGUs

Table 5.3.1
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Maximizing productive, remunerative, freely chosen, and sustainable work
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Anticipate skill needs in priority sectors through labor market forecasting, ensuring these are all market-driven initiatives identify and strengthen key local industries with high potential for job creation									
Employment mapping and forecasting conducted, including dissemination of labor market forecast									
Number of national LMI forecast published	1 (annually)	1 (annually/demand-driven)	1 (annually/demand-driven)	1 (annually/demand-driven)	1 (annually/demand-driven)	1 (annually/demand-driven)	1 (annually/demand-driven)	Jobs and Labor Market Forecast	DOLE, Industry Associations (EOOP/PCCI), Labor Sector
Workplace and Skills Satisfaction Survey (WSSS) conducted	2 WSSS	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	TESDA WSSS Report
Labor Market Information Reports (LMIRs) developed and disseminated	4 LMIRs	1-2	1-2	1-2	1-2	1-2	1-2	1-2	TESDA LMIRs
Number of capacity-building activities on employment forecasting increased	1	1 (demand-driven)	1 (demand-driven)	1 (demand-driven)	1 (demand-driven)	1 (demand-driven)	1 (demand-driven)	1 (demand-driven)	DOLE and TESDA Admin Data/Reports
Human resource mapping and forecasting by key industries									
KEGs • Hotel and Restaurant • Construction								DOLE Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, Industry Associations (EOOP/PCCI), Labor Sector
Update the branding, user experience, structure, architecture, connectivity, and infrastructure of the PhilJobNet and PESO employment information system, as benchmarked against private job portals									
Enhanced PhilJobNet maximized and utilized by individuals									
Number of job applicants registered in PJN increased	7,306 (2022)	8,840	9,742	10,697	11,766	12,943		DOLE Admin Data/Reports	OLE, PESOMAP, Education Institutions, Industry Associations (EOOP/PCCI)
Number of establishment registered in PJN increased	2,245 (2022)	2,716	2,988	3,287	3,616	310,977		DOLE Admin Data/Reports	OLE, PESOMAP, Education Institutions, Industry Associations (EOOP/PCCI)
Number of job registrants linked to PhilJobNet through the E-Gov app increased	45,000 (2023)	54,000	64,800	77,760	93,312	111,974		DOLE Admin Data/Reports	OLE, PESOMAP, Education Institutions, Industry Associations (EOOP/PCCI)
Promote PhilJobNet as labor market information and job-matching portal, including development of digital platform (i.e., mobile app)									
Enhanced PhilJobNet maximized and utilized by individuals/jobseekers									

Table 5.3.1
Results Matrix for Priority 1 - Employment
Maximizing productive, remunerative, freely chosen, and sustainable work
and employment opportunities

Number of job applicants registered in PJN increased	7,306 (2022)	8,840	9,742	10,697	11,766	12,943	DOLE Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, PESOMAP, Education Institutions, Industry Associations (EOOP/ PCC)
Number of establishments registered in PJN increased	2,245 (2022)	2,716	2,988	3,287	3,616	310,977	DOLE Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, PESOMAP, Education Institutions, Industry Associations (EOOP/ PCC)
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Number of job applicants registered in PJN increased	7,306 (2022)	8,840	9,742	10,697	11,766	12,943	DOLE Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, PESOMAP, Education Institutions, Industry Associations (EOOP/ PCC)
Intensify participation in employment programs for the youth, marginalized, disadvantaged, freelance, gig economy, vulnerable sectors, and in remote areas								
Skills development programs implemented								
Number of youth TVET graduates increased	486,009 (15-24, 2022)	2023 target + 5%	2024 target + 5%	2025 target + 5%	2026 target + 5%	2027 target + 5%	TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, Industry Associations (EOOP/ PCC)
Number of youth assessed	395,263	2023 target + 5%	2024 target + 5%	2025 target + 5%	2026 target + 5%	2027 target + 5%	TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, Industry Associations (EOOP/ PCC)
Number of youth certified	364,645	2023 target + 5%	2024 target + 5%	2025 target + 5%	2026 target + 5%	2027 target + 5%	TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, Industry Associations (EOOP/ PCC)
Provide emergency employment and training support to displaced workers due to human-induced disasters, natural calamities, and labor market disruptions								
Active labor market programs implemented								
Number of individuals assisted through Adjustment Measures Program	N/A	2023 target + 5%	2023 target + 5%	2023 target + 5%	2023 target + 5%	2023 target + 5%	TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DOLE
Percentage of individual affected by disasters, calamities, and disruptions assisted with TVET	46,472	Demand-driven	Demand-driven	Demand-driven	Demand-driven	Demand-driven	TESDA Admin Data/Reports	LGUs, DSWD, DOLE, Other NGAs,

Table 5.3.1
Results Matrix for Priority 1 - Employment
Maximizing productive remunerative freely chosen and sustainable work
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Develop programs and policies that address all forms of labor market discrimination in work, education, and training							
Labor education mainstreamed							
Labor education modules mainstreamed in education curriculum	N/A	1 module mainstreamed	1 module mainstreamed	1 module mainstreamed	1 module mainstreamed	DOLE Admin Data/ Reports	DOLE, CHED
Implement responsive regulation of recruitment, placement, and related activities such as job fair, contracting, alien and local employment (PEA), including digital labor-market intermediaries to ensure the protection of jobseekers							
Employment regulations revised and updated							
Revised Guidelines on Private Employment Agency (PEA) issued	1 existing (2022)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	DOLE Issuance	DOLE
Guidelines on Digital Labor-Market Intermediaries issued	1 existing (2022)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	DOLE Issuance	DOLE
Revised Guidelines on Alien Employment Permit (AEP) issued	1 existing (2022)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	DOLE Issuance	DOLE
Revised Guidelines on Job Contracting and Subcontracting	1 existing (2022)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	DOLE Issuance	DOLE
Licenses and permits issued within the process cycle time							
PEA licenses issued within the process cycle time (PCT)	100% PEA licenses issued within the PCT (2022)	100% PEA licenses issued within the PCT	100% PEA licenses issued within the PCT	100% PEA licenses issued within the PCT	100% PEA licenses issued within the PCT	DOLE Admin Data/ Reports	DOLE
AEP applications (with complete documentary requirements) received and processed, and approval or denial issued, within the process cycle time (PCT)	80-100% AEP applications received, processed and issued within the PCT (2022)	90%-100% applications for AEP received and approval or denial issued, within	90%-100% applications for AEP received and approval or denial issued, within	90%-100% applications for AEP received and approval or denial issued, within	90%-100% applications for AEP received and approval or denial issued, within	DOLE Admin Data/ Reports	DOLE

Table 5.3.1
Results Matrix for Priority 1 - Employment
Maximizing productive, remunerative, freely chosen, and sustainable work
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Applications for registration for job contracting and subcontracting (with complete documentary requirements) received and processed, and approval or denial issued, within the process cycle time (PCT)	90-100% registered applications for job contracting and subcontracting establishments received, processed and issued within the PCT	90%-100% applications for registration for JobCon/SubCon received and processed, and approval or denial issued, within	90%-100% applications for registration for JobCon/SubCon received and processed, and approval or denial issued, within	90%-100% applications for registration for JobCon/SubCon received and processed, and approval or denial issued, within	90%-100% applications for registration for JobCon/SubCon received and processed, and approval or denial issued, within	90%-100% applications for registration for JobCon/SubCon received and processed, and approval or denial issued, within	90%-100% applications for registration for JobCon/SubCon received and processed, and approval or denial issued, within	DOLE Admin Data/ Reports	DOLE
Strengthen the reintegration program of the Department of Migrant Workers (DMW), with the involvement of PESOs									
OFW reintegration assistance extended to returning OFWs									
Number of OFWs registered in PEIS/ PhilJobNet increased	8,250 (2022)	11,880 (20%)	14,176 (20%)	17,011 (20%)	17,011 (20%)	17,011 (20%)	17,011 (20%)	DOLE Admin Data/ Reports	DOLE, DMW
1.3. Shared Labor Market Governance									
Strengthen linkages and collaboration among government and industry associations, enterprises, youth organizations, PESOs, job placement offices, and social partners to emphasize shared responsibility in promoting, implementing, and monitoring employment, skills, labor standards, and professional development policies and strategies, and fully supporting the innovation centers									
Partnerships with social partners forged and implemented									
Number of forged partnership agreements with private establishments for the implementation of youth employability programs	0	9	11	13	15	17		MOAs/MOUs	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), PESOs
Number of forged partnerships with NGAs and private establishments relative to local employment	1	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)		MOAs/MOUs	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), PESOs
Number of Industry Boards established and recognized in the KEGs and/or its subsectors	28	48	58	68	78	88		TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI)
Number of CTECs trained on Community Program Development Services Level IV (CPDS)	N/At	Training of Trainers for CPDS	25	450	875	1,300		TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), LGUs
Align policies on local and overseas employment									
Local employment policies reviewed and aligned									
No. of existing policies on local employment reviewed	1-2	1-2	1-2	1-2	1-2	1-2		DOLE Issuances	DOLE

Table 5.3.1
Results Matrix for Priority 1 - Employment
Maximizing productive, remunerative, freely chosen, and sustainable work
and employment opportunities

No. of policies on local employment formulated based on approved issuance (e.g. Caregivers Bill, etc.)	Demand driven	Demand driven	Demand driven	Demand driven	Demand driven	Demand driven	Issuances	DOLE
Design mechanisms to ensure inclusive participation and equitable access to education and skills development programs								
Tap the private sector towards financing skills trainings by allotting a portion of their sales to skills training programs								
Area-Based Demand-Driven (ABDD) TVET implemented								
Number of ABDD TVET guidelines developed and implemented	1	ABDD TVET guidelines developed	ABDD TVET Implemented				TESDA Admin Data/ Reports	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI)
Number of Enterprise-Based Training graduates increased	79,100	80,682	82,264	83,846	85,428	87,010	88,592	TESDA Admin Data/ Reports
Map or forecast areas of industries to enable workers and employers to strategically adapt to the effects of technological change, climate change, green technologies, and situations of conflict								
Green and digital industries mapped or forecasted								
Number of green and digital industries mapped	7	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	(Demand driven)	Green and Digital Career Pamphlets	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), PSA, DICT, CCC, DENR
National Green Jobs Human Resource Development Plan reviewed, updated, and implemented	1	1 updated		1 implemented			NGJHRD Plan	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), PSA, DICT, CCC, DENR
INTENSIFY ADVOCACY SUPPORT OF GOVERNMENT AND SOCIAL PARTNERS THROUGH SKILLS DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMS TO PROMOTE A SUSTAINABLE ENVIRONMENT AND JUST TRANSITION								
Active labor market programs offered or rolled-out								
Percentage increase in the number of TVET Scholarship beneficiaries	254,891 (TWSR, PESFA, STEP)	2023 target + 5%	2024 target + 5%	2025 target + 5%	2026 target + 5%	2027 target + 5%	TESDA Admin Data/ Reports	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), Labor Sector
Number of advocacy module developed and rolled-out	1 existing		1 developed and rolled-out				Green Jobs Module	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), PSA, DICT, CCC, DENR
Mainstream gender and green competencies in training standards, modules, and curricula								
Training standards, modules, curricula with gender and green competencies developed, revised, or updated								

Table 5.3.1
Results Matrix for Priority 1 - Employment
Maximizing productive, remunerative, freely chosen, and sustainable work
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Number of training standards, regulations, and curriculum with green mainstreaming developed, revised, or updated	89	102	115	128	138	144	TESDA TRs/ CSS	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), Educational Institutions
Number of training standards, regulations, and curriculum with gender mainstreaming developed, revised, or updated	89	102	115	128	138	144	TESDA TRs/ CSS	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), Educational Institutions
Ensure that representation and participation in tripartite mechanisms are genuine, inclusive, and gender-responsive, including representation to the Philippine Qualification Framework and Philippine Skills Framework								
Representation in various tripartite mechanisms (especially in employment and skills development) ensured								
Number of sectoral representatives in industry training boards							TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, Labor Sector, Industry Associations, DOLE
Industry and economic sector representatives to the PQF identified, nominated and appointed	3	(Demand-driven)	(Demand-driven)	(Demand-driven)	(Demand-driven)	(Demand-driven)	PQF-NCC Report	DOLE, DepEd, Industry Association (ECOP, PCCI)
1.4. Enhanced Enabling Environment to Promote the Development of Sustainable and Resilient Enterprises, particularly for MSMEs								
Ensure effective and efficient use of tripartite and bipartite wage and productivity mechanisms								
Enterprise Productivity Improvement Program implemented								
Number of MSMEs provided with technical assistance on designing productivity-based incentive schemes	1,293 (2022)	1,280	1,360	1,440	1,520	1,600	NWPC Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP, PCCI)
Provide technical assistance and enhance capacity-building programs for MSMEs (e.g., emerging technologies), including toolkits to enhance the sustainability of MSMEs, social enterprises, and cooperatives, with a focus on facilitating access to finance, improving productivity, upgrading processes and technologies, incorporating green and sustainable practices								
Enterprise Productivity Improvement Program implemented								
Number of MSMEs provided with productivity training/ orientation increased	14,515 (2022)	16,000	17,000	17,500	18,000	18,500	NWPC Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP, PCCI)
Capacity building on service quality by industry								
KEGs (Service sector) • Hotel and Restaurant Industry Health and Wellness							Admin Data	DTI, DOLE, Industry
MOU with partner agencies forged	N/A	As needed	As needed	As needed	As needed	As needed	MOUs forged	DTI, DOLE, Industry

Table 5.3.1
Results Matrix for Priority 1 - Employment
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and employment opportunities

Conduct studies on the impact of free trade agreements on employment									
Employment impacts of free trade agreements analyzed									
Number of free trade agreements/economic partnership agreements with labor and employment provisions or dimensions analyzed (including impact assessments of	0	1	1	1	1	1	1	DOLE Reports	DOLE with ILATF, Industry Associations (ECOP, PCCI), Labor Sector
Make labor regulation more flexible and market-driven									
Policy (Department Order) on AMP issued									
Ensure that representation and participation in tripartite mechanisms are genuine, inclusive, and gender-responsive, including representation to the Philippine Qualification Framework and Philippine Skills Framework									
Representation in various tripartite mechanisms (especially in employment and skills development) ensured									
Number of sectoral representatives in industry training boards							TESDA Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, Labor Sector, Industry Associations, DOLE	
Industry and economic sector representatives to the PQF identified, nominated and appointed	3	(Demand-driven)	(Demand-driven)	(Demand-driven)	(Demand-driven)	(Demand-driven)	PQF-NCC Report	DOLE, DepEd, Industry Association (ECOP, PCCI)	
1.4. Enhanced Enabling Environment to Promote the Development of Sustainable and Resilient Enterprises, particularly for MSMEs									
Ensure effective and efficient use of tripartite and bipartite wage and productivity mechanisms									
Enterprise Productivity Improvement Program implemented									
Number of MSMEs provided with technical assistance on designing productivity-based incentive schemes	1,293 (2022)	1,280	1,360	1,440	1,520	1,600	NWPC Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP, PCCI)	
Provide technical assistance and enhance capacity-building programs for MSMEs (e.g., emerging technologies), including toolkits to enhance the sustainability of MSMEs, social enterprises, and cooperatives, with a focus on facilitating access to finance, improving productivity, upgrading processes and technologies, incorporating green and sustainable practices									
Enterprise Productivity Improvement Program implemented									
Number of MSMEs provided with productivity training/orientation increased	14,515 (2022)	16,000	17,000	17,500	18,000	18,500	NWPC Admin Data	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP, PCCI)	
Capacity building on service quality by industry									
KEGs (Service sector)							Admin Data	DTI, DOLE, Industry	
• Hotel and Restaurant Industry Health and Wellness									
MOU with partner agencies forged	N/A	As needed	As needed	As needed	As needed	As needed	MOUs forged	DTI, DOLE, Industry	
Conduct studies on the impact of free trade agreements on employment									

Table 5.3.1
Results Matrix for Priority 1 - Employment
Maximizing productive, remunerative, freely chosen, and sustainable work
and employment opportunities

Employment impacts of free trade agreements analyzed									
Number of free trade agreements/ economic partnership agreements with labor and employment provisions or dimensions analyzed (including impact assessments of	0	1	1	1	1	1	1	DOLE Reports	DOLE with ILATF, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI), Labor Sector
Make labor regulation more flexible and market-driven									
Policy (Department Order) on AMP issued									
Number of policy on DOLE AMP issued	1	As needed	As needed	As needed	As needed	As needed	As needed	DOLE Issuances	DOLE
Scale-up MSMEs by giving them access to money, markets, and mentoring									
DOLE Adjustment Measures Program implemented									
Number of MSMEs provided with DOLE AMP	N/A	308	Demand- driven	Demand- driven	Demand- driven	Demand- driven	Demand- driven	DOLE Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, DTI, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI)
Number of DOLE AMP MSMEs beneficiaries which upscaled and increased	N/A	Demand- driven	Demand- driven	Demand- driven	Demand- driven	Demand- driven	Demand- driven	DOLE Admin Data/Reports	DOLE, DTI, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI)
Accelerate the digitalization and innovation of MSMEs, including the adoption of e-commerce and science, technology, and innovation initiatives									
Digitalization and innovation of MSMEs advocated									
Benchmarking activity on digitalization and innovation of MSMEs against ASEAN counterpart conducted	N/A	1	1	1	1	1	1	DOLE Reports	DOLE, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), Labor Sector
Number of MSMEs/Start-ups provided with business incubation and guidance								DTI and DOLE Admin Data/ Reports	DOLE, DTI, DOST, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI)
Number of MSMEs/Start-ups provided with technical assistance in establishing start-ups or entrepreneurship								DTI and DOLE Admin Data/ Reports	DOLE, DTI, DOST, Industry Associations (ECOP/ PCCI)
Build linkages among senior high school students and MSMEs for possible employment, including support to youth entrepreneurial initiatives									
Entrepreneurship Development in Basic Education advocated									
Number of entrepreneurship courses mainstreamed in SHS								Admin Data/ Reports	DepEd, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), NYC
Number of internships in MSMEs implemented								Admin Data/ Reports	DepEd, Industry Associations (ECOP/PCCI), NYC

Table 5.3.2
Results Matrix for Priority 2 - Labor Market Governance
Forging labor market governance that ensures respect for all fundamental principles and rights at work international labor standards and human rights

Outcome Indicators	Baseline	Targets				Means of Verification	Responsible Agency
		2024	2025	2026	2027		
1.1 Improved capacity of labor administration authorities to implement and enforce labor standards and social and welfare legislations; and to eliminate all forms of unacceptable work							
Continuously enhance and upgrade the capacity of labor inspectors, labor inspectorate managers, conciliators, med-arbiters, labor arbiters, voluntary arbitrators, and commissioners to efficiently and effectively administer, enforce or resolve cases arising from the application of labor laws							
Enhance and upgrade the capacity of labor inspectors, labor inspectorate managers, sheriffs, conciliators, med-arbiters, labor arbiters, voluntary arbitrators, and commissioners							
Trainings/capacity building conducted							
Number of trainings for labor inspectors	4	5	5	5	5	5	DOLE
Number of Labor inspectors trained	133	150	150	150	150	150	DOLE
Number of trainings for labor inspectorate	1	2	2	2	2	2	DOLE
Number of Labor inspectorate managers trained		32	32	32	32	32	DOLE
Number of trainings for sheriffs and designated sheriffs	1	2	2	2	2	2	DOLE
	1	1	1	1	1	1	
Number of sheriffs trained		60	60	60	60	60	DOLE
Number of Enhancement seminar for Labor Arbiters and Commissioners	(2022)	1		1			DOLE
Number of Labor Arbiters (125) and Commissioners (22) trained (Nos. of participants from NLRC may vary depending on the on the No. of retirees and new appointees)		100% participation rate					DOLE
Number of trainings conducted for Single Entry Assistance Desk Officers (SEADOs)	6 (2022)	6	6	6	6	6	DOLE
Number of SEADOs trained (no. of participants from DOLE and NLRC may vary depending on the on the no. of retirees and new appointees)	180	180	180	180	180	180	DOLE
Number of trainings conducted for Conciliator-Mediators	1	1	1	1	1	1	DOLE
Number of Conciliator-Mediators trained	26	25	25	25	25	25	DOLE

Table 5.3.2
Results Matrix for Priority 2 - Labor Market Governance
Forging labor market governance that ensures respect for all fundamental principles and rights at work international labor standards and human rights

Number of trainings conducted for voluntary arbitrators	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	Training Accomplishment Report	DOLE
Number of voluntary arbitrators trained	84	77	77	77	77	77	77	77	77	Training Accomplishment Report	DOLE
Number of trainings conducted for med-arbiters		1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	Training Accomplishment Report	DOLE
Number of med-arbiters trained		30	30	30	30	30	30	30	30	Training Accomplishment Report	DOLE
Implement a strategic compliance program and rationalize labor inspection approaches											
Use technical assistance visits to provide advisory services to micro and small enterprises to address GLS and OSHS compliance gaps											
Provided with technical assistance to micro enterprises to address compliance gaps											
Number of MEs Covered under TAV (Technical Advisory Visits) increased	- (2022)	144,500	161,500	170,000	161,500	153,000	161,500	153,000	153,000	TAV Report	DOLE
Number of MEs with compliance gaps referred for BOSH Training increased	- (2022)	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	TAV Report	DOLE
Number of MEs with compliance gaps referred to PRC for first aid training increased	- (2022)	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	TAV Report	DOLE
Number of MEs referred to RTWPBs for productivity services/ trainings increased	- (2022)	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	TAV Report	DOLE
Number of MEs with compliance gaps referred to the appropriate agency (SSS, Pag-Ibig, PhilHealth)	- (2022)	needs based	needs based	needs based	needs based	needs based	needs based	needs based	needs based	TAV Report	DOLE
Number of MEs with compliance gaps referred for assistance under DILP increased	- (2022)	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	TAV Report	DOLE
Harmonize inspection procedures with DENR, DOE, DPWH, DA											
Harmonized monitoring of compliance with government regulations by the different agencies that conduct inspection											
Policy issued/MOA executed	- (2022)	(to be coordinated with concerned agencies)								SEC Records/ DOLE & concerned agencies Website	DOLE

Table 5.3.2
Results Matrix for Priority 2 - Labor Market Governance
Forging labor market governance that ensures respect for all fundamental principles and rights at work international labor standards and human rights

Implementation of the policies/ monitored	MOA	(2022)	(to be coordinated with concerned agencies)	(to be coordinated with concerned agencies)	SEC Records/ DOLE & concerned agencies Website	DOLE
Observe timetables in the disposition of cases						
Ensured speedy and efficient delivery of labor justice						
Original and Appealed Cases disposed						
Disposition rate • ROs • BLR • BWC • ECC		100%	100%	100%	100%	DOLE
Labor-Management Disputes Settled						
Settlement rate • SeNA (70%) • PM (85%) • Notice of Strike/ Lockout (70%)		SeNA (70%) PM (85%) NS/L (70%)	100% of target	100% of target	100% of target	DOLE
Ensure prompt and immediate execution of judgments						
Enforce all Writs within five (5) years from the date the decision becomes final and executory						
Number of Writs enforced		100% (2022)	100%	100%	100%	DOLE
					Writ of Execution issued Sheriff's Return	
1.2. Strengthened capacity of government and social partners in ensuring compliance with labor standards and effective participation in social dialogue and tripartite processes						
Enhance knowledge and common understanding of tripartite partners on the substantive and technical aspects of freedom of association, the rights to organize and to bargain, bipartism and tripartism, and shared responsibility in regulating labor-management relations						
Design and implement modernized, updated, problem-solving, focused labor education programs for the tripartite partners						
Development of comprehensive labor education program						
Basic Labor Law Module crafted		- (2022)	1		Module	DOLE
Standardized learning modules on: 1. Labor Relations 2. Employment and manpower development		- (2022)	3	3	3	DOLE
Improve capacity of social partners to effectively participate in crafting policies concerning terms and conditions of employment through participative workplace mechanisms						
Improved knowledge of workers, employers, and students on their rights and responsibilities toward promoting and maintaining harmonious labor-management relations in the workplace						

Table 5.3.2
Results Matrix for Priority 2 - Labor Market Governance
Forging labor market governance that ensures respect for all fundamental principles and rights at work international labor standards and human rights

Number of clients (workers, employers, and students) reached through Labor and Employment Education Services	538,270 (2022)	573,100	573,150	573,200	573,250	573,300	Regional Reports	DOLE
Provided technical assistance to labor organizations, labor management councils and other social partners								
Number of capacity building conducted	- (2022)	Needs based	Needs based	Needs based	Needs based	Needs based	Activity Report	DOLE
Number of social partners provided with technical assistance	- (2022)	Needs based	Needs based	Needs based	Needs based	Needs based	Activity Report	DOLE
Number of Union members benefited under the Workers Organization and Development Program (WODP)	1,894 (2022)	1,894	1,894	1,894	1,894	1,894	Regional Reports	DOLE
Design and implement technical assistance and capacity-building to strengthen workers' and employers' organizations in assisting and advising their members on labor relation matters								
Technical assistance and capacity-building implemented to strengthen workers' and employers' organizations in assisting and advising their members on labor relations matters								
Number of workers assisted, advised, and represented on labor matters (demand driven)	- (2022)						Report	DOLE
Sectoral partners provided with paralegal training	- (2022)	80	80				Post Activity Report	DOLE
Complete and implement the tripartite roadmap on freedom of association consistent with recommendations of ILO supervisory bodies								
Promote common understanding among concerned stakeholders on ILO Convention 87 and strengthen inter-agency coordination to expedite actions on issues raised in ILO supervisory bodies concerning compliance with the ILO convention								
Review and strengthen existing mechanisms to promote a culture of non-violence in relation to the legitimate exercise of workers' and employers' organizations of freedom of association								
Tripartite Roadmap on Freedom of Association implemented								
Major action points acted upon within the timeline, in reference to the roadmap	- (2022)	Monitoring & Review	Monitoring & Review	Monitoring & Review	Monitoring & Review	Monitoring & Review	NTIPC Oversight Committee Report	DOLE
Legitimate exercise of freedom of association promoted								
Increase in union density	6.9% (as of December 2022)							Labor Sector
Increase in number of registered CBAs	972 (as of December 2022)							Labor Sector
Strengthen tripartism at national, regional and industry levels, and ensure genuine and competency-based representation of workers and employers in tripartite consultative and decision-making bodies								
Strengthened tripartism and sectoral representatives capacitated toward effective sectoral participation in policy-making processes								
Number of sectoral representatives capacitated in basic labor governance courses (e.g., labor economics course)	- (2022)	70	77	85	94	103	Post Activity Report	DOLE

Table 5.3.2
Results Matrix for Priority 2 - Labor Market Governance
Forging labor market governance that ensures respect for all fundamental principles and rights at work international labor standards and human rights

Tripartite processed policies	- (2022)	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	demand driven	Minutes of the Meeting	DOLE
Activation or setting up of ITCs in industries identified as key employment generators (KEGs) and industries affected by economic restructuring							
KEGs - hotel - restaurant							
Mobilize tripartite partners to strengthen advocacy efforts and to take action on social concerns affecting the world of work, such as promoting non-discrimination, diversity and inclusion, and preventing gender-related violence and sexual harassment							
Capacity building for social partners for participation in labor inspection activities conducted							
Performance of social partners reviewed (based on regional representations)	- (2022)	1				Activity Report/ Attendance Sheet of previous trainings	DOLE
Training capacity building conducted	- (2022)	1	1	1	1	Activity Report	DOLE
Number of social partners trained	- (2022)	30	30	30	30	Activity Report	DOLE
Capacity building for the public on non-discrimination, diversity inclusion, and gender-related violence and sexual harassment in the workplace							
Orientation/public webinars conducted	- (2022)	3	3	3	3	Activity Report	DOLE
Number of participants oriented	- (2022)	50	50	50	50	Activity Report	DOLE
Capacity building of the public sector on OSH Standards (to be pursued through the healthy workplace initiative and lead by the CSC)							
Orientation/Webinar conducted	- (2022)	2	2	2	2	Activity Report	DOLE
Number of government offices trained	- (2022)	160	160	160	160	Activity Report	DOLE
IEC materials produced in consultation with the social partners							
Number of tripartite-developed IEC materials	- (2022)	2	2	2	2	IEC materials produced	DOLE
1.3 Strengthened, modernized and balanced policy, legal and institutionalized frameworks on labor protection for all							
Conduct review and regulatory impact assessment of laws, rules and regulations, particularly on the following:							
Republic Act No. 6727 (Wage Rationalization Act)							
Wage Regulatory Program							
Number of Wage Orders issued	16 (2022)	As necessary	As necessary	As necessary	As necessary	Wage order issued	DOLE

Table 5.3.2

Socio-economic indicators and other basis for minimum wage setting reviewed and monitored	- (2022)	12	12	12	12	12	Reports submitted	DOLE
Research Study on living wage								
Study on living wage conducted	- (2022)	1					Updated family living wage framework and research output/report	DOLE
Provisions of the Labor Code on contracting and subcontracting, including implementing rules and regulations								
Regulatory Impact Assessment on the law/rules on contracting/ subcontracting								
• Scope of implementation of EO 51 • Hindering factors in the implementation of regional directors of the rules of SOT								
Policy reviewed/issued	0						OSEC Records/ DOLE Website/ UP ONAR	DOLE
Conduct a review of the policy in the hiring of contract of service and job orders in the public sector								
Policy reviewed/issued	- (2022)							DOLE
Executive Order No. 180 and its implementing rules and regulations, in relation to ILO Convention No. 151 (Public sector relations)								
Regulatory Impact Assessment on EO No. 180/rules								
Policy reviewed/issued	0	1						DOLE
Revisit policies and regulations on registration and accreditation of unions in the public sector								
Regulatory Impact Assessment conducted								
Enactment of Public Sector Labor Relations bill- enabling law of ILO Convention 151 (part of roadmap)								
Review of EO 180 and PSLMC Resolutions- to make it compliant to ILO Convention 151 (part of roadmap)								
Institutionalization of Social Dialogue in the Public Sector thru an Executive Order (part of roadmap)								
Devise recommendations on policy and regulatory frameworks for emerging work arrangements where employer-employee relationship is ambiguous								
Exploring Policy Options to Address Issue of Governance of Gig Economy in the Philippine Context								
Study conducted/ policy gap analysis conducted	- (2022)						Study/ policy gap analysis produced	DOLE
Conducted policy analysis of the labor inspection program								
Policy analysis or study conducted	- (2022)						Study conducted	DOLE

Table 5.3.2

Results Matrix for Priority 2 - Labor Market Governance
Forging labor market governance that ensures respect for all fundamental principles and rights at work international labor standards and human rights

Effectively operationalize the principle of shared responsibility between the social partners and progressively rationalize the labor dispute resolution system to make it more responsive									
Amended NLRC Rules of Procedure									
Adoption & Publication of New NLRC Rules of Procedure	- (2022)	1	as need arises	as need arises	as need arises	as need arises	Study Report/ NLRC Rules of Procedure, enhance resolution (as needed)	DOLE	
Continuous Review of NLRC Rules of Procedure		1			1	1			
Amended NLRC Rules on Execution									
Adoption & Publication of New NLRC Rules on Execution	- (2022)	1	as need arises	as need arises	as need arises	as need arises	Study Report/ NLRC Rules on Execution, enhance resolution (as needed)	DOLE	
Continuous Review of NLRC Rules on Execution		1			1	1			
Continuously promote use of grievance and other similar plant-level mechanisms to resolve disputes, in both organized and unorganized establishments									
Improved Labor Management Relations through the Promotion of Bipartite Mechanisms									
Bipartite Mechanisms (LMC and GM) established	620	884	986	1,100	1,226	1,364	ADR Report	DOLE	
Bipartite Mechanisms (LMC and GM) enhanced	4,344	4,590	5,050	5,554	6,110	6,722	ADR Report	DOLE	
Study on the Impact of Bipartite Labor Dispute Mechanism in the Maintenance of Industrial Peace									
Study Conducted	- (2022)	1					Study produced/ published	DOLE	
Review the rules of procedure on voluntary arbitration and progressively strengthen and professionalize the voluntary arbitration program									
Strengthening of Voluntary Arbitration Program									
Number of Continuing Education Seminar for Accredited Voluntary Arbitrators	1	1	1	1	1	1	Post Activity Report	DOLE	
Number of VA Policy Reviewed/Issued	(As the need arises)	(As the need arises)	(As the need arises)	(As the need arises)	(As the need arises)	(As the need arises)	TVAAC /DOLE Advisory	DOLE	
Conduct of Accreditation of New VAs	As the need arises	1			1		Post-Activity Report	DOLE	
Review provision of the Labor Code on small money claims and consider adopting summary procedures on such claims and similar claims									
Provision on small money claims in the Labor Code Reviewed									

Table 5.3.2
Results Matrix for Priority 2 - Labor Market Governance
Forging labor market governance that ensures respect for all fundamental principles and rights at work international labor standards and human rights

Study conducted/ Revised Rule issued	- (2022)						Study produced/ published	DOLE
Rewards and Recognition Program conducted								
Conduct of Rewards and Recognition Program (Gawad Kaligtasan at-Kalusugan, Productivity Olympics)	1 (2022)	1 (GKK)	1 (Productivity Olympics)	1 (GKK)	1 (Productivity Olympics)	1 (GKK)	Activity Report	DOLE
Conduct of Biennial Search for Outstanding LMC and GM	1 (2022)		1			1	Activity Report	DOLE

Table 5.3.3
Results Matrix for Priority 3 - Social Protection
Building an equitable and inclusive social protection

Outcome Indicators	Baseline	Targets				Responsible Agency	
		2024	2025	2026	2027		2028
1.1 Enhanced and more inclusive implementation of social protection policies, programs and mechanisms							
Continue to implement emergency employment, subsidies, and cash transfers, and livelihood skills training program to vulnerable and marginalized workers linking it to active labor market policies and interventions							
Provision of assistance for disadvantaged workers							
Percentage increase in the no. of beneficiaries provided with emergency employment under the Tulong Panghanapuhay sa Ating Disadvantaged Workers (TUPAD) Program	3,053,328 (ave. 3yr accomp 2020-2022)	10%*	15%*	20%*	25%*	30%*	DOLE
Percentage increase in the no. of beneficiaries provided with livelihood assistance under DOLE Integrated Livelihood Program (DILP)	68,274 (ave. 3yr accomp 2020-2022)	10%*	15%*	20%*	25%*	30%*	DOLE
Number of parents/guardians of child laborers provided with livelihood assistance	4,811 (2022)	needs-based	needs-based	needs-based	needs-based	needs-based	DOLE
Provision of rehabilitation services for the PWRDs							
Percentage of PWRDs provided with various rehabilitation services (Skills and Entrep Training, PT/OT, and Prosthesis) under the KAGABAY Program	73.67% (305/414)	77%	79%	81%	83%	85%	DOLE-ECC
Provision of TVET scholarship							
No. of scholars enrolled under Special Training for Employment Program (STEP)	245,277	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	TESDA
No. of scholarship beneficiaries who graduated under STEP	211,882	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	TESDA
Certification rate of scholarship beneficiaries under STEP		92.5%	93%	93.5%	94%	94.5%	TESDA
Percentage increase in the no. of beneficiaries provided with emergency employment under the Tulong Panghanapuhay sa Ating Disadvantaged Workers (TUPAD) Program	3,053,328 (ave. 3yr accomp 2020-2022)	10%*	15%*	20%*	25%*	30%*	DOLE
Percentage increase in the no. of beneficiaries provided with livelihood assistance under DOLE Integrated Livelihood Program (DILP)	68,274 (ave. 3yr accomp 2020-2022)	10%*	15%*	20%*	25%*	30%*	DOLE

Table 5.3.3
Results Matrix for Priority 3 - Social Protection
Building an equitable and inclusive social protection

Number of parents/ guardians of child laborers provided with livelihood assistance	4,811 (2022)	needs-based	77%	needs-based	79%	needs-based	81%	needs-based	83%	needs-based	85%	DOLE
Provision of rehabilitation services for the PWRDs												
Percentage of PWRDs provided with various rehabilitation services (Skills and Entrep Training, PT/OT, and Prosthesis) under the KAGABAY Program	73.67% (305/414)	needs-based	77%	needs-based	79%	needs-based	81%	needs-based	83%	needs-based	85%	DOLE-ECC
Provision of TVET scholarship												
No. of scholars enrolled under Special Training for Employment Program (STEP)	245,277	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	TESDA
No. of scholarship beneficiaries who graduated under STEP	211,882	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	previous year's target* + 5%	TESDA
Facilitated the provision of 300 livelihood/skills training with appropriate start-up kits to PWRDs												
Number of Persons with Disabilities (PWRDs) provided with livelihood assistance	308 (2022)	300	300	300	300	300	300	300	300	300	300	DOLE-ECC
Conduct impact assessment and evaluate selected existing social protection programs for vulnerable and marginalized workers												
Impact assessment and evaluation studies												
No. of impact assessment and evaluation studies conducted	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	DOLE
Qualified members who are eligible to the unemployment benefit are provided under RA 11199.	Review of program is ongoing for possible enhancements.											SSS, GSIS, DOLE
Strengthen convergence and collaboration (integrated approach, institutional strengthening) among government agencies on social protection programs to ensure sustainability of livelihood programs and greater impact												
Partnership on social protection programs between and among implementing agencies												
Number of MOAs with other agencies forged		needs based		needs based		needs based		needs based		needs based		DOLE
Livelihood assistance to micro-enterprises under Technical and Advisory Visit (TAV)												
No. of micro-enterprises under TAV provided with livelihood assistance	N/A	demand-driven		demand-driven		demand-driven		demand-driven		demand-driven		DOLE
Strengthen targeting of beneficiaries and monitoring of interventions:												
Coordinate with DSWD/CBMS on harmonization of database/profiling of beneficiaries to ensure coverage of intended beneficiaries												

Table 5.3.3
Results Matrix for Priority 3 - Social Protection
Building an equitable and inclusive social protection

Philippine Program Against Child Labor / DOLE Child Labor Prevention and Elimination Program / DSWD SHIELD Against Child Labor Program						
National database on child labor established and maintained	Database on child labor from each agency	1 (continuation of development)	1 (maintenance)	1 (maintenance)	1 (maintenance)	1 (maintenance) DOLE
Strengthen data-collection mechanisms (including data disaggregation from a unified database) on the beneficiaries of social protection programs (guided by the Data Privacy Act)						
Generated data on DILP and TUPAD Program through online database system						
DILP Information System developed and/or enhanced (i.e. functionalities, security measures, data storage, among others)		1 (enhancement)	1 (enhancement)	1 (enhancement)	1 (enhancement)	1 (enhancement) DOLE
TUPAD Information Management System enhanced and /or maintain (e.t. functionalities, security measures, data storage)		1 (enhancement)	1 (enhancement)	1 (enhancement)	1 (enhancement)	1 (enhancement)
Intensify information dissemination of existing government programs at the local level including use of social-media platforms and other innovative communication strategies:						
Development of IEC materials to educate and capacitate the beneficiaries about the benefits and requirements of SP programs						
Development and dissemination of IEC materials						
Number of IEC materials developed	1000 pcs. printed materials 1 AVP 1 radio commercial 2 social media cards	5000 pcs. printed materials 4 AVP 1 radio commercial 12 social media cards	5000 pcs. printed materials 4 AVP 1 radio commercial 12 social media cards	5000 pcs. printed materials 4 AVP 1 radio commercial 12 social media cards	5000 pcs. printed materials 4 AVP 1 radio commercial 12 social media cards	5000 pcs. printed materials 4 AVP 1 radio commercial 12 social media cards DOLE
Number of IEC materials on child labor disseminated • print • radio • websites						
Accomplishment of Compensation Program Dissemination through Quad-Media	Employees (ECP) 20 ads in general circulation 4 SMS text blasts in public/private sector 36 press releases	20 ads in general circulation 4 SMS text blasts in public/private sector 36 press releases	20 ads in general circulation 4 SMS text blasts in public/private sector 36 press releases	20 ads in general circulation 4 SMS text blasts in public/private sector 36 press releases	20 ads in general circulation 4 SMS text blasts in public/private sector 36 press releases	20 ads in general circulation 4 SMS text blasts in public/private sector 36 press releases

Table 5.3.3
Results Matrix for Priority 3 - Social Protection
Building an equitable and inclusive social protection

IEC and advocacy material in different languages developed • print • radio • websites	12	12	12	12	12	12
IEC and advocacy material in different languages distributed • print • radio • websites						DOLE
No. of beneficiaries reached by IEC materials						
Monitoring, information dissemination, advocacy on child laborers with the support of the local government and improved delivery of services towards the progressive elimination of child labor						
Philippine Program Against Child Labor (PPACL) / DOLE Child Labor Prevention and Elimination Program (CLPEP)						
PPACL Communication Plan developed and updated	PPACL Commu- nity Plan 2021-2022	1 (finalization of PPACL Comm Plan 2023-2025)	1 (finalization of PPACL Comm Plan 2023-2025)	1 (finalization of PPACL Comm Plan 2023-2025)	1 (finalization of PPACL Comm Plan 2023-2025)	1 (finalization of PPACL Comm Plan 2023-2025)
No. of orientations/seminars on child labor for various stakeholders conducted	TBD	40	40	40	40	DOLE
No. of World Day Against Child Labor (WDACL) celebrations conducted	18 (1 national WDACL celebration and 17 regional WDACL celebrations)	18	18	18	18	DOLE
No. of information and service caravans on child labor conducted	N/A	4	4	4	4	DOLE
1.2 Strengthened Policy, Legal and Institutional Framework for social protection for all						
Implement social protection floor (SPF guarantees for healthcare, women and children, working age, and elderly)						
For Children						
Philippine Program Against Child Labor / DOLE Child Labor Prevention and Elimination Program / DSWD Strategic Helpdesks for Information, Education, Livelihood and other Developmental Interventions (SHIELD) Against Child Labor Program						
Percentage of profiled child laborers monitored for provision of services to remove them from child labor increased	472,225 child laborers profiled from 2018 to 2022 who are still in child labor	66%	100%			SDC, NCACL, DOLE, DSWD

Table 5.3.3
Results Matrix for Priority 3 - Social Protection
Building an equitable and inclusive social protection

Percentage of children provided with assistance through the Shield Against Child Labor Program increased	1,400	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	DSWD
For working age							
Inclusion of insurance protection for livelihood enhancement projects in the DILP guidelines							
Number of enhancement livelihood projects provided with insurance protection from natural calamities		to be determined	to be determined	to be determined	to be determined	to be determined	DOLE
Facilitate the automatic enrolment of self-employed (e.g. job orders/contract of service) personnel as well as Barangay Health Workers (BHWs) in SSS, PhilHealth and PAG-IBIG							
Proportion of JO/COS personnel and other vulnerable workers (e.g. BHW, BNS) covered with social insurance increased	Number of JO/ COS personnel and other vulnerable workers (e.g. BHW, BNS) covered with social	80%	95%	95%	95%	95%	DILG, SSS, PhilHealth, PAGIBIG, LGUs, NGAs
Proportion of self-employed workers covered with social insurance increased							SSS
Inclusion of savings/financial literacy and information on the benefits of social insurance programs during the orientation of government livelihood program beneficiaries							
Number of interested livelihood beneficiaries/referred for orientation on savings/financing literacy and benefits of social insurance programs		100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	DOLE with BSP, DSWD, SSS
Affordable insurance schemes for workers in the informal sector developed/ enhanced							
Social insurance schemes for workers in the informal sector developed/enhanced	Implementation of Sections 4(a) (10), 19-A and 22-A of RA No.	Implement enhanced Kasambahay Program					SSS
Advocacy on social insurance developed							
No. of partnership with LGUs and transport group provided with orientation on social insurance programs							Insurance Commission
No. of workers in the informal sector encouraged to avail of social insurance products							
Strengthened advocacy on AlkanSSSy program							
No. of advocacy activities for the promotion of AlkanSSSy for the workers in the informal sector conducted		TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	DOLE with SSS, LGUs, DSWD

Table 5.3.3
Results Matrix for Priority 3 - Social Protection
Building an equitable and inclusive social protection

No. of beneficiaries attended the advocacy activities for the promotion of AlkanSSSyA	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
Enhanced existing unemployment insurance in the long-term, recipients should be able to transition to employment by linking unemployment insurance to ALMP						
Percentage of unemployed individuals provided with Unemployment Insurance benefit	DOLE, SSS					
Percentage of interested unemployed individuals referred to ALMP						
Advocate activities to facilitate the coverage of all government livelihood program beneficiaries to social security schemes						
Number of advocacy activities conducted on social security schemes	Total advocacies/ presentations done	123	As needed	As needed	As needed	As needed
No. of beneficiaries who attended advocacy activities						
Social Security Agreements (SSAs) or Bilateral Labor Agreements (BLAs) that integrate social security provisions with emphasis on portability and payment schemes						
No. of countries pursued/signed/in-force for SSA/BLA	SSA: with 15 countries in force (since 1982); various countries pursued BLA: 0	+2 countries	+2 countries	+2 countries	+2 countries	SSS, DMW
		+1 country	+1 country	+1 country	+1 country	+1 country
Comprehensive reintegration package for returning OFWs						
No. of beneficiaries of the Reintegration Program disaggregated by sex and type of dimension of support (if available)	DMW, DOLE, DTI					
Program for OFWs for better options for payment of social security contributions						
No. of existing payment options for OFWs	With existing payment options: SSS Web - AltPaynet (web) SSS Mobile App - Maya - Gcash - BPI - Credit/Debit Cards SSS, DMW					

5.4. Advocacy and Communication Plan

A holistic advocacy and communication plan (ACP) will be crucial in effectively communicating the progress and achievements of the PLEP. The ACP will use multimedia, online platforms, traditional and non-traditional channels, community-based communication channels, and digital tools to reach out to the public, promote the plan and its programs and activities, and sustain and widen support to the PLEP.

The Committee, through the TWG, shall lead the formulation of the ACP. The DOLE's Information and Publication Service (IPS) shall provide technical and administrative support. The ILO and other concerned government agencies shall be part of this process to provide inputs and lend their expertise

and resources in mobilizing sectoral support. The active participation of the top leadership of the tripartite partners as well as other senior government officials in communication activities will be secured. Lastly, opinion and thought leaders will be engaged in disseminating the core messages of the PLEP.

5.5. PLEP Platform

An online knowledge-sharing platform will be created to provide a digital database for the PLEP. This collaborative platform will contain all the data and information about the plan, including performance targets and indicators, programs and activities, progress and achievements, resources, knowledge products, and partnerships and collaborations. This interactive platform will provide a space for individual and institutional voices on the PLEP and the world of work in general, as it also facilitates multistakeholder exchanges and public sharing of good practices through, for example, podcasts, online communities, webinars, and social media.



BAGONG PILIPINAS